

删不掉的光 III

当文字被删，光仍留下

的鲜绿，我外被删，一袋在春
naive 楚删的晓是我来处遇
楚了。直说“enki”
花替，never light
light Wornen”
how 也是你，非么
被删的自生，将棒
hora. 弄在得删，我
，帝该都文字的
绿的。

THE LIGHT THEY COULD NOT ERASE, Vol. 3
When Words Vanish, Light Remains

Chongzhu (Paul) Zhang

删不掉的光 III：在破碎中仍然相爱

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文字、良知、失去、婚姻与盼望

作者：张崇助

The Light They Could Not Erase, Vol. 3

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版权页

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作者简介 · Author Bio

张崇助（Chongzhu “Paul” Zhang），牧师、作者、神学研究者。

早年毕业于上海华东神学院，获神学本科与圣乐本科。随后赴美深造，就读于美国 Ozark Christian College 旗下林肯神学院（Lincoln Seminary），获道学硕士（Master of Divinity）学位，主修圣经研究与教牧领导（Biblical Studies and Pastoral Leadership）。

现就读于美国亚斯埋神学院（Asbury Theological Seminary）教牧学博士（Doctor of Ministry, D.Min.）项目，研究方向为 Preaching and Leading（讲道与领导）。

自 2001 年开始全职牧会，长期从事讲道、教导、门徒训练与教会牧养工作。曾在中国多地服事，现任美国印第安纳州印城第一华人循理会（First Chinese Free Methodist Church of Indianapolis）主任牧师。

除了牧会与教学之外，张崇助长期通过网络平台分享关于信仰、人生、家庭、苦难、盼望与跨文化经历的思考。《删不掉的光》（The Light They Could Not Erase）系列，记录一个普通牧者在人生旅程中所经历的恩典、反思与成长。

他深信：真正改变生命的，往往不是轰轰烈烈的时刻，而是那些隐藏在平凡日子里的恩典之光。

Author Bio

Chongzhu “Paul” Zhang is a pastor, author, and theological researcher.

He graduated from East China Theological Seminary in Shanghai, earning undergraduate degrees in Theology and Sacred Music. He later pursued advanced theological studies in the United States at Lincoln Seminary of Ozark Christian College, where he received a Master of Divinity (M.Div.) with a concentration in Biblical Studies and Pastoral Leadership.

He is currently pursuing a Doctor of Ministry (D.Min.) degree at Asbury Theological Seminary, with a focus on Preaching and Leading.

Since entering full-time ministry in 2001, Pastor Zhang has devoted himself to preaching, teaching, discipleship, and pastoral leadership. After years of ministry in China, he now serves as Senior Pastor of the First Chinese Free Methodist Church of Indianapolis, Indiana.

In addition to ministry, he writes regularly about faith, life, family, suffering, hope, and cross-cultural experience. The Light They Could Not Erase series preserves stories of grace, perseverance, and spiritual growth from his life and online writing ministry.

He believes that the moments that shape our lives most deeply are often not the extraordinary ones, but the quiet lights of grace found in ordinary days.

书名说明

为什么是“在破碎中仍然相爱”

文字可能消失，声音可能变小，安全感可能被击碎；家庭也可能经历误解、冲突、背叛与离散。

但破碎不是本书最后的答案。

这本合并后的第三册，从公共表达与良知写到纪念、失去与盼望，也从婚姻盟约写到亲密、界限、离婚与重新站立。看起来是不同主题，背后却在追问同一件事：当外在世界不再稳固，我们里面还有什么不能被夺走？

答案不是更响亮的声音，也不是更完美的关系，而是在真理中仍守住良知，在苦难中仍保有盼望，在关系中仍学习真实地爱。

文字会被删除，光却仍然留下；关系会受伤，爱却仍能在真相、责任、界限与恩典中重新学习。

因此，这一册命名为《在破碎中仍然相爱》。

Why “Loving Through Brokenness”

Words may disappear. Voices may grow quiet. Security may be shattered. Families may also pass through misunderstanding, conflict, betrayal, and separation.

Brokenness, however, is not the final answer of this book.

This combined volume moves from public expression and conscience to memory, loss, and hope, and then from marital covenant to intimacy, boundaries, divorce, and healing. These themes appear different, but they ask the same question: when the outer world is no longer secure, what remains beyond the reach of loss?

The answer is not a louder voice or a perfect relationship. It is the grace to keep a clear conscience in truth, to retain hope in suffering, and to continue learning how to love honestly.

Words may be erased, yet light remains. Relationships may be wounded, yet love can be learned again through truth, responsibility, boundaries, and grace.

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第一辑：当文字被删，光仍留下

当文章消失后：那些仍然留在心里的光

一篇文章消失，往往只是一瞬间的事。

但它在读者心里留下的亮光，却不是一瞬间就能消失的。

有一段时间，连续几篇文章无法查看。有些刚发出去不久，有些已经收到不少读者回应，却突然从页面上消失。每当看到那样的提示，我心里像被轻轻敲了一下。

不是震怒，只是沉默。

写作本来就是与时间、空间、现实之间的一种安静较量。而文章不能留下，只是提醒我：这条路仍然有代价。

但奇妙的是，文章消失之后，留下来的并不是黑暗，而是读者的私信、留言、问候和祷告。

有人说：“你写的东西我来不及收藏，但我记住了。”

有人说：“虽然文章看不到了，但我读的时候被安慰了。”

也有人说：“每一篇都像是在陪伴我走过一个阶段。”

那一刻，我才意识到：文章的生命不只在平台上，也在读者的生命里。

文章可以消失，但影响不会因此消失。

文字可以被拿走，但被触碰过的心不会被拿走。

一、被看见的不是文章，而是生命

写作表面上是表达，实际上也是一种被看见。

文章不能留下，让我重新思考一个问题：到底是什么让人愿意持续写？

不是发表的权利，不是平台提供的空间，也不是流量带来的成就感。

而是在茫茫信息洪流里，仍有一个具体的人，可能因为一句话得到安慰，因为一段经历重新得力，因为一束微光没有在黑夜里放弃。

如果写作只是为了保存页面，那么页面消失就是失败。

但如果写作是为了触碰生命，那么任何真实的触碰，都已经有意义。

二、被夺走的，从来不是最重要的

被拿走的文章，只是文字的外壳。

真正留下来的，是文字曾经承载过的祷告、信念、痛苦、坚持与盼望。

我慢慢学会一句话：

写作不是为了留住文字，而是为了信守呼召。

如果一篇文章真正出自祷告，它不会因为无法查看而失去价值。

如果一段见证真正属于神，它不会因为不再公开而完全失效。

有些真理就算不能写，仍然是真理；有些经历就算不能发，仍然是经历；有些见证就算不能公开，仍然会在暗中发光。

三、写作是回应遗忘的一种方式

这个时代，最大的压力不只是表达不易，而是不被听见。

最大的恐惧不只是被删除，而是被遗忘。

而写作，就是在遗忘面前留下一点见证。

每一篇文章都是一个标记，标记着我曾在某个深夜祷告、挣扎、哭泣、醒悟；标记着神在我生命里做过的事；也标记着一个时代给人的试炼与盼望。

即使文章消失了，写过，就留下痕迹；写进人心，就留下种子。

有些种子不会长在平台上，而是长在每一个读到的人生命里。

四、尽力之后的平安

妻子曾对我说：“你已经写了，也有人看见了，你的责任尽到了。”

这句话让我从压力中被释放。

我们不是被呼召去控制结果，而是被呼召去尽力、忠心、顺服。

文章能不能留下，不完全由我决定。

文章能不能影响人，也不完全由我决定。

唯一由我决定的是：我是否继续忠心。

平安不是来自文章永远不会消失。

平安来自每一篇文章，我都尽力了。

结语：成为不会消失的活文字

当文章消失时，我更深刻地意识到：真正的文章，是写在生命中的。

你我的生命，是神亲自书写的故事。没有平台能删除，没有黑暗能遮盖，没有风浪能完全吹灭。

也许页面会关闭，也许记录会消失，但爱的行动不会失效，祷告的声音不会落空，忠心的见证不会被时间封存。

愿我们都成为时代中安静却坚定的活文字，继续发光，继续前行，继续写下属于神的故事。

English Version

When Articles Vanish, but the Light Remains

An article can disappear in an instant.

But the light it leaves in a reader's heart does not disappear in an instant.

There was a season when several of my articles became unavailable one after another. Some had only been posted for a short time. Others had already received responses from many readers before they suddenly vanished from the page. Each time I saw the notice, something in me felt quietly struck.

Not with rage.

Only with silence.

Writing has always been a quiet struggle with time, space, and reality. When an article cannot remain, it simply reminds me that this road still carries a cost.

Yet something unexpected happened. After the articles disappeared, what remained was not darkness, but private messages, comments, greetings, and prayers from readers.

Someone said, "I did not have time to save what you wrote, but I remembered it."

Someone said, "Although I can no longer see the article, I was comforted when I read it."

Someone else said, "Each article felt like it was walking with me through a season."

In that moment, I realized that the life of an article is not only on a platform. It is also in the lives of those it touches.

An article may disappear, but its influence does not necessarily disappear with it.

Words may be taken away, but a heart once touched by them is not taken away.

1. What Is Seen Is Not Only the Article, but a Life

On the surface, writing is expression. At a deeper level, it is a way of being seen.

When articles cannot remain, I am forced to ask again: what keeps a person writing?

It is not the right to publish, the space a platform provides, or the sense of achievement that comes from numbers.

It is the possibility that, in the flood of information, one specific person may receive comfort from one sentence, find strength through one experience, or refuse to give up because of one small light.

If writing is only about preserving a page, then disappearance is failure.

But if writing is about touching life, then every true touch already matters.

2. What Is Taken Away Is Never the Most Important Thing

The article that disappears is only the outer shell of the words.

What remains is the prayer, conviction, pain, perseverance, and hope those words once carried.

I have slowly learned this:

Writing is not for preserving text. It is for remaining faithful to a calling.

If an article truly comes out of prayer, it does not lose its value because it can no longer be viewed.

If a testimony truly belongs to God, it does not become invalid because it is no longer public.

Some truths remain true even when they cannot be written. Some experiences remain real even when they cannot be posted. Some testimonies continue to shine in secret even when they cannot be seen.

3. Writing Is One Way to Respond to Forgetting

The greatest pressure of this age is not only that expression can be difficult. It is that we may not be heard.

The greatest fear is not only being removed. It is being forgotten.

Writing is one way to leave a witness in the face of forgetting.

Every article is a marker. It marks a night of prayer, struggle, tears, and awakening. It marks something God has done in my life. It also marks the trials and hopes of an age.

Even if an article disappears, the act of writing leaves a trace. When words enter a heart, they become seeds.

Some seeds do not grow on platforms. They grow in the lives of those who read.

4. Peace After Faithfulness

My wife once said to me, “You already wrote it, and someone saw it. You have fulfilled your responsibility.”

Those words released me from pressure.

We are not called to control results. We are called to do our best, to be faithful, and to obey.

Whether an article remains is not fully in my hands.

Whether it affects someone is not fully in my hands either.

The one thing I can choose is whether I will continue faithfully.

Peace does not come from knowing that an article will never disappear.

Peace comes from knowing that I gave my best to each piece.

Conclusion: Becoming Living Words That Do Not Disappear

When an article disappears, I realize more deeply that the truest writing is written into life.

Our lives are stories written by God Himself. No platform can delete them. No darkness can cover them. No storm can fully extinguish them.

Pages may close. Records may vanish. But acts of love do not lose their meaning. Prayers do not fall empty. Faithful witness is not sealed away by time.

May we become quiet but steady living words in this generation, continuing to shine, continuing to walk forward, and continuing to write the story that belongs to God.

当声音渐弱：神在沉默中塑造的力量

有一段时间，文章消失得越来越频繁。

有时候，是一篇深夜刚写完、还没有来得及分享的文章；有时候，是一篇已经有不少读者回应的文章；有时候，是刚刚有人留言说“这句话帮助了我”，转眼之间，页面就变成了无法查看。

外面看见的，是一篇文章不见了。

但我里面感受到的，是神正在进行一场更安静、更深的塑造。

被拿走的，不只是文字，也包括我里面一些隐藏很深的东西：想被看见的渴望，想被理解的急切，对成果的依赖，以及对影响力的执着。

原来，声音被压低的时候，最需要被处理的，不一定是外面的环境，而是里面的心。

一、声音被压低，内心反而更吵

第一次文章无法查看时，我心里会不平：为什么这样温和的反思也不能留下？

第二次、第三次之后，我开始无奈。

后来，连无奈都变成了一种疲惫。

但慢慢地，我发现，真正吵闹的并不是外面，而是我里面那股急切的声音：

“我希望更多人看见。”

“我希望我的表达被理解。”

“我希望这篇文章能留下来。”

当声音被压低时，我才看见自己并不只是想写。我也想影响、扩散、被读、被认可。

神允许一些文字暂时消失，不是为了羞辱我，而是为了温柔地提醒我：

你的声音，不是建立在平台上，而是建立在我里面。

二、文章消失后，才看见什么真正留下

文章可以消失，但背后的祷告不会消失。

文字可以被隐藏，但生命的塑造不会被隐藏。

页面可以不再显示，但一个人心里被点亮的那一点光，仍然真实存在。

有读者对我说：“虽然文章看不到了，但那几句话我还记得。”

也有人说：“我没来得及收藏，可是我读的时候被安慰了。”

这些回应让我明白：文章不是终点，文章只是桥梁。

桥梁也许会断，但它曾经带人走过的那一段路，仍然存在。

真正被保存的，不一定是文字，而是文字曾经触碰过的人心。

三、限制成为呼召的过滤器

写作一开始看起来像一种选择。

我愿意写，我想分享，我希望被看见。

但一个人若真被呼召，走到某个阶段就会发现：写作不只是选择，更是一种顺服。

一次次受限，像一层层筛子，把许多混杂的动机过滤掉：想被看见，想被称赞，想证明自己，想留下一点影响。

最后留下来的，是一个更简单的问题：

即使没有掌声，我还愿意忠心吗？

如果一篇文章只有一个人读到，那一个人仍然值得。

如果一段光只亮了很短的时间，那一段光仍然是真实的光。

限制不是失败。它有时只是帮助我确认：我不是为了留名写作，而是为了忠心写作。

四、沉默中，神让声音更真实

当外面的声音被压低时，里面的声音反而有机会被重新校正。

我开始问自己：

我写作到底是为了谁？

我真正想传递的是什么？

如果只能在小范围里影响人，我是否仍然愿意继续？

如果世界听不见，我是否仍愿意让神听见？

答案很安静，却也很清楚：

愿意。

因为真正的声音，不只是音量，而是生命本身在说话。

文字可以暂时被拿走，但坚持不会被拿走；外在可以沉默，但内心的召命不会沉默。

结语：成为不会消失的活见证

我越来越相信，神不只是要保守一段段文字，祂更要塑造写作者的生命。

祂允许我们失去一些可见的文字，为要让我们得着一种不能被夺走的生命。

愿我们成为这样的人：

被压低时仍温柔；

被误解时仍坚定；

被限制时仍发光；

被静默时仍祷告。

愿我们的盼望不只停留在“文章能否留下”，而是安放在神正在我们生命里书写的那篇更大的故事中。

English Version

When the Voice Grows Quiet

There was a season when my articles disappeared more and more often.

Sometimes it was a piece I had just finished late at night and had not yet shared widely. Sometimes it was an article that had already received many responses. Sometimes a reader had just written, “This sentence helped me,” and moments later the page was no longer available.

Outwardly, an article had disappeared.

Inwardly, I sensed that God was doing a quieter and deeper work of formation.

What was being taken away was not only text. Something inside me was also being exposed: my desire to be seen, my urgency to be understood, my dependence on visible results, and my attachment to influence.

When the voice is lowered, the first thing that needs attention is not always the outside circumstance. Often, it is the heart within.

1. When the Voice Is Lowered, the Heart Becomes Loud

The first time an article became unavailable, I felt wronged. Why could even such a gentle reflection not remain?

The second and third times, I became resigned.

Eventually, even resignation became a kind of weariness.

But slowly I realized that the real noise was not outside me. It was the restless voice within:

“I want more people to see this.”

“I want my words to be understood.”

“I want this article to remain.”

When my voice was lowered, I discovered that I did not merely want to write. I also wanted to influence, spread, be read, and be affirmed.

God allowed some words to disappear not to humiliate me, but to remind me gently:

Your voice is not built on a platform. It is built in Me.

2. When Articles Disappear, We Learn What Remains

An article can disappear, but the prayer behind it does not.

Words can be hidden, but the formation of a life cannot be hidden.

A page may no longer be visible, but the small light kindled in a person’s heart remains real.

One reader told me, “Although I can no longer see the article, I still remember those sentences.”

Another said, “I did not have time to save it, but I was comforted when I read it.”

Such responses taught me that an article is not the destination. It is a bridge.

The bridge may break, but the part of the journey it helped someone cross still remains.

What is truly preserved is not always the text. It is the heart once touched by the text.

3. Limitation Becomes a Filter for Calling

At first, writing feels like a choice.

I want to write. I want to share. I want to be seen.

But when a person is truly called, there comes a point when writing is no longer merely a choice. It becomes an obedience.

Repeated limitation becomes like a sieve, filtering out mixed motives: the desire to be noticed, praised, proven, or remembered.

What remains is a simpler question:

Even without applause, am I still willing to be faithful?

If only one person reads an article, that one person is still worth it.

If a light shines only briefly, it is still real light.

Limitation is not necessarily failure. Sometimes it simply helps me remember that I do not write to make a name for myself. I write to be faithful.

4. In Silence, God Makes the Voice More True

When the outer voice is lowered, the inner voice has a chance to be corrected.

I began asking myself:

For whom am I writing?

What am I truly trying to communicate?

If my influence remains small and private, will I still continue?

If the world does not hear me, am I still willing to be heard by God?

The answer was quiet, but clear:

Yes.

Because a true voice is not merely volume. It is life itself speaking.

Words can be temporarily removed, but perseverance cannot. The outside may become silent, but the calling within does not become silent.

Conclusion: Becoming Living Letters That Cannot Be Removed

I am increasingly convinced that God is not merely protecting articles. He is shaping the writer.

He allows us to lose some visible words so that we may receive a life that cannot be taken away.

May we become people who remain gentle when lowered, steady when misunderstood, bright when restricted, and prayerful when silenced.

May our hope rest not merely in whether an article remains, but in the greater story God is writing in our lives.

当安全感被击碎

有一段时间，我开玩笑说，自己写的不是文章，而是“限时动态”。

因为一篇文章刚发出去，读者刚开始回应，甚至还没有完全被读到，就突然无法查看了。

起初，我会失落。后来，我会苦笑。再后来，我开始在这些反复发生的经历里，看见一个更深的问题：

我的安全感到底建立在哪儿？

如果安全感建立在平台、数据、阅读量、回应和保存期限上，它迟早会被击碎。

但如果安全感建立在神的呼召里，即使外面的东西摇动，里面仍然可以站立。

一、文章可以消失，呼召的火不会熄灭

有人问我：“写了又可能消失，还值得吗？”

我当然会累，也会失望。

可是每次想停下来的时候，里面总有一种很深的负担提醒我：

你仍然要记录。

你仍然要说话。

你仍然要把所领受的光写下来。

那不是一时情绪，也不是愤怒，而是一种安静却压不住的呼召。

文章可能消失，但呼召的火不会因此熄灭。相反，它有时会被炼得更纯、更安静、更真实。

二、当安全感来自数字，人就会不断惧怕

一篇文章被拿走时，我会想：那些阅读还算数吗？那些回应还在吗？那些读者还记得吗？

这些问题看似自然，其实也暴露了我的依赖。

我把太多安全感放在成果里，而不是呼召里。

数字能上升，也能归零；回应能热烈，也能消散；平台能保留，也能改变。

如果我为了安全而写，我就会越来越小心，越来越圆滑，越来越不像自己。

所以我必须学习把安全感放回神那里。

写作不是为了证明自己有效，而是为了在所领受的托付上忠心。

三、被击碎的安全感，也让同行者显明出来

文章消失之后，我原以为一切就结束了。

但常常就在那时，一些安静的回应出现了。

有人说：“我已经读到了。”

有人说：“那几句话我记住了。”

有人说：“虽然文章不在了，但它真的帮助我。”

这些声音让我明白：读者不是单纯的旁观者。有些人其实是在一起承担、一起记念、一起守住那些不该被遗忘的光。

文章的力量不只在传播多少，也在于它是否真实地照亮了某一个人。

四、试炼也可能成为恩典

从前，我只觉得失去是一种损失。

现在我慢慢看见，有些失去也可能成为恩典。

它让我更谦卑，知道自己不是靠文字改变世界，而是作一个忠心的小仆人。

它让我更自由，因为文章随时可能消失，所以我不再把价值绑在数字上。

它让我更勇敢，因为每一次失去都像在问我：“你还愿意继续吗？”

当我再次回答“愿意”时，勇气就慢慢成为生命的一部分。

结语：在脆弱中站稳

写作确实是脆弱的。每一篇文章都可能失去，每一次表达都可能被误解，每一段见证都可能只留下很短的时间。

但信仰不是脆弱的。

它不建立在平台上，也不倚靠数字维持。

愿神帮助我们，在脆弱中仍然忠心，在压力中仍然温柔，在限制中仍然发光。

愿我们的安全感，不再建立在能否被保存，而建立在那位永不改变的主身上。

English Version

When Security Is Shattered

For a season, I joked that I was not writing articles, but temporary messages.

An article would be posted, readers would just begin to respond, and before it had even been fully read, it would suddenly become unavailable.

At first, I felt disappointed. Later, I laughed bitterly. Eventually, I began to see a deeper question beneath these repeated experiences:

Where is my sense of security really rooted?

If my security is built on platforms, numbers, views, responses, and the length of time a post remains visible, it will eventually be shattered.

But if my security is rooted in God's calling, then even when outward things are shaken, the soul can still stand.

1. Articles Can Disappear, but the Fire of Calling Remains

Some people ask, "If what you write may disappear, is it still worth it?"

Of course I get tired. Of course I feel disappointed.

Yet every time I want to stop, a deep burden within me reminds me:

You still need to record.

You still need to speak.

You still need to write down the light you have received.

This is not a passing emotion. It is not anger. It is a quiet but persistent calling.

An article may disappear, but the fire of calling is not extinguished. Sometimes it is purified, becoming quieter, deeper, and more real.

2. When Security Comes from Numbers, Fear Never Ends

When an article is taken away, I wonder: Do those views still count? Are those responses still there? Will the readers remember?

These questions are understandable, but they also reveal my dependence.

I had placed too much security in results instead of calling.

Numbers can rise and fall. Responses can be warm and then fade. Platforms can preserve something today and change tomorrow.

If I write only to stay safe, I will become smaller, smoother, and less true.

So I must learn to place my security back in God.

Writing is not about proving that I am effective. It is about being faithful to what has been entrusted to me.

3. Shattered Security Reveals Companions

After an article disappears, I often assume the matter is finished.

But often, quiet responses appear afterward.

Someone says, “I already read it.”

Someone says, “I remember those sentences.”

Someone says, “Although the article is gone, it truly helped me.”

These voices remind me that readers are not merely observers. Some are companions who help remember and carry the light that should not be forgotten.

The power of an article is not only in how widely it spreads, but in whether it truly illumines one person.

4. Trial Can Become Grace

I used to see removal only as loss.

Now I am slowly learning that some losses can also become grace.

They make me more humble, reminding me that I do not change the world through words. I simply serve as a faithful servant.

They make me freer, because if articles can disappear at any time, my worth cannot be tied to numbers.

They make me braver, because each loss asks me again, “Will you still continue?”

When I answer yes, courage slowly becomes part of my life.

Conclusion: Standing Firm in Fragility

Writing is fragile. Every article can be lost. Every expression can be misunderstood. Every testimony may remain visible only for a short time.

But faith is not fragile.

It is not built on platforms, and it does not depend on numbers to survive.

May God help us remain faithful in fragility, gentle under pressure, and bright under limitation.

May our security no longer rest in whether our words are preserved, but in the unchanging Lord.

当声音被缩小

有时候，一篇文章消失的那一瞬间，像是一个声音突然从空气中被抽走。

明明刚刚还在回响，下一刻却好像从未存在过。

可是，奇妙的是，每一次声音被缩小，都让我更清楚一件事：

声音可以被按住，但心不必跟着变小。

只要心还在扩张，路就不会被真正封死。

一、声音被缩小是外在，心变狭窄是内在

外在的声音会被剪短、遮住、吞没、误解，这并不稀奇。

这是时代的风。

风大，不一定是你的错。

但心是否因此变窄，却是我们必须面对的选择。

有些人声音被缩小之后，心也跟着缩小。他们不再说，不再想，不再坚持，也不再相信意义。

久而久之，沉默不只是外在状态，也变成了内在习惯。

我愿意选择另一条路。

即使声音变得微弱，我仍愿意让心继续向外延伸：继续写，继续说，继续点一盏小灯。

因为心若宽广，就容得下风，也容得下不理解；容得下黑暗，也容得下那些仍然需要光的人。

二、真正被触动的，常常是人不愿面对的真实

有人说：“你的文章之所以容易消失，是因为写得太真实。”

我听了，只能沉默。

真实有时候并不锋利，却仍会让人不舒服。

因为真实会照见被忽略的角落，会触碰人心里早已知道却不愿承认的部分，也会让一些表面的平静显出裂缝。

但真实也是灵魂醒来的入口。

如果所有表达都只剩下安全的表面话，人就会慢慢失去呼吸的空间。

所以，我继续学习诚实。

不是为了对抗谁，而是为了不让自己的心变得虚假。

诚实，本身也是一种呼吸。

三、心越大，路越宽

当心慢慢变宽时，人会发生几个变化。

第一，不再只为“能不能发表”而写。

因为写作的价值不只在平台，而在生命本身。

第二，不再被“消失了怎么办”吓住。

因为被拿走的是一段文字，不是灵魂里的火。

第三，开始拥有平台之外的声音。

真正的声音不只是账号发出的内容，而是生命散发出的见证。即使不能大声说，也可以轻轻说、慢慢说、持续说。

第四，开始看见更多人。

心宽了，人就不只在意自己失去了什么，也会开始问：谁还在沉默里挣扎？谁还在黑暗里走不出来？谁需要听见一句“你并不孤单”？

心越宽，世界也越宽。

四、失去是心被扩张的机会

每一次文章消失，我都会问自己：

我还愿意继续吗？

如果答案仍然是“愿意”，那我的心就又被扩张了一点。

失去不是终点，也可以是训练。

它逼着我确认：我的动机、信念、勇气和呼召，是否比“能不能被看见”更深。

当一个人心越来越宽，他就不再那么害怕失去。

因为真正重要的东西，往往藏在里面，是不容易被拿走的。

结语：愿你的心大过风

世界的风会吹散人的声音，吹淡人的痕迹，也吹动人的安全感。

但愿我们的心大过这些风。

心宽的时候，风吹不走你；黑暗吞不掉你；沉默定义不了你；失去也不能终止你。

愿你成为这一代安静的守灯者：即使声音被缩小，心却越来越宽，路也越来越亮。

因为一个心宽的人走到哪里，哪里就会多一盏灯。

English Version

When the Voice Is Made Small

Sometimes, when an article disappears, it feels as if a voice has been pulled out of the air.
One moment it is still echoing. The next moment, it seems as though it never existed.
Yet strangely, every time my voice is made smaller, I become clearer about one thing:
A voice can be pressed down, but the heart does not have to shrink with it.
As long as the heart continues to expand, the road ahead is not truly closed.

1. A Smaller Voice Is External; a Narrower Heart Is Internal

Outward voices can be shortened, hidden, swallowed, or misunderstood. This is not surprising.
It is the wind of the times.
Strong wind is not necessarily your fault.
But whether the heart becomes narrow is a choice we must face.
Some people lose volume in their voice, and their hearts shrink with it. They stop speaking, stop thinking, stop persevering, and stop believing that meaning matters.
Over time, silence becomes not only an outward condition, but an inward habit.
I want to choose another way.
Even if my voice becomes faint, I still want my heart to keep reaching outward: to keep writing, to keep speaking, and to keep lighting a small lamp.
When the heart is wide, it can carry the wind and misunderstanding. It can carry darkness, and it can also carry those who still need light.

2. What Is Touched Is Often the Truth People Do Not Want to Face

Some people say, “Your articles disappear because they are too real.”
When I hear this, I can only be quiet.
Truth is not always sharp, but it can still make people uncomfortable.
Truth shines into neglected corners. It touches what people already know but do not want to admit. It reveals cracks beneath surface-level calm.
But truth is also the doorway through which the soul wakes up.
If all expression is reduced to safe surface language, people slowly lose room to breathe.
So I continue learning honesty.
Not in order to oppose anyone, but so that my own heart will not become false.

Honesty itself is a form of breathing.

3. The Wider the Heart, the Wider the Road

When the heart becomes wider, several changes take place.

First, we no longer write only for the sake of being published.

The value of writing does not rest only on a platform. It rests in life itself.

Second, we are no longer controlled by the fear of disappearance.

What is taken away is a piece of text, not the fire within the soul.

Third, we begin to have a voice beyond platforms.

A true voice is not merely what an account posts. It is the witness a life gives off. Even if we cannot speak loudly, we can speak gently, slowly, and steadily.

Fourth, we begin to see more people.

When the heart grows wider, we no longer care only about what we have lost. We begin to ask: Who is still struggling in silence? Who cannot find a way out of the dark? Who needs to hear the words, “You are not alone”?

The wider the heart, the wider the world.

4. Loss Can Become an Invitation to Grow

Every time an article disappears, I ask myself:

Am I still willing to continue?

If the answer is still yes, then my heart has grown a little wider.

Loss is not the end. It can also be training.

It forces me to examine whether my motives, convictions, courage, and calling are deeper than the desire to be seen.

When a person’s heart becomes wider, he becomes less afraid of loss.

Because the things that matter most are often hidden within, where they cannot easily be taken away.

Conclusion: May Your Heart Be Larger Than the Wind

The winds of the world can scatter a voice, thin a trace, and shake a person’s security.

But may our hearts be larger than those winds.

When the heart is wide, the wind cannot carry you away. Darkness cannot swallow you. Silence cannot define you. Loss cannot end you.

May you become a quiet keeper of light in this generation: even when your voice is made small, may your heart grow wider and your path grow brighter.

Because wherever a wide heart walks, another lamp is lit.

当灵魂疲惫时

有一天，一位朋友问我：

“你的文章一次次消失，你会不会觉得累？”

我笑了笑，说：“累，当然累。但奇妙的是，我也越来越清醒。”

写作有时像在风中点灯。你刚刚把一点光举起来，风就来了；你刚刚听见读者说“这句话帮助了我”，转眼之间，文章已经无法查看。那一刻，人会疲惫，也会怀疑：我到底在做什么？这样坚持还有意义吗？

可是，正是在这样的时刻，我慢慢明白：灵魂的疲惫，并不一定是失败。有时候，它是一种提醒，提醒我们重新分辨自己为什么写，为什么说，为什么仍然选择忠心。

一、疲惫让我们重新定义意义

这个时代很容易让人误会：文章留下来，才算有价值；阅读量高，才算有影响；被广泛转发，才说明值得。

但真实的意义，往往不在这些可见的数字里。

一篇文章可以短暂存在，却真实地安慰一个人。一句话可以很快消失，却在某个深夜扶住一颗软弱的心。一个见证也许没有留下链接，却已经在人心里留下了光。

意义不完全取决于作品能保存多久，而取决于写作背后的忠心是否真实。

二、疲惫让我们学习为看不见的果效而写

从前，我以为写作主要是写给读者看的。

后来我越来越觉得，写作首先是写在神面前。

也许文章只存在几个小时，也许读者并不多，也许许多回应没有被看见，但我们永远不知道：哪一句话曾经安慰一个正在挣扎的人，哪一段文字曾经让一个灰心的人没有放弃，哪一个比喻曾经让一个迷茫的灵魂重新看见方向。

我们负责忠心地写，神负责让祂要触摸的人读到。

果效不是我们能掌控的。忠心，才是我们可以选择的。

三、疲惫加深我们对盼望的理解

盼望不是浪漫的情绪，也不是廉价的乐观。

真正的盼望，是在环境看似没有盼望的时候，仍然坚持做正确的事。

文章可能无法长久保存，但真理不会因此失效；表达可能受到限制，但光不会因此熄灭；人的声音可能被压低，但信心的种子仍会在暗处生长。

盼望不是一条没有阻力的路，而是在崎岖中仍然往前走的力量。

四、疲惫让力量在隐藏中累积

有读者曾经问我：“既然这么累，为什么还要继续写？”

我想了很久，答案其实很简单：

因为写作对我来说，不只是策略，而是呼召。

呼召不是为了保证结果，而是为了学习忠心。一个人若只在顺利时坚持，那还不算真正的坚持；若在疲惫、限制、误解中仍然不放弃，生命里面就会长出一种更深的韧性。

这种韧性，不是课程能立刻教出来的，也不是掌声能塑造出来的。它常常是在沉默中，在不被理解中，在一次次重新开始中，被慢慢炼成的。

五、疲惫让我们更接近圣经中的见证人

圣经里有许多在限制中仍然忠心的人。

约瑟在监牢里，但他的忠心没有被锁住。

但以理面对压力，但他的祷告没有停止。

保罗被囚禁，但他的书信至今仍然安慰和坚固无数人。

这提醒我：真正改变世界的，不只是外在形式，而是生命里面不肯熄灭的忠心。

文章可以消失，忠心不会消失。

平台可以改变，呼召不会改变。

结语：愿疲惫不夺走你的盼望

如果你也正在经历一种深处的疲惫，请记得：疲惫不一定说明你走错了路。有时候，它只是说明你正在一条需要付代价的路上。

愿你在疲惫中不失盼望，在安静中不失火，在受限中不失自己。

愿你的文字，即使短暂，也带着永恒的光。

愿你的生命，即使疲惫，也仍然被神亲自扶持。

English Version

When the Soul Grows Weary

One day, a friend asked me,

“When your articles keep disappearing, don’t you feel tired?”

I smiled and said, “Of course I do. But strangely, I am also becoming more awake.”

Writing can feel like lighting a lamp in the wind. Just as you raise a small light, the wind comes. Just as a reader says, “This sentence helped me,” the article is suddenly no longer available. In that moment, weariness comes. Questions come too: What am I doing? Does this kind of perseverance still matter?

Yet in those moments, I have slowly come to understand that the weariness of the soul is not always a sign of failure. Sometimes it is a reminder. It asks us to discern again why we write, why we speak, and why we still choose faithfulness.

1. Weariness Redefines Meaning

This age easily teaches us to misunderstand meaning. We assume that an article matters only if it remains visible, that influence depends on high numbers, and that something is valuable only if it is widely shared.

But true meaning is often not found in visible numbers.

An article may exist only briefly and still comfort one person. A sentence may disappear quickly and still hold up a weary heart at midnight. A testimony may leave no public link behind and yet leave light in someone’s soul.

Meaning is not determined only by how long a piece of writing survives. It is determined by whether the faithfulness behind it is real.

2. Weariness Teaches Us to Write for Unseen Fruit

I once thought writing was mainly for readers.

Now I increasingly believe that writing is first done before God.

An article may remain visible for only a few hours. The audience may be small. Many responses may never be seen. Yet we never know which sentence may comfort someone who is struggling, which paragraph may keep a discouraged person from giving up, or which image may help a confused soul see direction again.

We write faithfully. God decides whom the words will reach.

The fruit is not ours to control. Faithfulness is ours to choose.

3. Weariness Deepens Our Understanding of Hope

Hope is not a romantic feeling. It is not cheap optimism.

True hope is continuing to do what is right when circumstances do not look hopeful.

An article may not remain available, but truth does not lose its power. Expression may be limited, but light is not extinguished. A human voice may be lowered, but seeds of faith can still grow in hidden places.

Hope is not a road without resistance. It is the strength to keep walking on a difficult road.

4. Weariness Builds Strength in Hidden Places

A reader once asked me, “If it is so tiring, why keep writing?”

I thought about it for a long time. The answer is simple:

For me, writing is not merely a strategy. It is a calling.

Calling is not about guaranteeing results. It is about learning faithfulness. If a person perseveres only when things are easy, that is not yet true perseverance. But when someone continues through weariness, limitation, and misunderstanding, a deeper resilience begins to grow within the soul.

This resilience cannot be formed instantly by a course. It cannot be created by applause. It is often forged slowly in silence, in being misunderstood, and in beginning again and again.

5. Weariness Draws Us Nearer to Biblical Witnesses

Scripture gives us many examples of people who remained faithful under limitation.

Joseph was in prison, but his faithfulness was not chained.

Daniel faced pressure, but his prayers did not stop.

Paul was imprisoned, but his letters still comfort and strengthen countless lives today.

This reminds me that what truly changes the world is not merely outward form, but the faithfulness within a life that refuses to go out.

Articles may disappear. Faithfulness does not.

Platforms may change. Calling does not.

Conclusion: May Weariness Not Take Away Your Hope

If you are also experiencing deep weariness, remember this: weariness does not always mean you are on the wrong road. Sometimes it simply means you are walking a road that carries a cost.

May you not lose hope in weariness. May you not lose fire in silence. May you not lose yourself under limitation.

May your words, however brief, carry eternal light.

May your life, even when weary, be held by God Himself.

当文字无法留下

有时候，看着一篇文章无法再被打开，我心里会浮现一个很真实的问题：

如果文字留不住，那我写的意义在哪里？

这是每一个写作者、思考者、说话者，在某些时代都会面对的困惑。

文章会消失，记录会中断，平台会改变，痕迹也可能被抹去。

那么，一个人的思想、信仰和灵魂，到底如何留下印记？

答案也许比我们想象的更简单：

文字不一定留下，但生命可以留下。

记录不一定保存，但影响可以保存。

文章可能消失，但它曾经触动过的人，不会因此完全回到原点。

我们无法决定所有字句能否长久留下，但我们可以决定：在别人心里留下什么。

一、文字容易消失，生命不容易被抹去

我们常常把文章当作“我存在过”的证明。

发出去了，被看见了，被转发了，好像就说明这段思想在世界上留下了一点位置。

可是，当文章消失时，人会突然觉得：是不是连我的表达也被拿走了？

但事实并不是这样。

被拿走的是文本，不是生命。

被抹去的是页面，不是经历。

文字是一条路，却不是目的本身。

你的经历、眼泪、祷告、见证、信念，这些比一篇文章更长久。

有时候，一句话虽然看不见了，却已经足够在某个人心里点亮一盏灯。

文章不在了，光却已经留下了。

二、最深的痕迹写在人心里

有些文章消失以后，反而会收到读者的私信。

“我昨天刚好读到了。”

“那句话帮助我很多。”

“那一段正是我需要的。”

“虽然找不到了，但我记住了。”

这些回应让我意识到，真正的存档不一定在网络上，而在人心里。

落在平台上的，是数据。

落在人心里的，才是影响。

真正持久的，不只是能不能保存，而是能不能使一个人被安慰、被唤醒、被陪伴。

文章可以结束，但触动不会立刻结束。

文字会消失，但共鸣不一定消失。

三、删不掉的是故事与生命

一篇文章可以不见，但一个人的故事不会因此被抹去。

你经历过的恩典，你走过的痛苦，你看见过的光，你守住过的信仰，这些都不是平台能够决定的。

文章消失，反而让我重新问自己：

我写作是为了文字，还是为了见证？

是为了被看见，还是为了忠心？

是为了存在感，还是为了回应呼召？

当写作成为献给神的一种敬拜，而不是献给平台的一份内容，人就不容易因为失去外在保存而灰心。

四、文字无法留下时，神让生命留下

或许写作的终点，不只是文章留下，而是我们通过写作成为怎样的人。

当我们写温柔，自己也要学习温柔。

当我们写盼望，自己也要经历盼望。

当我们写信心，自己也要操练信心。

于是，文章反过来成为神塑造人的工具。

外在的文字可能消失，但因写作而被塑造的生命不会白白消失。

真正留下的印记，不只是一篇文章的链接，而是一个人慢慢成为诚实、勇敢、忠心、守光的人。

结语：让生命成为不会消失的文章

有一天，也许许多文章都会不见。

这不是不可能，也不是最重要的。

更重要的是，有些东西不要从生命中消失：

安慰不要消失；

勇气不要消失；

盼望不要消失；

在黑暗中被点亮的那一点光，不要消失。

文字会被风吹散，记录会被时间遮盖，平台也会不断改变。

但灵魂留下的印记，诚实、勇敢、信念、爱与盼望，是更深、更久的见证。

愿我们的生命，成为一篇不被时间抹去的见证。

English Version

When Words Cannot Remain

Sometimes, when I see an article become unavailable, a very real question rises within me:

If my words cannot remain, what is the meaning of writing?

This is a question every writer, thinker, and speaker may face in certain seasons.

Articles disappear. Records break off. Platforms change. Traces may be erased.

So how can a person's thoughts, faith, and soul leave a mark at all?

The answer may be simpler than we imagine:

Words may not always remain, but life can.

Records may not always be preserved, but influence can.

An article may disappear, but the person it once touched does not simply return unchanged.

We cannot decide whether every sentence will remain visible. But we can decide what we leave in another person's heart.

1. Words Disappear Easily; Life Is Not So Easily Erased

We often treat an article as proof that we were here.

It was published, seen, and shared. In some way, it seemed to give our thoughts a place in the world.

But when an article disappears, we may suddenly feel as if our expression itself has been taken away.

Yet that is not the whole truth.

What is taken is text, not life.

What is removed is a page, not an experience.

Words are a road, but they are not the destination.

Your experiences, tears, prayers, witness, and convictions last longer than a single article.

Sometimes a sentence can no longer be seen, yet it has already lit a lamp in someone's heart.

The article is gone, but the light remains.

2. The Deepest Marks Are Written in Human Hearts

After some articles disappear, I receive private messages from readers.

"I happened to read it yesterday."

"That sentence helped me so much."

"That paragraph was exactly what I needed."

“Although I cannot find it now, I remember it.”

These responses remind me that the truest archive is not always online. It is in the human heart.

What lands on a platform is data.

What sinks into a heart is influence.

What lasts most deeply is not merely what can be saved, but what can comfort, awaken, and accompany a person.

An article may end, but its touch does not end immediately.

Words may disappear, but resonance does not always disappear.

3. Stories and Lives Cannot Be Deleted

An article may vanish, but a person's story is not erased by that.

The grace you have received, the pain you have walked through, the light you have seen, and the faith you have guarded are not decided by any platform.

When writing disappears, it forces me to ask again:

Do I write for text, or for witness?

For visibility, or for faithfulness?

For a sense of existence, or in response to calling?

When writing becomes an act of worship offered to God, rather than content offered to a platform, a person is less likely to lose heart when outward preservation fails.

4. When Words Cannot Remain, God Lets Life Remain

Perhaps the end of writing is not only that an article remains, but that through writing we become a certain kind of person.

When we write about gentleness, we must learn gentleness ourselves.

When we write about hope, we must experience hope ourselves.

When we write about faith, we must practice faith ourselves.

In this way, articles become tools God uses to shape us.

The outward words may disappear, but the life formed through writing does not disappear in vain.

The real mark left behind is not merely a link to an article, but a person slowly becoming honest, courageous, faithful, and a keeper of light.

Conclusion: Let Your Life Become an Article That Cannot Disappear

One day, many articles may be gone.

That is possible. It is also not the most important thing.

What matters more is that certain things do not disappear from our lives:

comfort,

courage,

hope,

and the small light once kindled in the dark.

Words may be scattered by the wind. Records may be covered by time. Platforms may continue to change.

But the marks left by the soul, honesty, courage, conviction, love, and hope, are a deeper and longer-lasting witness.

May our lives become articles that cannot be deleted.

当平台有限制

有时候，我觉得自己像在一座不断变化的城市里讲故事的人。

刚刚把摊子摆好，还没讲几句，就有人提醒：“这里不合适。”

于是，只能收起故事，换一个地方继续。

这几年，网络平台的规则不断变化，表达的空间也常常让人重新学习分寸。有些文章能够留下，有些文章很快消失。有些话刚刚说出口，就需要换一种方式再说。

这些经历让我慢慢明白：平台有平台的限度，算法有算法的逻辑，系统有系统的边界。

但属灵的声音，有它自己的路径。

它不只靠流量，也不只靠算法，更不只靠某一个平台。真正能继续前行的，是生命里那份不可熄灭的火。

一、限制来临时，我们才知道自己依靠什么

当文章无法留下时，我心里当然会有遗憾。

但情绪平复之后，我反而会被一个问题追问：

我究竟依靠什么？

是平台，还是那位赐我言语的主？

是点击量，还是心中不灭的呼召？

是被更多人看见，还是忠于所领受的托付？

限制来临，常常也是重新校准方向的时刻。

它像风浪中的航标，让人再次看清自己脚下真正的道路。

有时候，神使用那些被拿走的东西，提醒我们什么才是不能被拿走的。

二、门关上时，仍可能有别的路打开

当一个空间变窄时，人很容易以为前路已经堵死。

但后来我慢慢发现，有些限制不是终点，而是转弯。

有些关闭不是结束，而是引导。

有些失去不是否定，而是提醒我们：声音的路径，比我们想象的更丰富。

一篇文章不能留在这里，也许会以另一种方式被记住。

一段文字不能继续传播，也许会在某个读者心里继续发酵。

一个平台的门关上，神仍能在别处预备空间。

三、属灵的声音靠生命延续

回望这些年，我越来越相信：属灵的信息不是靠传播工具本身存活，而是靠生命的真实性。

文字若真实，就会有人记在心里。

经历若诚恳，就会有人从中得安慰。

光若来自神，就能穿透许多看得见和看不见的限制。

有人问我：“这样继续写，会不会很累？”

会。

但如果一个人心里有火，不表达也是一种痛苦。

如果神给了一个信息，不回应也是一种亏欠。

平台有页面的边界，却挡不住一个人心中燃烧的光。

四、限制让人谦卑，也让人勇敢

限制让我重新认识写作与服事。

它使人谦卑，因为我知道自己不是掌控者，不是英雄，只是被托付言语的人。

它也使人勇敢，因为我越来越明白，真正值得写的东西，不一定最安全，却常常最真实；真正该说的话，不取决于流量，而取决于呼召。

于是，我继续写，继续分享，继续牧养。

像一个在风里拿灯的人，不是因为风小，而是因为知道这光不是出于自己。

我只是拿着灯的人，不是光的源头。

结语：继续前行

平台会有边界，规则会有变化，路径也会不断调整。

但神的国度不会被数字墙围住。

只要真理仍在人心里燃烧，只要爱仍催促人说话，只要神仍呼召祂的百姓作见证，属灵的声音就总会找到继续前行的路。

所以，限制不是终点。

它只是提醒我们：不要把盼望放在平台上，而要放在那位引导道路的主身上。

English Version

When the Platform Has Limits

Sometimes I feel like a storyteller in a constantly changing city.

I have barely set up my place and begun to speak when someone reminds me, “This is not the right place.”

So I gather up the story and move somewhere else.

In recent years, the rules of online platforms have kept changing, and the space for expression has required continual discernment. Some articles remain. Some disappear quickly. Some words must be spoken again in another way.

These experiences have slowly taught me that platforms have limits. Algorithms have their own logic. Systems have their boundaries.

But a spiritual voice has its own path.

It does not depend only on traffic, algorithms, or one particular platform. What continues to move forward is the fire that cannot be extinguished within a life.

1. When Limitation Comes, We Discover What We Rely On

When an article cannot remain, I naturally feel disappointed.

But after my emotions settle, a deeper question begins to follow me:

What am I truly relying on?

A platform, or the Lord who gives me words?

Numbers, or the calling that keeps burning within?

Being seen by more people, or being faithful to what has been entrusted to me?

Limitation often becomes a moment of recalibration.

It is like a marker in the storm, helping us see again the road beneath our feet.

Sometimes God uses what is taken away to show us what cannot be taken away.

2. When One Door Closes, Another Path May Open

When a space becomes narrower, we may easily assume that the road ahead is blocked.

But I have slowly discovered that some limitations are not dead ends. They are turns in the road.

Some closed doors are not endings, but guidance.

Some losses are not rejection, but reminders that the path of a voice is richer than we imagined.

An article may not remain here, but it may be remembered in another way.

A piece of writing may not continue to circulate publicly, but it may continue to work quietly in a reader's heart.

When the door of one platform closes, God can still prepare space elsewhere.

3. Spiritual Voices Continue Through Life

Looking back over these years, I believe more and more that spiritual messages do not survive by communication tools alone. They survive through the authenticity of life.

If words are true, someone will remember them.

If an experience is sincere, someone will find comfort in it.

If the light comes from God, it can pass through many visible and invisible limitations.

Someone once asked me, "Isn't it tiring to keep writing like this?"

Yes, it is.

But if there is fire in a person's heart, not expressing it is also painful.

If God gives a message, refusing to respond is also a kind of loss.

A platform can limit a page, but it cannot limit the light burning in a person's heart.

4. Limitation Makes Us Humble and Brave

Limitation has reshaped how I understand writing and ministry.

It makes me humble, because I know I am not in control. I am not a hero. I am only a steward of words entrusted to me.

It also makes me brave, because I increasingly understand that what is truly worth writing is not always the safest thing, but often the truest thing. What must be said is not determined by traffic, but by calling.

So I continue to write, share, and shepherd.

Like someone holding a lamp in the wind, not because the wind is weak, but because I know the light does not come from me.

I am only the lamp bearer, not the source of the light.

Conclusion: Keep Moving Forward

Platforms have boundaries. Rules change. Paths must often be adjusted.

But the kingdom of God is not enclosed by digital walls.

As long as truth continues to burn in human hearts, as long as love continues to compel speech, and as long as God continues to call His people to bear witness, a spiritual voice will always find a way forward.

Limitation is not the end.

It simply reminds us not to place our hope in a platform, but in the Lord who guides the road.

当真理沉默时：守住心里的微光

有些沉默，不是没有声音。

而是声音还在，心却开始犹豫。

有些真理，不是无人知道。

而是知道的人，开始学习怎样更谨慎、更温柔、更有智慧地说。

当真理沉默时，人最容易产生两种反应：一种是愤怒，想用更大的声音冲开局面；另一种是灰心，觉得既然说了也未必留下，不如从此不说。

但信仰给我们的路，常常不是这两种极端。

它呼召我们在沉默中守住清醒，在限制中守住良知，在黑暗中守住微光。

一、沉默不一定是失败

我们常常以为，真理必须用响亮的方式出现，才算得胜。

但圣经里，真理有时是雷霆，有时也是细小的声音；有时站在广场上宣告，有时藏在一个人的良心里发光。

沉默不一定等于失败。

有时候，沉默是等待。

有时候，沉默是孕育。

有时候，沉默是神让一个人先被炼净，然后再开口。

真正需要警醒的是：沉默有没有让我们失去真理？有没有让我们对不义变得习惯？有没有让我们把良心的提醒一点点调低？

如果沉默只是暂时的等待，它可能成为更深表达的预备。

但如果沉默变成心灵的麻木，就需要被唤醒。

二、真理不是用来攻击人的武器

当我们觉得真理被忽略时，很容易把真理变成武器。

我们开始急着证明自己是对的，急着指出别人是错的，也急着把复杂的人和事过快划入简单的阵营。

可是，真理若离开爱，就会变得冰冷。

真理若离开谦卑，就会变成骄傲。

真理若离开怜悯，就可能伤害本来需要被医治的人。

主耶稣说：

“我就是道路、真理、生命。”（约 14:6，和合本）

真理首先不是一个口号，而是一位主。

所以，守住真理，不只是守住一套说法，更是活在基督的生命里。

当我们说真理时，语气也要被真理塑造；当我们坚持立场时，心也要被基督管理。

三、微光也是光

人总希望自己能成为一道强光，照亮很多人。

但在某些时刻，神只托付我们守住一盏小灯。

那盏灯也许只是一次诚实的祷告。

也许是一篇不够显眼的文字。

也许是在家庭中仍然坚持温柔。

也许是在教会中继续服事。

也许是在心里对自己说：“我不要让苦涩掌管我。”

微光看起来不壮观，却很真实。

在黑暗中，最先让人看见方向的，常常不是远方的太阳，而是身边那一点没有熄灭的灯。

四、守住良知，不让心变暗

当真理沉默时，最重要的不是证明自己仍然有话可说，而是守住良知。

良知是神放在人里面的提醒。

它让我们在不容易说话的时候，仍然知道什么不该放弃；在看似无能为力的时候，仍然知道什么需要坚持；在别人都习惯黑暗的时候，仍然不把黑暗称为光。

保罗说：

“我因此自己勉励，对神对人，常存无亏的良心。”（徒 24:16，和合本）

无亏的良心，不是完美无缺，而是不让自己故意背叛所知道的真。

一个人的声音也许有限，但若良心仍然清醒，他就还没有失败。

五、等候不是放弃

有些话，不是今天说不出来，就永远不能说。

有些门，不是今天没有打开，就永远不会打开。

有些种子，不是今天没有发芽，就代表已经死去。

等候不是放弃。

等候是把时间交给神。

等候是让愤怒沉淀为智慧。

等候是让冲动变成更深的祷告。

等候也是相信：神看见一切，也知道什么时候该让什么发出声音。

结语：让微光继续亮着

当真理沉默时，不要急着让自己被黑暗定义。

也不要急着让愤怒替你说话。

更不要让灰心偷走你里面那一点光。

愿我们在不能大声的时候，仍然诚实；

在不能完全表达的时候，仍然清醒；

在环境复杂的时候，仍然温柔；

在道路漫长的时候，仍然守住良知。

因为微光也是光。

只要它还亮着，黑暗就没有完全得胜。

English Version

When Truth Falls Silent

Keeping the Small Light Within

Some silence does not mean there is no voice.

It means the voice is still there, but the heart has begun to hesitate.

Some truth is not unknown.

It is known, but those who know it are learning how to speak with greater care, gentleness, and wisdom.

When truth seems silent, people often react in one of two ways. Some become angry and want to force a way through with a louder voice. Others become discouraged and think, “If speaking does not change anything, perhaps it is better to stop.”

But faith often gives us a third way.

It calls us to remain awake in silence, to keep conscience under limitation, and to guard a small light in the dark.

1. Silence Is Not Always Failure

We often assume that truth must appear loudly in order to be victorious.

But in Scripture, truth sometimes comes like thunder, and sometimes like a gentle whisper. Sometimes it is proclaimed in public. Sometimes it shines quietly in a person’s conscience.

Silence is not always failure.

Sometimes silence is waiting.

Sometimes silence is formation.

Sometimes silence is the place where God purifies a person before giving that person words again.

The real question is this: Has silence caused us to lose truth? Has it made us accustomed to what is wrong? Has it caused us to lower the voice of conscience little by little?

If silence is temporary waiting, it may become preparation for deeper expression.

But if silence becomes numbness of the soul, then it must be awakened.

2. Truth Is Not a Weapon for Attacking People

When we feel that truth has been ignored, we can easily turn truth into a weapon.

We become eager to prove that we are right, to show that others are wrong, and to divide complex people and situations into simple camps.

But truth without love becomes cold.

Truth without humility becomes pride.

Truth without mercy can wound those who need healing.

Jesus said:

"Jesus said to him, 'I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father, except through me.'" (John 14:6, WEB)

Truth is not first a slogan, but the living Lord.

Therefore, guarding truth is not only guarding a set of words. It is living in the life of Christ.

When we speak truth, our tone must also be shaped by truth. When we hold a position, our hearts must also be governed by Christ.

3. A Small Light Is Still Light

People often want to become a great light that shines upon many.

But in certain seasons, God entrusts us only with a small lamp.

That lamp may be an honest prayer.

It may be a quiet piece of writing.

It may be the choice to remain gentle at home.

It may be continuing to serve in the church.

It may be saying within the heart, "I will not let bitterness rule me."

A small light may not look impressive, but it is real.

In darkness, the first thing that helps a person see the way is often not the distant sun, but the small lamp nearby that has not gone out.

4. Keep Conscience Clear, and Do Not Let the Heart Grow Dark

When truth seems silent, the most important thing is not proving that we still have something to say. It is keeping conscience clear.

Conscience is one of the reminders God places within us.

It helps us know what must not be abandoned when speaking is difficult. It helps us know what must be held when we feel powerless. It keeps us from calling darkness light simply because others have become used to the dark.

Paul said:

"In this I also practice always having a conscience void of offense toward God and men." (Acts 24:16, WEB)

A clear conscience does not mean perfection. It means refusing to knowingly betray what one has come to understand as true.

A person's voice may be limited, but if the conscience remains awake, that person has not failed.

5. Waiting Is Not Giving Up

Some words cannot be spoken today, but that does not mean they can never be spoken.

Some doors are not open today, but that does not mean they will never open.

Some seeds have not yet sprouted, but that does not mean they have died.

Waiting is not giving up.

Waiting is entrusting time to God.

Waiting lets anger settle into wisdom.

Waiting turns impulse into deeper prayer.

Waiting also believes that God sees all things and knows when a voice should be heard.

Conclusion: Let the Small Light Keep Burning

When truth seems silent, do not let darkness define you too quickly.

Do not let anger speak for you.

Do not let discouragement steal the small light within.

May we remain honest when we cannot speak loudly.

May we remain awake when we cannot express everything.

May we remain gentle when circumstances are complicated.

May we keep conscience when the road is long.

For a small light is still light.

As long as it continues to burn, darkness has not fully won.

当声音被压低：灵魂如何保持清晰与自由？

有些时候，声音不是一下子消失的。

它是慢慢变小的。

起初，你只是少说一句。

后来，你开始换一种说法。

再后来，你发现自己在开口之前，已经先学会了计算。

这时，真正需要警醒的，不只是外面的限制，而是里面的变化。

因为一个人的声音被压低，并不一定立刻伤害他的灵魂；更需要警醒的是，灵魂也可能跟着变得混乱、恐惧、苦涩，甚至慢慢失去自由。

一、声音变小的时候，心容易变乱

当一个人发现有些话不容易说出口时，心里常常会出现几种反应。

第一，是委屈。

“为什么明明是真实的，却不能直接说？”

第二，是愤怒。

“为什么表达一件事，也要如此小心？”

第三，是疲惫。

“既然如此，那就算了吧。”

这些反应都是真实的。

但若不被带到神面前，它们就可能在心里发酵，变成怨恨、讽刺、冷漠，甚至让人对人性 and 世界彻底失望。

所以，当声音被压低时，第一件要守住的，不是音量，而是心。

二、清晰，不等于尖锐

很多人误以为，若要保持清晰，就必须变得尖锐。

其实不一定。

清晰是一种内在分辨，尖锐却常常是一种情绪反击。

清晰的人知道什么是真，什么是假；什么该坚持，什么可以等待；什么需要说，什么需要换一种方式说。

他不轻易被恐惧带走，也不轻易被怒气支配。

圣经说：

“你们必晓得真理，真理必叫你们得以自由。”（约 8:32，和合本）

这里的自由，不只是外在环境的宽阔，更是里面不被谎言、惧怕和怨恨捆绑。

真正清晰的人，即使声音不大，灵魂仍然站得稳。

三、自由，不是想说什么就说什么

我们常把自由理解为：我想说什么，就能说什么。

当然，表达的空间很宝贵。

但属灵意义上的自由，比这更深。

自由不是任性，不是发泄，也不是把所有情绪直接倒给世界。

自由是：即使我不能按自己想要的方式说话，我仍不被惧怕控制；即使我必须选择更有智慧的表达，我仍不出卖心里的真实；即使环境要求我放低声音，我仍不让灵魂向黑暗低头。

一个人若只能在顺境中真实，那还不是真正的自由。

真正的自由，是在限制中仍然不失去自己。

四、温柔，是更深的刚强

声音被压低之后，人很容易走向两个极端。

一种是沉默到麻木。

另一种是愤怒到失控。

但信仰给我们第三条路：温柔而坚定。

温柔不是退缩。

温柔是不让伤害塑造自己的语气。

坚定不是强硬。

坚定是不让压力改变自己的方向。

主耶稣在许多时候没有用人的方式争辩，但祂从未失去真理；祂没有被仇恨吞没，却也没有向黑暗妥协。

这就是温柔中的刚强。

五、让生命替声音继续说话

当声音不能放大时，生命就更要真实。

你如何对待家人，是一种声音。

你如何面对受伤，是一种声音。

你如何在限制中仍然祷告、服事、写作、陪伴人，也是一种声音。

有时候，一篇文章无法留下，但一个人的生命仍然可以继续作见证。

有时候，一句话不能被广泛传播，但一个稳定、诚实、温柔的人，本身就是一篇被神写出来的文字。

平台可能限制内容，却不能限制一个人真实地活。

结语：声音可以变小，灵魂不要变暗

声音被压低，并不意味着光已经熄灭。

它只是提醒我们，要更加认真地守住里面的灯。

愿我们在不能大声的时候，仍然保持清晰；

在需要等待的时候，仍然保持自由；

在容易愤怒的时候，仍然保持温柔；

在许多事情无法掌控的时候，仍然相信神掌管道路。

声音可以变小。

但灵魂不要变暗。

因为真正的光，不只在声音里，也在生命里。

English Version

When the Voice Is Lowered Again

Keeping the Soul Clear and Free

Sometimes a voice does not disappear all at once.

It becomes smaller little by little.

At first, you simply say one sentence less.

Later, you begin to say things in another way.

Eventually, before you speak, you have already learned to calculate.

At that moment, what needs attention is not only the limitation outside us, but the change within us.

When a person's voice is lowered, the soul is not necessarily harmed immediately. What requires deeper attention is that the soul may become confused, fearful, bitter, and gradually lose its freedom.

1. When the Voice Grows Quiet, the Heart Can Become Noisy

When a person discovers that certain words are not easy to say, several reactions often rise within the heart.

The first is hurt.

“Why can something true not be said plainly?”

The second is anger.

“Why must even expression require such caution?”

The third is weariness.

“If this is how it is, then perhaps I should stop.”

These reactions are real.

But if they are not brought before God, they can ferment inside the heart and become resentment, sarcasm, coldness, or even despair toward people and the world.

So when the voice is lowered, the first thing to guard is not volume, but the heart.

2. Clarity Is Not the Same as Sharpness

Many people assume that to remain clear, one must become sharp.

That is not necessarily true.

Clarity is inward discernment. Sharpness is often emotional reaction.

A clear person knows what is true and what is false; what must be held firmly and what can wait; what needs to be said and what may need to be said in another way.

Such a person is not easily carried away by fear, nor easily ruled by anger.

Scripture says:

"You will know the truth, and the truth will make you free." (John 8:32, WEB)

This freedom is not only an outward widening of circumstances. It is also the inward freedom of not being bound by lies, fear, or resentment.

A truly clear person may not speak loudly, but the soul still stands firm.

3. Freedom Is Not Saying Whatever We Want

We often define freedom as being able to say whatever we want.

The space to speak is indeed precious.

But spiritual freedom goes deeper.

Freedom is not self-will. It is not venting. It is not pouring every emotion directly into the world.

Freedom means that even when I cannot speak in the way I wish, I am not controlled by fear. Even when I must choose wiser language, I do not betray what is true in my heart. Even when circumstances require my voice to be lower, I do not let my soul bow to darkness.

If a person can be true only when life is easy, that is not yet true freedom.

True freedom is remaining oneself even within limitation.

4. Gentleness Is a Deeper Strength

When the voice is lowered, people can easily move toward two extremes.

One is silence that becomes numbness.

The other is anger that becomes loss of control.

Faith gives us a third way: gentleness with firmness.

Gentleness is not retreat.

It means refusing to let injury shape the tone of the soul.

Firmness is not harshness.

It means refusing to let pressure change one's direction.

Jesus did not always argue in the way people expected, yet He never lost truth. He was not swallowed by hatred, yet He never compromised with darkness.

This is strength within gentleness.

5. Let Life Continue Speaking

When the voice cannot be amplified, life must become more real.

How you treat your family is a voice.

How you face hurt is a voice.

How you continue to pray, serve, write, and accompany others within limitation is also a voice.

Sometimes an article cannot remain, but a person's life can continue to bear witness.

Sometimes a sentence cannot spread widely, but a steady, honest, gentle person becomes a text written by God.

A platform may limit content, but it cannot limit a person from living truthfully.

Conclusion: The Voice May Grow Smaller, but the Soul Must Not Grow Dark

When the voice is lowered, it does not mean the light has gone out.

It reminds us to guard the lamp within more carefully.

May we remain clear when we cannot speak loudly.

May we remain free when we must wait.

May we remain gentle when anger feels near.

May we still believe that God guides the road when many things are beyond our control.

The voice may grow smaller.

But the soul must not grow dark.

For true light lives not only in the voice, but also in the life.

第二辑：信仰不是口号，而是生命

信仰不是工具，是关系

我们这个时代，有太多工具。导航帮我们找路，搜索引擎帮我们找答案，信用卡帮我们延后付款，人工智能帮我们整理文字、处理信息，甚至替我们思考一部分问题。

久而久之，我们也容易把信仰当成一种“灵性工具”：生病时求医，遇难时求助，考试前求顺利，签证时求通过。人生一有问题，就把信仰拿出来用一用。

可是，信仰若只是“有用”，它就不过是一根临时的拐杖。真正的信仰，从来不是工具，而是关系。它不是我们需要时才打开的应用程序，而是一段真实、活着、持续同行的关系。

一、工具用来解决问题，关系陪你面对问题

工具的价值在于效率。有用，就拿出来；没用，就收起来。

但关系不是这样。关系并不总是立刻解决问题，却在问题中陪你走下去。

当你孤独时，信仰不一定立刻拿走孤独，却会让你知道：你不是一个人。当你受苦时，信仰不一定马上改变环境，却会在痛苦里给你一种深处的托住。当你无路可走时，信仰不一定马上打开所有门，却会在黑暗中保留一盏微光。

真正的信仰，不是许诺一个没有问题的人生，而是应许人在所有问题中仍然被看见、被扶持、被爱。

二、工具靠使用，关系靠信任

工具用久了会老旧，方法用多了会失效。

但关系因信任而加深，因时间而丰厚，因共同走过风雨而更加真实。

信仰不是我们每次出问题时才拿出来修补人生。它是在风平浪静的时候，也愿意与神同行；是在没有特别需要的时候，也愿意亲近祂；是在生活看似普通的时候，也知道自己仍然活在祂的恩典之中。

信仰最深的地方，不是“它能帮我得到什么”，而是“我愿意把自己交托给谁”。

三、工具求效率，关系需要时间

工具追求立竿见影，关系却需要日积月累。

真正的信仰之路，不是一夜之间解决所有人生难题，而是一年一年，在起落、等待、失败和更新中，看见生命慢慢被改变。

有时候，信仰不是让你马上明白答案，而是让你学会在尚未明白的时候，仍然不离开。

结语：珍惜这份同行

信仰不是你人生的备用钥匙，也不是你情绪低谷时的止痛药。它是你心中最深的归属，是你灵魂最真实的交谈对象，是你疲惫时的安慰，也是你喜乐时的感恩。

愿我们经历的，不是一套灵性的操作系统，而是一位愿意与我们同行的主。

别只把信仰当作工具。让它成为一段活着的、真实的关系。

English Version

Faith Is Not a Tool, but a Relationship

We live in an age filled with tools. Navigation apps help us find our way. Search engines help us find answers. Credit cards help us delay payment. Artificial intelligence helps us organize words, process information, and even think through certain questions for us.

Over time, we may begin to treat faith in the same way: as a kind of spiritual tool. When we are sick, we seek healing. When we are in trouble, we ask for help. Before an exam, we pray for success. During an immigration process, we pray for approval. Whenever life runs into a problem, we take faith out and try to use it.

But if faith is merely useful, then it is nothing more than a temporary crutch. True faith is not a tool. It is a relationship. It is not an app we open only when we need it. It is a living, real, ongoing relationship of companionship.

1. A Tool Solves Problems; a Relationship Walks with You Through Them

The value of a tool lies in efficiency. If it is useful, we take it out. If it is not useful, we put it away.

But relationships do not work that way. A relationship may not solve a problem immediately, but it stays with you while you face it.

When you are lonely, faith may not instantly remove your loneliness, but it reminds you that you are not alone. When you suffer, faith may not immediately change your circumstances, but it gives you a deep sense of being held. When there seems to be no way forward, faith may not open every door at once, but it keeps a small light burning in the dark.

True faith does not promise a life without problems. It promises that, within every problem, you are still seen, sustained, and loved.

2. A Tool Depends on Use; a Relationship Depends on Trust

Tools grow old with use. Methods eventually lose their effect.

Relationships are different. They deepen through trust, become richer through time, and grow more real through storms walked together.

Faith is not something we take out only when our lives need repair. It is walking with God when the waters are calm, drawing near to Him when there is no urgent need, and knowing, even in ordinary days, that we are still living under His grace.

The deepest question of faith is not, “What can it help me get?” but, “To whom am I willing to entrust myself?”

3. A Tool Seeks Efficiency; a Relationship Takes Time

Tools seek immediate results. Relationships require daily growth.

The journey of faith does not solve every life problem overnight. Year after year, through rises and falls, waiting, failure, and renewal, faith slowly changes a life.

Sometimes, faith does not give you the answer right away. It teaches you not to leave while you are still waiting to understand.

Conclusion: Treasure This Companionship

Faith is not the spare key of your life. It is not a painkiller for your emotional low points. It is your deepest belonging, the truest conversation of your soul, your comfort in weariness, and your gratitude in joy.

May what we experience not be a spiritual operating system, but the Lord who walks with us.

Do not merely use faith as a tool. Let it become a living and genuine relationship.

信仰不是任务，而是旅程

有些人把信仰当成一张任务清单，一项一项勾选：礼拜天去聚会了吗？今天祷告了吗？这周读经了吗？奉献交了吗？

这些事都做完了，心里却仍然空落落的，像交了工却没人收货，也像走了很远的山路，却从来没有抬头看过风景。

我也曾以为，信仰就是完成一堆规定动作。后来才慢慢明白，信仰其实是一段路。一步一个脚印，走着走着，人认识了自己，也看见了天光。

一、任务可以安排，旅程却充满未知

任务像打卡，清清楚楚，按部就班。

旅程却不一样。旅程会遇到岔路、暴雨、等待、误解，也会遇到突然出现的人和意想不到的恩典。

有一段时间，我的人生像被节奏压着往前走，生怕一步走偏，结果心越走越紧。

直到后来，我经历了一个突如其来的巨变。儿子像天边的云，轻轻来了，又轻轻走了。那一刻，我才明白，这条信仰的路，不是我在主导，而是我在被带领。

任务让人以为自己可以掌控。旅程却教人承认：我需要被引导。

二、任务让人紧张，旅程让人成长

做任务，是为了交差。走旅程，是为了成长。

有些人信得久了，热情淡了，留下的只是惯性。每天例行公事，却忘了起初为什么出发。这样的信仰，容易让人疲惫。

但一个旅人，即便风尘仆仆，眼里仍然可以有光，因为他知道前方还有希望，还有方向。他也许脚疼，心乱，累得想放弃，但只要仍然向前，每一步就都不是白走。

旅程不会让每一天都精彩，却会让每一步都有意义。

三、旅程不在乎速度，而在乎方向

我曾在黄昏时一个人走过山间。脚下的路并不清楚，心里却知道方向。

信仰也像这样。你不必走得比别人快，也不必每一步都显得漂亮，但你要知道自己正朝哪里走。

任务式的信仰只问：“我做完了吗？”旅程式的信仰却问：“我正在变成谁？”

前者关心完成度，后者关心生命。前者让人焦虑，后者让人谦卑。

结语：慢一点，别急着完成你的信仰

亲爱的朋友，不要把信仰只当成每天必须完成的任务清单。把它看作你生命中的旅程地图。

这旅程中有花，有泪，有路人，有岔路，也有风景。更重要的是，有一位看不见却真实的同行者。祂不催你，也不放弃你。祂陪着你，直到你走出一个更真实的自己。

信仰不是目的地，而是过程。不是高举标语，而是一步一脚印地生活。

English Version

Faith Is Not a Task, but a Journey

Some people treat faith like a checklist, marking off one item after another: Did I attend worship on Sunday? Did I pray today? Did I read Scripture this week? Did I give my offering?

When all these things are done, the heart can still feel strangely empty, like work submitted but never received, or like someone who has walked a long mountain road without ever lifting his eyes to see the view.

I once thought faith was the completion of a set of required actions. Only later did I begin to understand that faith is a road. Step by step, as we walk, we come to know ourselves, and we begin to see light breaking in.

1. A Task Can Be Scheduled; a Journey Is Full of the Unknown

A task is like checking in. It is clear, orderly, and manageable.

A journey is different. A journey includes crossroads, storms, waiting, misunderstanding, unexpected people, and surprising grace.

There was a season when my life felt pressed forward by a rhythm I could not escape. I was afraid of taking a wrong step, and my heart grew tighter and tighter.

Then I experienced a sudden and life-changing loss. My son came like a cloud on the horizon, and then he quietly departed. In that moment, I realized that this journey of faith was not something I controlled. I was being led.

Tasks make us think we are in control. Journeys teach us to admit that we need guidance.

2. A Task Creates Pressure; a Journey Forms Us

A task is done in order to be completed. A journey is walked in order to be formed.

Some people have believed for many years, but their passion has faded, leaving only habit. They continue the routine, but forget why they began. That kind of faith easily becomes exhausting.

But a traveler, even covered in dust, can still have light in his eyes because he knows there is hope and direction ahead. His feet may hurt. His heart may be confused. He may feel so tired that he wants to give up. But as long as he keeps moving forward, no step is wasted.

A journey does not make every day exciting, but it can make every step meaningful.

3. A Journey Is Not About Speed, but Direction

I once walked alone through the hills at dusk. The path beneath my feet was not always clear, but my heart knew the direction.

Faith is like that. You do not have to walk faster than others. Every step does not have to look graceful. But you must know where you are going.

Task-based faith asks, “Have I finished?” Journey-shaped faith asks, “Who am I becoming?”

The first is concerned with completion. The second is concerned with life. The first makes us anxious. The second makes us humble.

Conclusion: Slow Down; Do Not Rush to Complete Your Faith

Dear friend, do not reduce faith to a daily checklist. See it as a map for the journey of your life.

Along this journey there are flowers and tears, strangers and companions, crossroads and scenery. Most importantly, there is an unseen but real Companion. He does not rush you, and He does not abandon you. He walks with you until you become more truly yourself.

Faith is not merely a destination. It is a process. It is not a slogan lifted high, but a life walked step by step.

第三辑：在有限中认清自己

嫉妒：骨中的朽烂

圣经对嫉妒的描述，从来不是轻描淡写的负面情绪，而是一种能够腐蚀灵魂与关系的毒素。

它不像愤怒那样爆炸式释放，也不像骄傲那样张扬高调。嫉妒常常安静、隐秘、难以承认，却足以让人心枯干，使关系分裂，让灵命衰弱。

圣经说：

“心中安静，是肉体的生命；嫉妒是骨中的朽烂。”（箴 14:30，和合本）

嫉妒最危险的地方在于，它往往不是从远方的敌人而来，而是生长在最熟悉的关系之中：家人、朋友、同事、同工，以及那些与我们最接近、最相似的人。

一、祭司长为何要钉耶稣？不是因为真理，而是因为嫉妒

在耶稣被审判时，马太福音这样记载：

“巡抚原知道，他们是因为嫉妒才把他解了来。”（太 27:18，和合本）

这些宗教领袖外表敬虔，口中满是律法与敬拜的语言，但他们的心却被嫉妒吞噬。

耶稣的智慧、能力、吸引力和影响力，让他们心中燃起暗火。不是因为祂做错了什么，而是因为祂做得太好了。

嫉妒往往不是因为别人犯错，而是因为别人比我做得好、走得快、被人看重。它无法忍受一个问题：为什么神这样祝福别人，却没有这样祝福我？

这正是人灵魂深处最隐秘也最真实的挣扎。

二、嫉妒总是在最熟悉的人中产生

嫉妒很少对遥不可及的人产生。它往往扎根在熟悉又接近的关系里。

约瑟的哥哥嫉妒他的梦，结果将他卖到埃及。扫罗嫉妒大卫击败歌利亚，开始用枪追杀。该隐嫉妒神看中亚伯的献祭，最终杀了亲弟弟。宗教领袖嫉妒耶稣吸引众人，最终将祂交出去钉十字架。

嫉妒不是单纯对别人拥有的东西不满，而是对神给别人的安排无法释怀。

嫉妒的深处，其实是不信神的主权。它在心里悄悄质问：“神啊，你公平吗？”

三、嫉妒破坏的不只是关系，更是灵命

嫉妒的破坏力，不只是让人与人的关系恶化，更会使人的灵性慢慢衰败。

它让人无法感恩，无法安静，无法真心欣赏别人，也无法诚实面对自己。

我们越嫉妒，就越远离满足。我们越盯着别人，就越失去与神的连接。

嫉妒最终会使人走向毁灭性的行动：说话伤人、拉帮结派、贬低他人，甚至用属灵语言掩饰不属灵的动力。

四、如何胜过嫉妒？

第一，承认嫉妒是罪，而不只是“心情不好”。

不要合理化嫉妒。它不是成熟的人际反应，而是灵命的警钟。一句诚实的祷告，可以成为释放的开始：“主啊，我嫉妒他，请赦免我。”

第二，感恩神给别人的，也感恩神给自己的。

神的恩典不是分蛋糕，别人多一点，我就少一点。祂是无限的供应者。能真心欣赏别人，是属灵成熟的开始。

第三，信靠神的时间与道路。

也许今天你还没有被看见，还没有开花结果，还没有走到理想的位置。但神没有忘记你。

“神造万物，各按其时成为美好。”（传 3:11，和合本）

第四，为你嫉妒的人祷告，祝福他们。

这不是讽刺，而是真实的属灵操练。当你真心为那个人祝福，嫉妒的毒根就开始被拔除。

五、结语：脱去嫉妒，穿上基督

保罗说：

“但现在你们要弃绝这一切的事，以及恼恨、忿怒、恶毒、毁谤……所以你们既是神的选民，圣洁蒙爱的人，就要存怜悯、恩慈、谦虚、温柔、忍耐的心。”（西 3:8、12，和合本）

嫉妒属于旧人，爱属于新人。嫉妒是罪性的暗流，合一是圣灵的工作。我们不能同时活在嫉妒与爱中。

愿我们脱去嫉妒，穿上基督。在神所分给我们的位置上，忠心、感恩、喜乐。如此，我们的灵魂才不至朽烂，我们的关系才有医治的可能，教会也才能满有恩典与合一。

English Version

Envy: Rot in the Bones

Scripture never treats envy as a harmless negative emotion. It describes envy as something that can corrode the soul and poison relationships.

It does not explode like anger. It does not announce itself like pride. Envy is often quiet, hidden, and difficult to admit. Yet it can dry up the heart, divide relationships, and weaken the soul.

Scripture says:

"The life of the body is a heart at peace, but envy rots the bones." (Proverbs 14:30, WEB)

The danger of envy is that it often does not come from distant enemies. It grows among the most familiar relationships: family, friends, colleagues, coworkers, and those who are closest and most similar to us.

1. Why Did the Chief Priests Hand Jesus Over? Not Because of Truth, but Because of Envy

When Jesus was being judged, Matthew records:

"For he knew that because of envy they had delivered him up." (Matthew 27:18, WEB)

These religious leaders appeared devout. Their mouths were full of the language of law and worship. Yet their hearts were being consumed by envy.

Jesus' wisdom, power, attraction, and influence stirred a hidden fire within them. It was not because He had done wrong, but because He had done too well.

Envy often does not arise because someone else has sinned. It arises because someone else is doing better, moving faster, or receiving more attention. It cannot bear the question: Why has God blessed that person in this way, but not me?

This is one of the most hidden and honest struggles of the human soul.

2. Envy Grows Among Those Closest to Us

Envy rarely forms toward people who are completely beyond our reach. It usually takes root in relationships that are familiar and close.

Joseph's brothers envied his dreams and sold him into Egypt. Saul envied David after he defeated Goliath and began to pursue him with a spear. Cain envied Abel because God accepted Abel's offering and killed his own brother. The religious leaders envied Jesus because the crowds were drawn to Him, and they handed Him over to be crucified.

At its deepest level, envy is a failure to trust God's sovereignty. It quietly asks, "God, are You fair?"

3. Envy Damages Not Only Relationships, but the Soul

The destructive power of envy is not limited to human relationships. It also slowly weakens the spiritual life.

It makes us unable to give thanks, unable to be still, unable to sincerely appreciate others, and unable to face ourselves honestly.

The more we envy, the farther we move from contentment. The more we fix our eyes on others, the more we lose connection with God.

In the end, envy can lead to destructive actions: wounding words, factions, belittling others, and even using spiritual language to hide unspiritual motives.

4. How Can We Overcome Envy?

First, admit that envy is sin, not merely a bad mood.

Do not rationalize envy. It is not a mature relational response. It is a warning sign in the soul. An honest prayer can become the beginning of freedom: "Lord, I envy him. Please forgive me."

Second, give thanks for what God has given to others, and for what God has given to you.

God's grace is not a cake divided into limited portions. If someone else receives more, it does not mean you receive less. He is the infinite Giver.

Third, trust God's timing and path.

Perhaps today you have not yet been seen. Perhaps you have not yet borne fruit. Perhaps you have not yet arrived where you hoped to be. But God has not forgotten you.

"He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in their hearts, yet so that man can't find out the work that God has done from the beginning even to the end." (Ecclesiastes 3:11, WEB)

Fourth, pray for the person you envy and bless them.

This is real spiritual practice. When you sincerely bless that person, the poisonous root of envy begins to be pulled out.

5. Conclusion: Put Off Envy and Put On Christ

Paul writes:

"but now you must put them all away: anger, wrath, malice, slander, and shameful speaking out of your mouth. Put on therefore, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved, a heart of compassion, kindness, lowliness, humility, and perseverance;" (Colossians 3:8, 12, WEB)

Envy belongs to the old self. Love belongs to the new self. Envy is an undercurrent of sin. Unity is the work of the Holy Spirit.

May we put off envy and put on Christ. May we be faithful, grateful, and joyful in the place God has assigned to us. Then our souls will not rot, our relationships may be healed, and the church can be filled with grace and unity.

渺小与短暂：从宇宙到永恒的省思

夜空像一幅无边的画卷，银河静静横亘。

科学告诉我们，光速是宇宙中最快的速度，每秒约三十万公里。然而，即便以光速飞行，横跨银河系也需要大约十万年。而在可观测宇宙中，像银河系这样的星系至少有数千亿个。这还可能只是冰山一角。

在如此浩瀚的宇宙面前，人又算什么呢？

地球已有约四十五亿年的历史，而人的一生，不过七八十年。放在宇宙的时间轴上，仿佛清晨的一缕雾气，阳光一照，就消散不见。

雅各书提醒我们：

“其实明天如何，你们还不知道。你们的生命是什么呢？你们原来是一片云雾，出现少时就不见了。”（雅 4:14，和合本）

然而，令人惊奇的是，在这浩瀚无垠的宇宙中，圣经宣告：创造神地的神竟然顾念我们。

一、宇宙的宏大与人的渺小

大卫在诗篇中仰望夜空，发出这样的惊叹：

“我观看你指头所造的天，并你所陈设的月亮星宿，便说：人算什么，你竟顾念他？世人算什么，你竟眷顾他？”（诗 8:3-4，和合本）

今天，随着科学的发展，我们更能体会这句话的重量。

地球不过是太阳系中的一颗行星，太阳也只是银河系中的一颗恒星，而银河系只是宇宙中无数星系之一。

如果没有信仰，人很容易在这样的事实面前陷入虚无，觉得生命微不足道。

但诗篇 8 篇告诉我们：宏大的宇宙并不否定人的价值，反而凸显人的尊贵。因为创造宇宙的神，竟然亲自顾念我们。

二、时间的流逝与生命的短暂

除了空间的浩瀚，时间也显出人的有限。

摩西在诗篇中祷告：

“我们一生的年日是七十岁，若是强壮可到八十岁；但其中所矜夸的，不过是劳苦愁烦，转眼成空，我们便如飞而去。”（诗 90:10，和合本）

科学的语言称之为有限，圣经的语言称之为转眼成空。

但摩西在同一篇诗中也为我们指明方向：

“求你指教我们怎样数算自己的日子，好叫我们得着智慧的心。”（诗 90:12，和合本）

生命短暂，并不是绝望的理由，而是得智慧的呼召。

三、永恒的盼望与人的价值

如果只看宇宙的浩瀚和时间的无情，人的生命似乎渺小到微不足道。

但圣经告诉我们：人的价值不在于他在宇宙中占据多少空间，也不在于他能活多少年，而在于创造天地的神如何看待他。

诗篇继续说：

“你叫他比天使微小一点，并赐他荣耀尊贵为冠冕。”（诗 8:5，和合本）

这种价值的高峰，在耶稣基督里被完全显明。祂进入有限的时空，成为有血有肉的人，以永恒的爱为世人开了一条通向永生的道路。

约翰福音说：

“神爱世人，甚至将他的独生子赐给他们，叫一切信他的，不至灭亡，反得永生。”（约 3:16，和合本）

宇宙再大，时光再长，我们在神面前却不是虚无的。

四、如何在短暂中活出意义

当我们认识到自己的渺小与短暂，这不是让人绝望的宣告，而是一个呼召：让我们在短暂的岁月里，把目光转向永恒。

第一，敬畏神。认识自己的有限，才会敬畏那位无限的主。箴言说：“敬畏耶和华是智慧的开端。”（箴言 9:10，和合本）

第二，数算日子。我们不能改变生命的长度，却可以决定生命的深度。

第三，怀抱永恒的盼望。人的渺小不是终局，因为神在基督里赐下永生的应许。

结语：从渺小到尊贵

宇宙浩瀚无垠，时间如江河般流逝不返。若只凭人自身，我们确实像一粒尘埃，转瞬即逝。

但在神的眼中，我们却是祂所宝贵的创造，是祂在万有中亲自顾念的对象。

所以，当你仰望星空，不要只是叹息自己的渺小，也要记得：那位创造星空的主，正在低头看顾你。

English Version

Small and Brief: From the Universe to Eternity

The night sky is like a boundless canvas, with the Milky Way stretched quietly across it.

Science tells us that light travels at about 300,000 kilometers per second. Yet even at the speed of light, it would take about 100,000 years to cross the Milky Way. In the observable universe, there are at least hundreds of billions of galaxies like our own, and even that may be only the edge of what exists.

Before such vastness, what is a human being?

The earth is about 4.5 billion years old. A human life may last seventy or eighty years. On the timeline of the universe, it is like morning mist, appearing briefly and then vanishing in the sun.

James reminds us:

"Yet you don't know what your life will be like tomorrow. For what is your life? For you are a vapor that appears for a little time and then vanishes away." (James 4:14, WEB)

And yet, Scripture declares something astonishing: the God who created the heavens and the earth cares for us.

1. The Vastness of the Universe and the Smallness of Humanity

David looked at the night sky and cried out:

"When I consider your heavens, the work of your fingers, the moon and the stars, which you have ordained, what is man, that you think of him? What is the son of man, that you care for him?" (Psalm 8:3-4, WEB)

Today, with the progress of science, we feel the weight of these words even more deeply.

Earth is only one planet in the solar system. The sun is only one star in the Milky Way. And the Milky Way is only one galaxy among countless galaxies.

Without faith, such knowledge can easily lead us into emptiness. Human life may seem insignificant.

But Psalm 8 tells us that the vast universe does not erase human value. It magnifies it. The God who made the universe is mindful of us.

2. The Passing of Time and the Brevity of Life

Space reveals our smallness. Time reveals our limits.

Moses prayed:

"The days of our years are seventy, or even by reason of strength eighty years; yet their pride is but labor and sorrow, for it passes quickly, and we fly away." (Psalm 90:10, WEB)

Science calls this limitation. Scripture calls it passing away.

But in the same psalm, Moses points us toward wisdom:

"So teach us to count our days, that we may gain a heart of wisdom." (Psalm 90:12, WEB)

The brevity of life is not a reason for despair. It is a call to wisdom.

3. Eternal Hope and Human Worth

If we look only at the vastness of the universe and the relentless movement of time, human life can seem almost nothing.

But Scripture teaches that our worth does not depend on how much space we occupy or how many years we live. It depends on how the Creator sees us.

The psalmist continues:

*"For you have made him a little lower than the angels, and crowned him with glory and honor."
(Psalm 8:5, WEB)*

The fullness of this worth is revealed in Jesus Christ. He entered time and space, became flesh and blood, and opened the way to eternal life through eternal love.

John's Gospel says:

"For God so loved the world, that he gave his only born Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life." (John 3:16, WEB)

The universe may be vast and time may be long, but before God, we are not nothing.

4. How to Live Meaningfully in Our Brief Years

To recognize our smallness and brevity is not to fall into despair. It is a call to turn our eyes toward eternity.

First, fear the Lord. Only when we know our limits can we revere the One who is limitless. Proverbs says, "The fear of Yahweh is the beginning of wisdom. The knowledge of the Holy One is understanding." (Proverbs 9:10, WEB)

Second, number our days. We cannot change the length of life, but we can shape its depth.

Third, hold on to eternal hope. Human smallness is not the end, because God has given us the promise of eternal life in Christ.

Conclusion: From Smallness to Dignity

The universe is vast, and time flows like a river that never returns. If we look only at ourselves, we are indeed like dust, here for a moment and gone.

But in God's eyes, we are His treasured creation. We are the ones He remembers and cares for.

So when you look up at the stars, do not only sigh over your smallness. Remember that the Lord who created the stars is looking upon you with care.

落叶归根，还是落地生根？

给在美华人的一封信

小时候，我们常听老人说：“人啊，终究是要落叶归根的。”

这句话里有一种骨血的牵挂，是对故土的依恋，对根源的尊重，也是文化里一代代传下来的情感逻辑。

可当我们真正跨越万水千山，背井离乡，漂洋过海来到美国，在这片陌生而自由的土地上生活、学习、打拼、生儿育女，时间久了，才发现：我们这一代人，面对的未必只是“归根”的选择，更是“生根”的挑战。

一、归根是情感，生根是责任

“归根”是一种安慰人心的诗意表达，可现实并不总是诗意的。

你可能已经在美国生活了十年、二十年，甚至更久。你在这里交房贷、养孩子、缴税，也慢慢习惯了超市的货架、街道的节奏和邻里的冷暖。

这一切，构成了你新的土壤。

孩子，尤其是在这里出生长大的第二代，他们的根也许早就不再是那片你梦回的老屋，而是眼前这一片语言不同、节奏不同、文化也有张力的新世界。

此时，若我们只惦记“归去”，就可能忽略了“留下”的意义。

二、生根不是忘本，而是拓土

生根，不是抹去原来的身份，而是带着身份去适应、扎根、开花。

我们可以在家中坚持中文，保留节日习俗，讲述祖辈故事。同时，也需要鼓励孩子理解这片土地的规则，参与社区，建立跨文化友谊，学会在文化张力中寻找出路。

华人社区不该只是孤岛，也可以成为桥梁。

而桥梁的建造，正是从我们愿意在此地生根开始的。

三、你的根在哪里，未来就在哪里

我们来到这里，不只是为了谋一口饭吃，更是为了下一代有更宽广的视野与成长空间。

一个真正有盼望的生命，是能面对现实的风雨，也能在异地他乡种下一棵树。

落叶归根，是一种圆满。

落地生根，是另一种成全。

不要等老去才后悔没有早点融入，也不要等“终有一天要走”来搪塞今天的使命。

选择在美国生根，不等于忘记中国的根。恰恰相反，是带着那根、那魂、那文化的力量，去影响新的土地。

结语：你在哪里，根就可以在哪里

有句话说得好：“根不在脚下，在心里。”

只要心中有信念、有价值、有方向，哪怕是在异国的土地，也能种下信仰的种子、文化的种子、爱的种子。

愿你我都能成为不但落地，也愿意生根的人。

English Version

Returning to One's Roots or Taking Root Here?

A Letter to Chinese Immigrants in America

When we were young, we often heard older people say, “Leaves eventually return to their roots.”

There is a deep emotional pull in that saying: love for one's homeland, respect for one's origins, and a cultural instinct passed down from generation to generation.

But when we truly cross oceans and mountains, leave home, come to America, and begin to live, study, work, raise children, and build a life in this unfamiliar yet free land, we gradually discover something: our generation is not only facing the question of returning to our roots. We are also facing the challenge of taking root where we are.

1. Returning Is an Emotion; Taking Root Is a Responsibility

Returning to one's roots is a poetic comfort, but life is not always poetic.

You may have lived in America for ten years, twenty years, or even longer. You pay a mortgage here. You raise children here. You pay taxes here. You have slowly become familiar with the grocery shelves, the rhythm of the streets, and the warmth and distance of neighbors.

All of this has become your new soil.

For children, especially the second generation born and raised here, their roots may no longer be the old house you dream of returning to. Their roots may be this new world before them, with a different language, a different rhythm, and real cultural tension.

If we think only about going back, we may miss the meaning of staying.

2. Taking Root Does Not Mean Forgetting; It Means Cultivating New Ground

Taking root does not mean erasing our original identity. It means carrying that identity with us as we adapt, grow, and bear fruit.

We can continue speaking Chinese at home, preserving holiday customs, and telling the stories of our ancestors. At the same time, we also need to encourage our children to understand the rules of this land, participate in the community, build cross-cultural friendships, and learn to find a way through cultural tension.

The Chinese community should not be an island. It can become a bridge.

And bridges are built when one generation after another is willing to take root here.

3. Where Your Roots Are, There Your Future Can Grow

We did not come here merely to make a living. We came so that the next generation might have a broader vision and more room to grow.

A life with hope can face the storms of reality and still plant a tree in a foreign land.

Returning to one's roots can be a kind of completion.

Taking root where one lands can be another kind of fulfillment.

Do not wait until old age to regret that you did not integrate earlier. Do not use "I will leave someday" as an excuse to avoid today's calling.

Choosing to take root in America does not mean forgetting one's Chinese roots. On the contrary, it means carrying that root, that soul, and that culture into a new land and allowing it to bless others.

Conclusion: Wherever You Are, You Can Take Root

There is a saying: "Roots are not under your feet; they are in your heart."

If there is conviction, value, and direction in the heart, then even in a foreign land one can plant seeds of faith, culture, and love.

May we become people who not only land somewhere, but are also willing to take root there.

第四辑：记念、失去与盼望

记念小麦子：一周年的思与盼

一、记念与思念

一年前的今天，小麦子离开了我们。

那一刻的痛，如今仍然清晰。时间可以让生活重新往前走，却不能把爱从记忆中抹去。生命原来如此脆弱，也如此庄严；一个孩子短短来到世上，又静静离开，却在父母心里留下永远无法替代的位置。

小麦子的一生很短，却教会我们许多事。

他让我们更深地明白：孩子不是父母的附属品，也不是家庭计划中的一个项目。孩子是上帝托付给家庭的礼物，也是教会与信仰群体需要温柔守护的生命。

他的纯真、他的笑容、他短暂的陪伴，都成为我们心中删不掉的光。每一次想起他，我们仍会疼；但在疼痛深处，也有一种安静的盼望，提醒我们：爱没有因为分别而结束。

二、教育的归属

在过去这一年里，我们常常思想一个问题：孩子的教育，究竟首先属于谁？

从家庭伦理、教育研究和信仰传统来看，一个清楚的原则逐渐浮现出来：孩子教育的首要责任在家庭。父母不仅为孩子提供生活所需，也承担价值、品格、信仰与人生方向的塑造。

教会，则是家庭不可缺少的同行者。

家庭传递爱与信仰，教会提供群体的支持、榜样、陪伴和属灵根基。一个孩子的成长，不只是学业成绩的累积，更是生命被爱、真理、关系和使命慢慢塑造的过程。

教育不只是把人训练成有用的人，更是帮助人成为有根、有爱、有敬畏、有盼望的人。

三、信仰的传承

记念小麦子的一周年，我们不仅是在流泪与怀念，也是在追问：下一代的属灵根基，要在哪里扎稳？

教育不是单纯的知识传递，而是生命的塑造；信仰也不是成年以后才突然出现的选择，而是在家庭的饭桌旁、教会的诗歌中、父母的祷告里、群体的陪伴中，一点一点被种下的种子。

当下一代失去被信仰滋养的土壤，教会失去的不只是人数，而是未来的传承；家庭失去的，也不只是宗教活动，而是生命最深处方向感。

四、一周年的盼望

小麦子的离开，让我们更深刻地体会到：生命的每一天都弥足珍贵。

记念他，不只是为了怀念过去，也是为了更忠心地面对今天。

我们盼望家庭重新被看见，成为孩子教育与生命塑造的第一现场。我们也盼望教会继续成为孩子的属灵家园，让他们可以歌唱、祷告、提问、学习、成长和被祝福。

主耶稣说：

“我实实在在地告诉你们，一粒麦子不落在地里死了，仍旧是一粒；若是死了，就结出许多子粒来。”（约 12:24，和合本）

小麦子虽然离开了我们，但愿他的生命像一粒种子，在我们的眼泪中落下，在我们的信心中发芽，在更多家庭和教会的守望中，结出盼望的子粒。

结语

愿我们在泪水中仍存信心，在缺憾中仍怀盼望。

愿小麦子的纪念，不只是我们心中的伤口，也成为一盏安静的灯，提醒我们：孩子属于上帝，生命值得守护，信仰需要传承，而盼望永不落空。

2025 年 8 月 21 日

English Version

Remembering Little Wheat

Reflections and Hope One Year Later

1. Remembrance and Longing

One year ago today, Little Wheat left us.

The pain of that moment remains clear. Time can move life forward, but it cannot erase love from memory. Life is fragile, yet sacred. A child may come into the world briefly and leave quietly, but he leaves a place in his parents' hearts that can never be replaced.

Little Wheat's life was brief, but he taught us many things.

He helped us understand that children are not the property of their parents or projects within a family plan. They are gifts entrusted by God to families and lives that the church and the community of faith are called to cherish.

His innocence, his smile, and his brief companionship have become a light in our hearts that cannot be erased. Every time we remember him, we still hurt. Yet beneath the pain is a quiet hope: love did not end with separation.

2. The Family's First Responsibility

Over the past year, we have often reflected on a question: where does a child's education first begin?

One principle becomes clear through family ethics, educational reflection, and Christian tradition: the primary responsibility belongs to the family. Parents provide more than physical care. They also shape values, character, faith, and direction.

The church is an essential companion to the family.

The family passes on love and faith. The church provides community, examples, companionship, and spiritual grounding. A child's growth is more than academic achievement. It is the slow formation of life through love, truth, relationships, and calling.

Education is not merely training a person to become useful. It helps a person become rooted, loving, reverent, and hopeful.

3. Passing Faith to the Next Generation

As we remember Little Wheat one year later, we are not only grieving. We are asking where the next generation will take spiritual root.

Education is not simply the transfer of knowledge. It is the formation of life. Faith is not a choice that suddenly appears in adulthood. It is a seed planted around the family table, through the songs of the church, in the prayers of parents, and through the companionship of a community.

When the next generation loses the soil in which faith can grow, the church loses more than attendance. It loses continuity. The family loses more than religious activity. It loses a deep sense of direction.

4. Hope One Year Later

Little Wheat's departure has taught us again that every day of life is precious.

To remember him is not only to look back. It is also to live today more faithfully.

We hope that the family will be seen as the first place of education and life formation. We also hope that the church will remain a spiritual home where children may sing, pray, ask questions, learn, grow, and receive blessing.

Jesus said:

"Most certainly I tell you, unless a grain of wheat falls into the earth and dies, it remains by itself alone. But if it dies, it bears much fruit." (John 12:24, WEB)

Little Wheat has left us, but may his life be like a seed. May it fall into our tears, sprout in our faith, and bear seeds of hope through the watchful love of families and churches.

Conclusion

May we keep faith in our tears and hold hope in our loss.

May the memory of Little Wheat become not only a wound in our hearts, but also a quiet lamp reminding us that children belong to God, life is worthy of protection, faith must be passed on, and hope will not fail.

08/25/2025

麦子落地：在苦难中感受父的深情

那一天，天是灰的，像一张揉皱的纸。微雨无声地打在屋檐上。

我和灵修导师隔着屏幕坐下。虽然身处不同地方，隔着时差，却像面对面一样，心与心相通。一个小时的交通与祷告，在六月的空气里，有一种不言而喻的厚重。

他提起我上次送给他的书《麦子落地》。

是啊，那是我的儿子，小麦子。

一本书，像一粒麦子落在泥土里，盼望长出子粒；但每一次提起，也会翻动我心底的酸楚和泪水。

一、在幽谷中看见父的手

我告诉导师，这段日子里，我常常在苦难的幽谷里看见上帝的手。

祂像一位温柔的父亲。有时并不立刻解释，也没有把痛苦从生命里迅速拿走，却在沉默中托住我，不让我沉入绝望。

过去，我以为父亲的爱是庇护、供给，是一个高大的背影。直到小麦子离开，我才明白，父亲的爱有时也是放手，是含泪说再见，却不让爱因此退缩。

二、苦难改变了我对爱的理解

失去孩子之后，许多过去能够轻易说出口的话，忽然变得沉重。

我不再急着解释别人的苦难，也不再轻易告诉受伤的人“这一切都有美意”。有些痛，需要先被承认；有些眼泪，需要有地方落下。

苦难没有让我更会回答问题，却让我更愿意陪人坐在问题旁边。

也正是在最深的痛里，我经历了一种无法用环境解释的平安。那平安不是忘记，也不是不再流泪，而是在眼泪中仍然知道：我和孩子都没有离开天父的手。

三、在泪水里播种

我和导师像两个农夫，手里各握一把种子。

我们谈论如何在上帝的国度里播下盼望，也谈论泪水怎样进入人的服事与写作。

我知道，麦子落地，是为了结出更多的子粒。

我知道，我的泪水，上帝都看见。

我也相信，小麦子虽不在我的身边，却在父的怀里。

结语：苦难不是终章

雨仍在下，空气里带着泥土的气息。

我合上圣经，心里却渐渐明亮。

苦难不是一首容易读懂的诗，也不是必须被美化的经历。但它不是终章。那位在流泪谷中与人同行的父，仍能使伤口成为理解别人的入口，使记念成为爱，使失去之地缓缓长出盼望。

English Version

When the Wheat Falls

Discovering the Father's Love in Suffering

That day, the sky was gray, like a sheet of paper crumpled in the hand. A light rain fell silently on the roof.

My spiritual mentor and I sat before our screens. We were in different places and time zones, yet the conversation felt face to face. An hour of prayer and fellowship carried a weight that needed few words.

He mentioned the book I had given him, *When the Wheat Falls*.

The book was about my son, Little Wheat.

A book can be like a grain of wheat placed into the soil in hope of bearing fruit. Yet every mention of it also turns the sorrow and tears within me.

1. Seeing the Father's Hand in the Valley

I told my mentor that in the valley of suffering, I had often sensed the hand of God.

He was like a gentle father. He did not always explain, nor did He quickly remove the pain. Yet in the silence, He held me and kept me from sinking into despair.

I once thought a father's love meant protection, provision, and a strong figure standing nearby. After Little Wheat left us, I learned that a father's love may also mean letting go, saying goodbye through tears, and refusing to let love retreat.

2. Suffering Changed My Understanding of Love

After losing a child, many words that once came easily became heavy.

I no longer rush to explain another person's suffering. I no longer quickly tell the wounded that everything has a simple purpose. Some pain must first be acknowledged. Some tears need a place to fall.

Suffering did not make me better at answering questions. It made me more willing to sit beside people who live with them.

In the deepest pain, I also experienced a peace that circumstances could not explain. It was not forgetting, and it did not end my tears. It was the assurance that neither my child nor I had left the Father's hands.

3. Sowing Through Tears

My mentor and I were like two farmers, each holding a handful of seed.

We spoke about sowing hope in God's kingdom and about how tears enter ministry and writing.

I know that wheat falls into the ground in order to bear fruit.

I know that God sees my tears.

And I believe that Little Wheat, though no longer beside me, rests in the Father's care.

Conclusion: Suffering Is Not the Final Chapter

The rain continued, and the air carried the scent of soil.

I closed my Bible, but my heart had grown brighter.

Suffering is not an easy poem to understand, and it does not need to be romanticized. But it is not the final chapter. The Father who walks with us through the valley of tears can make wounds into doors of compassion, remembrance into love, and places of loss into ground where hope slowly grows.

悼念我的父亲

2020年3月18日早上八点，我亲爱的父亲张福生在睡梦中安然离世，归入主的怀抱。

那一刻，他的脸上没有痛苦，身体也没有挣扎，只像往常一样安静地躺在床上，睡姿依旧，是我们再熟悉不过的模样。只是这一次，他再也没有睁开眼睛。

一、没有吃上的那顿早饭

前一晚，父亲觉得肚子不舒服。母亲像往常一样忙前忙后地照顾他，为他预备中草药。

父亲体格一向强壮，只是多年来受高血压、高血脂和糖尿病困扰。每当身体不适，母亲总会细心照料。几十年过去，这样的日子早已成为夫妻之间不言而喻的默契。

那晚，父母一起祷告。父亲说身体好多了，便躺下休息。第二天清晨，母亲早早起床，为他预备了稀饭、泡菜和鸡蛋。她想着父亲昨晚睡得迟，便让他多睡一会儿。

谁也没有想到，那顿早饭，父亲再也没能吃上。

母亲后来去叫他，轻轻拍了几下，却没有得到回应。我接到她的视频电话，看见父亲躺在床上，仿佛只是睡着了，脸上甚至带着一点浅浅的安静。

可我知道，他已经走完了地上的旅程。

二、在风雨里撑起一个家

父亲生于1945年，在贫困的年代长大。年轻时，他曾参军服役。一次执行任务时，为了避免车辆冲撞桥下的人群和孩子，他紧急转向，自己却因此摔伤住院。住院期间，他又被查出胆结石，接受手术后病退返乡。

从此，他脱下军装，回到普通人的生活。

中年以后，为了养家，他从事客运服务，每天风里来、雨里去。一辆车、一身汗、一份倔强，支撑着一家人的日子。

他的生命并不惊天动地，却像家里的一口老水缸，静静立在角落里，装着一个家庭最寻常的需要。哪怕自己有了裂缝，也总想守住最后一滴水。

晚年，他对家庭的牵挂并未减少。哥哥患病期间，他一直陪伴照顾，直到哥哥离世。他很少抱怨，只是变得更加沉默。

每次通话，他说得不多，总是叮嘱我：“你要好好过，主的工要紧。”

三、清贫留下的财富

父亲的一生清贫朴实，没有留下多少物质，却给我留下了信仰、正直和担当。

他常说：“人这一生活得坦坦荡荡，不亏心，不亏人，主知道。”

这些话没有华丽的修辞，却一直在我心里回响。

晚年的父亲开始学着享受生活，吃得讲究一点，穿得整洁一些。他说：“人老了，也要活得有样子。”

我们原以为，还能陪他多过几年安稳的日子。谁知，他却在平常的一个清晨悄然离去。

四、无法赶回去的遗憾

因为新冠疫情，我和妻子身在美国。封城、停航与旅行限制，使我们无法回国送父亲最后一程。

这个遗憾，像一块石头压在心上。

但感谢信仰，它没有要求我否认悲伤，却在悲伤中给我盼望。我们相信，在主里睡了的人并未消失，而是进入了更美的家乡。

圣经说：

“论到睡了的人，我们不愿意弟兄们不知道，恐怕你们忧伤，像那些没有指望的人一样。”（帖前 4:13，和合本）

结语：等我们天家再见

父亲，愿您在那里不再有病痛，不再有忧虑。

您一生操劳，愿您如今在主的怀里得享安息。

您走好。

等我们天家再见。

儿子：张崇助

儿媳：张素川（Sue Zhang）

——2020年3月18日夜，写于美国

English Version

In Memory of My Father

At eight o'clock on the morning of March 18, 2020, my beloved father, Fusheng Zhang, died peacefully in his sleep and entered the embrace of the Lord.

There was no sign of pain or struggle on his face. He lay quietly in the familiar position in which we had seen him sleep so many times. But this time, he would not open his eyes again.

1. The Breakfast He Never Ate

The night before, my father had felt discomfort in his stomach. As she had done for decades, my mother cared for him and prepared traditional herbal medicine.

He had always been physically strong, though he had lived for years with high blood pressure, high cholesterol, and diabetes. Whenever he became unwell, my mother looked after him carefully. Such moments had become part of the quiet understanding of their marriage.

That evening, they prayed together. My father said he felt better and went to sleep. Early the next morning, my mother prepared rice porridge, pickled vegetables, and eggs. Because he had gone to bed late, she decided to let him rest.

No one imagined that he would never eat that breakfast.

When my mother later tried to wake him, he did not respond. She called me by video. On the screen, my father appeared to be sleeping, his face calm and almost smiling.

But I knew that his earthly journey had ended.

2. Carrying a Family Through Wind and Rain

My father was born in 1945 and grew up in years of hardship. As a young man, he served in the military. During one assignment, he turned a vehicle sharply to avoid people and children beneath a bridge. He was injured and hospitalized. While in the hospital, doctors discovered gallstones, and after surgery he retired from service and returned home.

He took off his uniform and returned to ordinary life.

In middle age, he worked in passenger transportation to support the family. Day after day, through wind and rain, a vehicle, a body covered in sweat, and a stubborn sense of responsibility carried our household forward.

His life was not dramatic. It was like an old water jar in the corner of a home, quietly holding what a family needed each day. Even when cracked, it tried to preserve the last drop.

In later years, his concern for the family did not lessen. When my older brother became ill, my father remained beside him until my brother died. He rarely complained. He simply became quieter.

Whenever we spoke, he said little. He would remind me, "Live well. The Lord's work matters."

3. The Wealth of a Simple Life

My father lived a modest life and left little material wealth. What he gave me was faith, integrity, and responsibility.

He often said, "Live openly and honestly. Do not wrong your conscience or another person. The Lord knows."

His words were simple, but they still echo within me.

In his later years, he began to enjoy life a little more, choosing better food and dressing neatly. "When a person grows old," he said, "he should still live with dignity."

We thought we would have several more peaceful years with him. Instead, he left quietly on an ordinary morning.

4. The Regret of Not Returning

My wife and I were in the United States when he died. Pandemic lockdowns, canceled flights, and travel restrictions made it impossible for us to return to China for his funeral.

That regret remains heavy.

Yet faith does not ask me to deny grief. It gives hope within grief. We believe that those who fall asleep in the Lord have not disappeared, but have entered a better country.

Scripture says:

"But we don't want you to be ignorant, brothers, concerning those who have fallen asleep, so that you don't grieve like the rest, who have no hope." (1 Thessalonians 4:13, WEB)

Conclusion: Until We Meet Again

Father, may you be free from pain and worry.

You labored throughout your life. May you now rest in the presence of the Lord.

Farewell, Father.

Until we meet again in our heavenly home.

Son: Chongzhu "Paul" Zhang

Daughter-in-law: Sue Zhang

—Written in the United States on the night of March 18, 2020

父亲节忆父亲

小学时，我曾和同桌打过一架。原因早已忘了，也许是为了一块橡皮，也许只是孩子之间的一时冲动。

那一天，双方父亲都被老师叫到学校。

父亲赶来时，穿着洗得发白的蓝褂子，脚上是一双已经裂口的黑布鞋。他步子很急，脸上带着劳累，也带着怒气。我低着头，等着挨训。

没想到，他转身对对方的父亲说了一句：

“我们将来都要靠儿子吃饭的。”

这句话像一根钉子，钉进了我心里。

一、“靠儿子吃饭”的玩笑

那时我不懂这句话的分量，只觉得羞。后来，同学们还常拿它调侃我。只要我考试没考好，他们便笑着说：“还要靠儿子吃饭呢！”

这句话就这样跟了我很多年。

可是回头来看，父亲真的靠我吃过一口饭吗？

没有。

相反，是我靠他一辈子。

年轻时，我不爱读书，整天想着做生意、赚钱，在人群中寻找存在感。父亲嘴上说我“浑”，可需要他帮助的时候，他从来没有把手收回去。

二、五十块钱里的父爱

父亲常说：“你好好读书，无论家里多困难，就算砸锅卖铁，也要供你。”

那时我嫌这句话太土，听过就忘。

直到上帝呼召我，我才真正走进书本，也慢慢看见一条比金钱更明亮的道路。

1996年，我进入圣经专修班。父亲几乎每周都会从家里赶来，给我五十块钱生活费。

在那个年代，五十块钱不是一个轻松的数字。那可能是他一天辛苦工作的收入，也是母亲从生活开支中一点一点省下的钱。

我不记得父亲说过多少鼓励的话，只记得他把钱塞给我时，手指冰凉，眼神却暖得像灶台里的火。

后来我到上海读神学，又继续学习圣乐。一路上，是父母、岳父岳母和妻子的支持，托住了我的学习与服事。

他们没有高深的神学语言，却把信仰化成一口饭、一笔学费和一句：“你安心读书。”

三、在低谷里为我铺路

2015 年，我因信仰经历了一段失去自由的日子。

那是我人生的低谷，也是父母心里无法言说的苦楚。母亲整夜祷告，父亲翻来覆去睡不着。

后来，父亲不断催我出国。他经历过动荡的年代，知道环境变化可以怎样改变一个普通家庭的命运。他把多年省吃俭用的积蓄交给我，只希望我能走得更远，也能继续自己所领受的呼召。

哥哥去世以后，我成了家中独子。我问父亲：“你们都老了，我若走了，谁照顾你们？”

父亲坐在旧藤椅上，望着屋外，平静地说：

“送终不送终不重要。我们信主的人，将来天堂再见。”

那句话像一把刀，割开了我心里最后的牵挂，也让我明白：父亲的爱不是把孩子留在身边，而是愿意放手，让孩子走上他应当走的路。

四、原来一直是儿子靠父亲

我出国以后，父亲每次视频都叮嘱我：“别苦了自己，别为钱发愁，你爸爸还在。”

2020 年 3 月 18 日，父亲在睡梦中安然离世。

他这一生，没有真正靠儿子吃过一顿饭，却把自己能给的都给了儿子。

去世以后，我才知道，他甚至还悄悄为我留下一点投资。他不懂复杂的金融，只是想多为孩子预备一点。

他的爱总是这样，藏在日常的碎片里，藏在我们没有留意的地方。

结语：父亲的重量

又是一年父亲节。

夜深人静，我在灯下写下这些文字。那句“靠儿子吃饭”，像一条穿过岁月的红线，把我与父亲一生的恩情、信仰和牵挂连在一起。

如今我更明白，不是父亲靠儿子吃饭，而是儿子靠父亲的爱走了一辈子。

愿有一天，我也能把这样的爱传下去：不喧哗，不张扬，却坚定、温暖，重如山岳。

English Version

Remembering My Father on Father's Day

When I was in elementary school, I once got into a fight with the boy who sat beside me. I no longer remember the reason. Perhaps it was an eraser, or perhaps it was simply a childish impulse.

Both fathers were called to the school.

My father arrived wearing a faded blue jacket and a pair of worn black cloth shoes. He walked quickly, his face marked by exhaustion and anger. I lowered my head and waited to be scolded.

Instead, he turned to the other father and said:

"One day, both of us will depend on our sons for food."

The sentence entered my heart like a nail.

1. A Sentence That Became a Joke

At the time, I did not understand its weight. I only felt embarrassed. Later, my classmates used it to tease me. Whenever I did poorly on an examination, they would laugh: "And your father plans to depend on you!"

The sentence followed me for years.

But looking back, did my father ever truly depend on me for a meal?

No.

I depended on him for a lifetime.

When I was young, I did not enjoy studying. I dreamed of business, money, and finding importance among other people. My father called me reckless, but whenever I needed help, he never withdrew his hand.

2. A Father's Love in Fifty Yuan

My father often said, "Study well. No matter how difficult life becomes, even if we have to sell everything, we will support your education."

At the time, I thought the words were old-fashioned.

Only after God called me did I begin to enter the world of books and see a road brighter than money.

In 1996, I entered a Bible training program. Nearly every week, my father traveled from home to bring me fifty yuan for living expenses.

At that time, fifty yuan was not a small amount. It could represent a full day of his labor and money my mother had carefully saved from household needs.

I do not remember many speeches of encouragement. I remember his cold fingers placing the money into my hand and eyes as warm as a fire in the kitchen stove.

Later, I studied theology and sacred music in Shanghai. My parents, my parents-in-law, and my wife carried me through those years of learning and ministry.

They did not speak in sophisticated theological language. They turned faith into a meal, tuition, and the simple words, "Study without worrying."

3. Opening a Road Through the Valley

In 2015, because of my faith, I passed through a period in which I lost my freedom.

It was one of the lowest seasons of my life and a grief my parents could hardly express. My mother prayed through the night. My father lay awake, turning from side to side.

Afterward, he repeatedly urged me to go abroad. He had lived through unstable years and knew how changing circumstances could alter the life of an ordinary family. He gave me savings accumulated through years of restraint, hoping that I could travel farther and continue the calling I had received.

After my older brother died, I became the only surviving son. I asked, "You are both growing old. If I leave, who will care for you?"

My father sat in an old rattan chair and looked outside.

"Whether you are present at the end is not the most important thing," he said calmly. "Those who trust the Lord will meet again in heaven."

His words cut through my final hesitation. They taught me that a father's love does not always keep a child nearby. Sometimes it releases him to walk the road he must take.

4. The Son Who Depended on His Father

After I moved abroad, my father would tell me during video calls, "Do not make life too hard for yourself. Do not worry about money. Your father is still here."

On March 18, 2020, he died peacefully in his sleep.

He never truly depended on his son for a meal. He gave his son everything he could.

Only after his death did I learn that he had quietly set aside a small investment for me. He understood little about finance. He simply wanted to prepare something more for his child.

That was how his love worked. It hid in fragments of ordinary life and in places we did not know to look.

Conclusion: The Weight of a Father

Father's Day has come again.

In the quiet of the night, I write these words beneath a small light. The sentence about "depending on a son for food" has become a red thread through time, joining my father's love, faith, and concern to my life.

Now I understand: my father did not live by depending on his son. His son lived by depending on his father's love.

May I one day pass on that kind of love: quiet and unannounced, yet steady, warm, and heavy as a mountain.

我信的最大，信祂什么都不怕

那是很多年前，发生在广东南方一个小镇的故事。

一位族里的老叔公，年岁已高，牙齿掉了许多，眼睛也老花。可每天清晨，他总会端坐在堂屋门口，戴着一副有些歪斜的老花镜，怀里抱着一本黑皮封面的书，嘴里唱着旁人听不懂的调子，像是在品尝某种古老而甘甜的东西。

一旁玩耍的小女孩忍不住问他：“你唱什么歌？这本书你天天读，里面写了什么？”

叔公笑了笑，只回答一句：

“我信的最大，信祂什么都不怕。”

这句话，小女孩当时没有听懂，却深深记住了。

一、一句话，在多年后重新回来

多年以后，小女孩长大成人，结婚、生子，生活原本安稳。

后来，她的身体长期不适，四肢乏力，心里也常常不安。她接受了多种检查和治疗，却一时没有找到清楚原因。白天努力维持生活，夜里却常常独自流泪。

就在她几乎失去盼望时，童年那句尘封已久的话忽然回到心里：

“我信的最大，信祂什么都不怕。”

她开始寻找叔公所相信的那一位，也想知道那本黑皮书里究竟有什么力量。

二、信仰不是迷信，而是风暴中的平安

后来，她来到一处基督徒聚会的地方。

在那里，她第一次认真听见圣经的话，也渐渐明白：叔公所说的“不怕”，不是认为人生从此没有疾病和风浪，而是在没有答案时仍然知道可以把自己交托给谁。

她继续面对身体与生活，也在信仰群体中得到陪伴。后来，她的身体状况逐渐好转，心灵也慢慢恢复平安。

这是一段个人见证，不是用信仰代替医疗，也不是说每一个相信的人都会以同样方式康复。它所见证的，是人在脆弱中仍能得到盼望、陪伴和面对明天的勇气。

三、真正的“大”，不是人的能力

“我信的最大”，并不是说自己的信心比别人强。

恰恰相反，它承认人的有限，也承认我们所信靠的那一位大过人的恐惧、大过暂时无法理解的处境。

信仰不是叫人否认害怕，而是让人在害怕时仍有可以站立的地方。

结语：一句朴素的话

那位老叔公也许没有受过多少教育，却把一生的信靠浓缩成一句朴素的话：

“我信的最大，信祂什么都不怕。”

愿我们记得，这不是一句保证人生无风无浪的口号，而是一份在风浪中仍然可以交托、仍然能够向前的信心。

English Version

I Trust the Greatest One, So I Need Not Be Afraid

Many years ago, in a small town in southern Guangdong, an elderly relative sat each morning at the doorway of his home.

He had lost many of his teeth, and his eyes had grown dim with age. Yet he would put on a crooked pair of reading glasses, hold a black-covered book in his arms, and sing words that the children nearby did not understand.

One little girl finally asked, "What are you singing? You read that book every day. What does it say?"

The old man smiled and answered:

"I trust the Greatest One, so I need not be afraid."

The girl did not understand, but she remembered.

1. A Sentence Returned Years Later

Years passed. The girl grew up, married, and had children. Her life seemed settled.

Then she began to experience continuing weakness and anxiety. She underwent examinations and treatments, but for a time no clear cause was found. During the day she tried to carry on. At night she often wept alone.

When hope was fading, the sentence from childhood returned:

"I trust the Greatest One, so I need not be afraid."

She began to search for the One her elderly relative had trusted and for the meaning hidden in that black-covered book.

2. Faith as Peace in the Storm

Eventually, she visited a Christian gathering.

There she listened carefully to Scripture and began to understand that "not being afraid" did not mean a life without sickness or trouble. It meant knowing to whom she could entrust herself when answers were absent.

She continued to face her health concerns and also received companionship within the community of faith. In time, her physical condition improved, and her inner life gradually found peace.

This is a personal testimony. It does not replace medical care or promise that every believer will recover in the same way. It bears witness to the hope, companionship, and courage that faith can give in human weakness.

3. The Greatest One Is Not the Self

To say, "I trust the Greatest One," is not to claim that one's faith is stronger than everyone else's.

It is to acknowledge human limitation and to trust that God is greater than fear and greater than circumstances we cannot yet understand.

Faith does not require us to deny fear. It gives us a place to stand while we are afraid.

Conclusion: A Simple Confession

The elderly man may not have received much formal education, but he gathered a lifetime of trust into one simple sentence:

"I trust the Greatest One, so I need not be afraid."

This is not a promise that life will have no storms. It is a confession that even in the storm, we can entrust ourselves to God and continue walking.

第五辑：时代、真理与良知

不卖灵魂：在现实里守住良知的人

最近，我看到一段文字，写得很尖锐，也很刺人。它用一种极端的对比方式提醒我们：人不仅会在生活里出卖劳力，也可能在更隐秘的层面出卖良心。

读完之后，我心里反而生出一种牧者式的沉重。

不是想去批评哪一类人，而是想问：在压力之下，我们怎样还能守住内在的清洁与真实？

先说一句：我们不该轻易用标签去定义一个人的价值。

每个人的处境都复杂。有的人被生活挤到墙角，有的人背着家庭、债务、疾病和孤独。所谓体面与不体面，常常只是外表；而真正的痛与挣扎，很多时候藏在沉默里。

若我们用一句话就把人归类、嘲讽、定罪，那不是智慧，也不是爱。

但那段文字仍提醒了我一件事：人最大的危险，有时不是身体的辛劳，而是心的妥协。

我们都可能在某个时刻，为了稳定、利益、位置、认可，而把真实收起来，把原则放一边，把良心按下去。

于是，我们开始学会说一套、做一套；学会保持正确姿态，却慢慢失去内里的诚实。

更可怕的是，人一旦习惯了这种分裂，连自己都不觉得疼了。

一、灵魂渐渐变钝

从信仰的角度看，这就是灵魂渐渐变钝的过程。

它不一定发生在舞台上，也可能发生在办公室、家庭、朋友圈，甚至发生在我们的内心独白里。

我们嘴里依然会说漂亮的话，心里却越来越冷。

外面看起来仍然能干、热心、积极，里面却越来越疲惫、焦虑、麻木。

不是因为我们不努力，而是因为我们努力的方向偏了。

我们努力守住人设，却没有守住心。

二、把尖锐的问题，换成温柔的省察

所以，今天我想把那段文字换一种更温柔的问法，送给自己，也送给你：

在你最忙、最累、最想将就一下的时候，你是否还愿意对自己诚实？

在你最需要别人认可的时候，你是否还愿意让神来认可你？

在你最容易随波逐流的时候，你是否还愿意守住一点点正直，哪怕因此吃亏？

信仰不是叫我们站在高处指责别人，而是叫我们先在光中省察自己。

真正的敬虔，也不是说得多漂亮，而是在无人看见处仍然选择诚实；在诱惑面前仍然选择清洁；在压力之下仍然选择不伤害、不欺骗、不背叛。

三、神不是用羞辱医治人

我也想对正在艰难处境中的人说：如果你此刻很疲惫、很纠结、很无助，请不要用羞耻压垮自己。

神从不以羞辱来医治人。

祂看见你的重担，也理解你的软弱。

祂呼召我们，不是去扮演完美，而是带着破碎来到祂面前，重新得力，重新做人。

结语：可以辛苦，但不失去良知

愿我们这一年，靠主的恩典学会一件事：

可以辛苦，但不失去良知；

可以卑微，但不失去尊严；

可以被误解，但不失去真实；

可以走得慢，但不走偏。

愿我们都在主里，做一个不卖灵魂的人。

English Version

Do Not Sell Your Soul

Keeping Conscience in Real Life

Recently, I read a piece of writing that was sharp and unsettling. It used an extreme contrast to remind readers that people may not only sell their labor in life; in more hidden ways, they may also sell their conscience.

After reading it, I felt a pastoral heaviness in my heart.

I did not want to criticize a certain kind of person. Instead, I found myself asking: under pressure, how can we still guard inner cleanliness and truthfulness?

Let me say this first: we should not use labels too quickly to define a person's worth.

Every person's situation is complex. Some are pushed into a corner by life. Some carry family burdens, debt, illness, and loneliness. What appears respectable or unrespectable is often only the surface. The real pain and struggle are often hidden in silence.

If we classify, mock, or condemn people with one sentence, that is neither wisdom nor love.

Still, that piece of writing reminded me of something important: a person's greatest danger is sometimes not physical hardship, but the compromise of the heart.

At certain moments, all of us may be tempted, for the sake of stability, benefit, position, or approval, to hide what is true, set principles aside, and press conscience down.

Gradually, we learn to say one thing and do another. We learn to maintain the right appearance while slowly losing inner honesty.

Even more frightening, once people become used to this inner division, they may no longer feel the pain of it.

1. When the Soul Becomes Dull

From the perspective of faith, this is the process by which the soul gradually becomes dull.

It does not necessarily happen on a stage. It may happen in the office, at home, among friends, or even in the private monologue of the heart.

Our mouths may still say beautiful things, while our hearts grow colder.

Outwardly, we may still appear capable, enthusiastic, and active, while inwardly we become increasingly tired, anxious, and numb.

It is not always because we are not trying hard enough. Sometimes it is because our effort is pointed in the wrong direction.

We work hard to preserve an image, but fail to guard the heart.

2. Turning a Sharp Question into Gentle Examination

So today, I want to turn that sharp warning into a gentler question, first for myself and then for you:

When you are busiest, most tired, and most tempted to compromise just a little, are you still willing to be honest with yourself?

When you most need approval from others, are you still willing to let God be the One who approves you?

When it is easiest to drift with the current, are you still willing to keep even a small measure of integrity, even if it costs you?

Faith does not call us to stand above others and condemn them. It calls us first to examine ourselves in the light.

True godliness is not shown merely by beautiful words. It is seen when we choose honesty where no one sees, purity in the face of temptation, and the refusal to harm, deceive, or betray under pressure.

3. God Does Not Heal Through Shame

I also want to speak to those who are in difficult circumstances.

If you are exhausted, conflicted, or helpless right now, please do not crush yourself with shame.

God never heals by humiliating people.

He sees your burden and understands your weakness.

He calls us not to perform perfection, but to come to Him with our brokenness, receive strength again, and become whole again.

Conclusion: Hard Pressed, but Still True

May we learn one thing by the grace of the Lord:

We may work hard, but not lose conscience.

We may be humble in position, but not lose dignity.

We may be misunderstood, but not lose truthfulness.

We may walk slowly, but not walk in the wrong direction.

May we become, in the Lord, people who do not sell their souls.

家庭、教会与下一代的属灵养育

Faith Formation Begins at Home

一个孩子的成长，需要学校，也需要社会。

但在这些结构之前，他首先属于一个家庭。

他从父母的语气里认识爱，从饭桌上的谈话里学习价值，也从成年人面对困难的方式里，慢慢形成对世界的理解。

因此，教育从来不只是知识的传递。教育也是生命的塑造。

一、父母不能把最重要的责任外包

父母可以把数学交给老师，把音乐交给专业人士，却不能把孩子的品格、信仰和灵魂完全交给别人。

孩子最终记住的，往往不是父母讲过多少道理，而是父母怎样生活。

他会看见我们是否诚实，是否尊重弱小，是否在冲突中愿意道歉，是否在风雨中仍然祷告。

家庭，就是孩子最早的神学课堂。

二、教会是家庭的同行者

家庭不是孤岛。

父母也会疲惫，会迷惘，会有自己不懂的问题。因此，健康的教会不是取代父母，而是帮助父母。

教会给孩子群体，让他知道信仰不只是父母的私人选择；教会也给父母支持，让他们在养育的压力中不必独自承担。

家庭提供每天的陪伴，教会提供更大的属灵共同体。两者若能彼此尊重、彼此配搭，孩子就更容易在爱与真理中扎根。

三、属灵养育不能只靠活动

参加聚会并不自动等于生命被塑造。

若孩子只在固定时间听见信仰语言，却在家中看不见信仰如何处理金钱、情绪、冲突与选择，他很容易把信仰理解成一种仪式。

真正的传承发生在生活里。

一起吃饭时的感恩，一次犯错后的诚实，一场争执后的和好，一段低谷中的坚持，都在告诉孩子：信仰不是口号，而是我们如何活着。

四、保护孩子，也要聆听孩子

属灵养育不是控制。

孩子不是父母梦想的延伸，也不是教会人数的象征。他是一个需要被尊重、被聆听、被引导的独立生命。

我们可以教导，却不能用羞耻压服；可以设立界限，却不能用恐惧操控；可以传递信仰，却不能假装孩子没有疑问。

真正稳固的信仰，往往不是从禁止提问中产生，而是在安全的关系里，经过诚实思考后慢慢扎根。

结语：把光交给下一代

下一代的信仰，不会只靠一场聚会保存。

它需要家庭的陪伴、教会的守望，也需要成年人真实一致的生命。

愿我们不是只问：“孩子有没有参加活动？”

而是更深地问：“他有没有在我们身上看见恩典、真理与爱？”

我们能交给下一代最宝贵的，不是一套完美答案，而是一条可以真实走下去的信仰之路。

English Version

Faith Formation Begins at Home

A child needs schools, communities, and many forms of guidance.

But before all these structures, a child first belongs to a family.

Children learn love from the tone of their parents. They learn values through conversations around the table. They form an understanding of life by watching how adults respond to conflict, disappointment, and hope.

Education, therefore, is never only the transfer of information. It is the formation of a life.

1. Parents Cannot Outsource What Matters Most

Parents may entrust mathematics to a teacher and music to a specialist. But they cannot completely hand over the formation of character, faith, and the soul.

Children may not remember every lesson their parents teach. They will remember how their parents live.

They notice whether we tell the truth, respect the vulnerable, apologize after conflict, and continue to pray when life becomes difficult.

The home is a child's first classroom of faith.

2. The Church Walks Beside the Family

A family is not an island.

Parents become tired. They face questions they do not know how to answer. A healthy church does not replace parents; it strengthens them.

The church gives children a community in which faith is larger than a private family preference. It also gives parents support so that they do not carry the work of formation alone.

The family offers daily companionship. The church offers a wider spiritual community. When the two honor and support one another, children are more likely to take root in truth and love.

3. Formation Is More Than Attendance

Attending activities does not automatically form a life.

If children hear religious language at scheduled times but never see faith shaping money, emotions, conflict, and decisions at home, they may come to understand faith as a ceremony rather than a way of life.

Real formation happens in ordinary moments: gratitude at the table, honesty after failure, reconciliation after an argument, and perseverance through a difficult season.

These moments teach a child that faith is not a slogan. It is the way we live.

4. Protecting Children Includes Listening to Them

Spiritual formation is not control.

A child is not an extension of a parent's ambition or a symbol of a church's success. A child is a person who must be respected, heard, guided, and protected.

We may teach without shaming, set boundaries without manipulating through fear, and pass on faith without pretending that children have no questions.

Enduring faith rarely grows from the prohibition of questions. It grows in safe relationships where honest thought and faithful practice can meet.

Conclusion: Passing the Light Forward

The faith of the next generation will not be preserved by one program or one gathering.

It requires the companionship of families, the care of churches, and the integrity of adults whose lives are consistent with their words.

May we ask not only, "Did the child attend?"

May we also ask, "Did the child see grace, truth, and love in us?"

The greatest gift we can give the next generation is not a collection of perfect answers, but a path of faith they can truly walk.

权柄之下，谁来守望权柄？

Authority, Accountability, and the Life of the Church

教会需要权柄。

没有带领，群体容易失去方向；没有秩序，服事也容易陷入混乱。

但教会同样需要问责。

因为只要权柄掌握在有限的人手中，就有可能被情绪、利益、恐惧和个人野心影响。

一、属灵权柄不是个人特权

属灵权柄的目的，不是让人拥有更高的位置，而是让人承担更重的责任。

主耶稣所显明的权柄，不是控制人的权柄，而是洗脚、服事、舍己的权柄。

一个领袖若只要求别人顺服，却不愿接受劝告；只强调自己的呼召，却拒绝说明自己的决定；只求别人透明，自己却活在不可询问的空间里，这样的权柄就已经偏离了服事的方向。

二、问责不是不信任，而是保护

有些人把问责理解成挑战领袖。

其实，健康的问责是在保护领袖，也在保护群体。

财务需要多人监督，重大决定需要共同分辨，投诉需要有安全渠道，领袖也需要可以诚实说话的同工与长者。

没有人应该大到不能被提醒，也没有一个职位可以高到不必说明责任。

三、顺服不能代替分辨

圣经教导信徒尊重带领者，但从未要求人放弃良知与分辨。

真正的顺服不是停止思考，而是在真理中彼此承担。

当权柄要求人隐瞒伤害、压制真话、保护名声高于保护受伤者时，沉默不一定是忠心。

有时候，忠心恰恰意味着用合宜、真实和负责任的方式提出问题。

四、领袖也需要被牧养

领袖不是没有软弱的人。

长期站在前面，会让人习惯被需要，也可能让人害怕承认疲惫和错误。

因此，领袖需要同伴，需要休息，需要被纠正，也需要在失败时得到真实的帮助，而不是被迫维持一种永远正确的形象。

结语：让权柄回到十字架

教会真正的安全，不在于有一位永不犯错的领袖，而在于所有人都愿意站在真理之下。

当权柄愿意被问责，顺服愿意与分辨同行，带领就不再只是职位，而会成为服事。

愿我们所建立的，不是围绕某个人运转的群体，而是一个让基督居首位、让真理可以被说出、让软弱者得到保护的家。

English Version

Who Watches Authority?

Authority, Accountability, and the Life of the Church

The church needs authority.

Without leadership, a community can lose direction. Without order, ministry can become confused.

But the church also needs accountability.

Whenever authority is held by limited human beings, it can be influenced by fear, emotion, self-interest, and ambition.

1. Spiritual Authority Is Not Personal Privilege

The purpose of spiritual authority is not to give someone a higher position. It is to give that person a greater responsibility.

The authority revealed in Jesus is not the power to control. It is the authority that washes feet, serves others, and gives itself away.

When leaders demand submission but refuse counsel, emphasize their calling but never explain their decisions, or require transparency from others while remaining beyond question, authority has moved away from service.

2. Accountability Is Protection

Some people interpret accountability as distrust or rebellion.

Healthy accountability, however, protects both leaders and communities.

Finances need shared oversight. Major decisions need communal discernment. Complaints need safe channels. Leaders need colleagues and elders who can speak honestly to them.

No person should become too important to be corrected. No office should become too elevated to explain its responsibilities.

3. Submission Does Not Replace Discernment

Scripture teaches believers to respect those who lead, but it never asks them to surrender conscience and discernment.

True submission is not the end of thought. It is shared faithfulness under truth.

When authority asks people to hide harm, silence honest questions, or protect reputation above wounded people, silence is not always faithfulness.

Sometimes faithfulness means raising a concern in a truthful, responsible, and appropriate way.

4. Leaders Also Need Pastoral Care

Leaders are not people without weakness.

Standing in front for a long time can make a person accustomed to being needed. It can also make it difficult to admit exhaustion or failure.

Leaders therefore need companions, rest, correction, and genuine help when they fail. They should not be forced to maintain the image of being permanently right.

Conclusion: Returning Authority to the Cross

The safety of the church does not depend on finding a leader who never fails. It depends on everyone being willing to stand under truth.

When authority accepts accountability and submission walks with discernment, leadership becomes service rather than status.

May we build communities that do not revolve around one personality, but place Christ first, make room for truth to be spoken, and protect those who are vulnerable.

公义不偏待人

When Love Refuses Partiality

人很容易同情看起来弱小的一方。

这种同情常常是宝贵的，因为它使我们愿意靠近受伤者。

但同情若失去事实与分辨，也可能让我们在尚未了解事情之前，就急着把一个人定为受害者，把另一个人定为恶人。

一、公义不是冷漠

坚持事实，不等于没有爱。

真正的公义会认真聆听弱者，也会谨慎核实信息；会保护可能受伤的人，也不会用未经证实的指控伤害另一个人。

爱若离开真理，很容易变成情绪。

真理若离开爱，也可能变成冰冷的审判。

二、标签会遮住真实的人

我们喜欢用简单标签理解复杂世界。

强者、弱者；好人、坏人；压迫者、受害者。

但现实中的人常常比标签复杂。一个人在某件事上可能受伤，在另一件事上也可能伤害别人。

因此，成熟的判断不急着站队，而是愿意听完、查明，并承认自己可能不知道全部。

三、保护弱者，也保护程序

一个健康群体需要给受伤者安全的表达空间，也需要清楚、公平的处理程序。

不能因为害怕冲突，就叫受伤者沉默；也不能因为舆论激烈，就跳过核实和回应的机会。

程序不是拖延公义，而是防止情绪代替公义。

四、先省察自己的偏见

我们每个人都有偏见。

我们容易相信与自己相似的人，也容易对自己不喜欢的人作最坏解释。

所以，在判断别人之前，需要先问：

我是在寻找真相，还是在寻找支持自己立场的材料？

我是在保护人，还是在享受定罪人的快感？

结语：让爱与公义同行

真正的爱不是偏护，真正的公义也不是无情。

它愿意靠近受伤者，也愿意尊重事实；愿意承担保护责任，也愿意给人说明和悔改的空间。

愿我们不被情绪推着走，而是在真理与怜悯之间，成为清醒、温柔又可靠的人。

English Version

When Love Refuses Partiality

We naturally feel compassion for the person who appears weaker.

That compassion can be precious because it moves us toward those who are hurting.

Yet compassion without facts and discernment can also lead us to decide too quickly that one person is entirely a victim and another entirely a villain.

1. Justice Is Not Coldness

Insisting on truth does not mean lacking love.

Real justice listens carefully to vulnerable people and examines information responsibly. It protects those who may have been harmed without using unverified accusations to harm someone else.

Love separated from truth can become mere emotion.

Truth separated from love can become cold judgment.

2. Labels Hide Real People

We prefer simple labels for a complicated world: strong and weak, good and bad, oppressor and victim.

Real people are more complex. A person may be wounded in one situation and may also wound others in another.

Mature judgment does not rush to choose a side. It listens, examines, and admits that it may not know the whole story.

3. Protect the Vulnerable and Protect a Fair Process

A healthy community gives wounded people a safe place to speak. It also uses a clear and fair process.

We must not silence those who are hurting because conflict feels uncomfortable. Neither should we allow public emotion to remove careful inquiry and a meaningful opportunity to respond.

Fair process does not delay justice. It helps prevent emotion from replacing justice.

4. Examine Our Own Partiality

Every one of us carries bias.

We tend to believe people who resemble us and assume the worst about people we already dislike.

Before judging others, we should ask:

Am I seeking truth, or only evidence that supports my position?

Am I protecting people, or enjoying the power of condemnation?

Conclusion: Let Love and Justice Walk Together

True love is not partiality, and true justice is not cruelty.

It draws near to the wounded while respecting facts. It accepts responsibility to protect while leaving room for explanation, repentance, and restoration.

May we not be driven by emotion alone. May we become people who are clear-minded, compassionate, and trustworthy in both truth and mercy.

死亡不是终点

Between Judgment and Grace

人到了一定年龄，会越来越频繁地听见离别的消息。

昨天还在说话的人，今天可能已经不在；原本以为还有很多时间的关系，忽然就停在了某一天。

死亡让人不舒服，因为它拆穿了我们的幻觉：我们并不能永远掌控时间。

一、死亡使人生显出重量

如果生命没有终点，许多选择似乎都可以无限拖延。

但正因为生命有限，今天怎样说话、怎样爱人、怎样使用时间，就有了重量。

死亡不是叫人消极，而是叫人清醒。

它提醒我们，不要把道歉留到来不及的时候，不要把爱只藏在心里，也不要一生追逐最终无法带走的东西。

二、审判也是公义的盼望

很多人听见“审判”，首先想到恐惧。

但若这个世界从来没有审判，隐藏的恶就永远不必被面对，未被听见的眼泪也永远得不到回应。

审判说明：我们的选择有意义，伤害不是无所谓，良善也不会被永远遗忘。

这对作恶者是警告，对受伤者却也是盼望。

三、恩典让人诚实面对自己

没有人能够只靠自己的记录，坦然站在完全圣洁的光中。

我们都伤害过人，也都在该行善的时候沉默过。

基督信仰的盼望，不是人能证明自己无罪，而是人在基督里可以悔改、被赦免、重新开始。

恩典不取消审判的严肃，却为愿意回转的人打开一条路。

四、今天就是预备永恒的地方

预备永恒，不是整天猜测死亡日期。

它是今天就学习诚实，今天就修复关系，今天就放下不义之利，今天就把生命交回给神。

一个预备好面对死亡的人，反而更能认真生活。

因为他知道，生命不是偶然的一段路，而是一份需要回应的托付。

结语：在有限中活出永恒

死亡不是最后一句话。

审判告诉我们，生命有责任；恩典告诉我们，失败不是唯一结局。

愿我们不逃避死亡，也不被死亡捆绑。在有限的日子里，活得诚实、清醒、有爱，直到把一生交在那位公义又怜悯的主手中。

English Version

Death Is Not the End

Between Judgment and Grace

As we grow older, news of death comes more often.

Someone who spoke with us yesterday may be gone today. A relationship we assumed would continue may suddenly stop on an ordinary date.

Death unsettles us because it exposes an illusion: we do not control time forever.

1. Death Gives Weight to Life

If life had no ending, every important choice could be postponed indefinitely.

Because life is limited, the way we speak, love, and use our time matters.

Death is not meant to make us passive. It makes us awake.

It reminds us not to postpone an apology until it is too late, not to hide love forever, and not to spend a lifetime pursuing what cannot be carried beyond the grave.

2. Judgment Is Also a Hope for Justice

Many people hear the word judgment and think only of fear.

But if there were no judgment, hidden evil would never need to be faced, and unheard tears would never receive an answer.

Judgment declares that our choices matter, that harm is not meaningless, and that goodness will not be forgotten forever.

It is a warning to those who do evil, but it is also hope for those who have been wounded.

3. Grace Allows Honest Self-Examination

None of us can stand in perfect light on the strength of our own record.

We have hurt others. We have remained silent when goodness required courage.

Christian hope is not that we can prove ourselves innocent. It is that, in Christ, we may repent, receive forgiveness, and begin again.

Grace does not remove the seriousness of judgment. It opens a way for those who turn toward God.

4. Today Is Where We Prepare for Eternity

Preparing for eternity does not mean constantly predicting death.

It means practicing honesty today, repairing relationships today, releasing dishonest gain today, and returning our lives to God today.

Those who are prepared to face death often become more serious about living.

They know life is not an accidental journey, but a trust that calls for a response.

Conclusion: Living Eternity Within Our Limits

Death does not have the final word.

Judgment tells us that life carries responsibility. Grace tells us that failure does not need to be the final outcome.

May we neither deny death nor be imprisoned by it. May we live our limited days with honesty, clarity, and love until we place our whole life into the hands of the One who is both just and merciful.

从英雄到掌控者

How Power Tests the Human Heart

人常常在困难中显出勇气，却在成功之后暴露自己。

危机来临时，他愿意牺牲、担当、带领，于是人们称他为英雄。

但当掌声持续太久，权力越来越集中，一个曾经保护别人的人，也可能慢慢变成不允许别人说“不”的人。

一、成功会改变周围的声音

失败时，身边的人容易指出问题。

成功以后，真实的声音却可能越来越少。有人怕得罪，有人想得好处，也有人把领袖过去的贡献当作今天不必被问责的理由。

久而久之，一个人听见的只剩赞美。不是因为他已经完全，而是因为别人不再敢说真话。

二、功劳不能成为特权

一个人过去做过好事，值得感恩。

但过去的功劳不能成为今天伤害人的许可证。

“我为这个群体付出很多”，不能变成“所以我可以决定一切”。

真正成熟的领袖，不会用贡献堵住别人的问题，也不会把不同意见解释为背叛。

三、权力最大的试探是自我合理化

很少有人会突然承认：“我现在要滥用权力。”

更多时候，人会说：“我是为了大家好。”

当目的被认为足够崇高，手段就容易失去界限。于是恐吓被称为果断，排斥被称为保护，个人意志被称为共同方向。

四、让权力保持可被纠正

保护一个领袖最好的方式，不是让他无人能问，而是让他始终可以被提醒。

任期、程序、共同决定、财务透明、独立申诉和真实同伴，都不是对领袖的不尊重。

它们是在帮助一个有限的人，不被自己的位置吞噬。

结语：不要让掌声改变初心

一个人从英雄变成掌控者，往往不是在一天之内。

那是一连串小小的例外：一次拒绝解释，一次压下异议，一次把自己放在规则之外。

愿我们在被肯定时仍然谦卑，在拥有权柄时仍然可被纠正，在别人称赞我们的时候，仍然记得自己只是一个受托的人。

English Version

From Hero to Controller

How Power Tests the Human Heart

People often show courage in hardship and reveal themselves after success.

During a crisis, someone may sacrifice, take responsibility, and lead well. Others begin to call that person a hero.

But when applause continues and authority becomes concentrated, a person who once protected others may slowly become someone who cannot tolerate the word no.

1. Success Changes the Voices Around Us

When we fail, people are more willing to point out our problems.

After success, honest voices may become rare. Some people fear offense. Some seek advantage. Others treat a leader's past contribution as a reason the leader should no longer be questioned.

Eventually, the leader hears only praise, not because the leader has become perfect, but because others no longer feel free to speak truthfully.

2. Contribution Does Not Create Privilege

Past service deserves gratitude.

But yesterday's contribution cannot become today's permission to harm.

"I have sacrificed much for this community" must not become "Therefore, I may decide everything."

Mature leaders do not use their service to silence questions or interpret every disagreement as betrayal.

3. The Great Temptation of Power Is Self-Justification

Few people announce, "I intend to misuse authority."

More often, they say, "I am doing this for everyone."

When the goal is considered noble enough, the means easily lose their limits. Intimidation becomes decisiveness. Exclusion becomes protection. Personal desire becomes the common direction.

4. Keep Authority Correctable

The best way to protect leaders is not to make them unquestionable. It is to keep them correctable.

Terms of service, clear procedures, shared decisions, financial transparency, independent complaint channels, and honest companions are not acts of disrespect.

They help limited human beings avoid being consumed by their positions.

Conclusion: Do Not Let Applause Change the Heart

The movement from hero to controller rarely happens in one day.

It happens through small exceptions: one refusal to explain, one silenced disagreement, one decision to live outside the rules applied to everyone else.

May we remain humble when affirmed, correctable when entrusted with authority, and mindful, even when praised, that we are still only stewards.

管得多，不如管得好

The Wisdom and Limits of Governance

有一种管理方式，什么都想管。

从大方向到小细节，从人的行动到人的想法，都希望掌握在手里。

表面上，这样的系统很有秩序；实际上，它可能让所有人越来越被动。

一、管理的目的不是证明管理者重要

管理是为了帮助群体完成使命，不是为了让管理者不断显示存在。

若每一件小事都必须经过同一个人，效率不会更高，只会让整个群体失去判断能力。

好的管理者不是让别人离不开自己，而是帮助别人能够成熟承担。

二、界限比全面控制更重要

健康治理需要清楚界限。

哪些事情必须共同遵守，哪些事情可以由个人决定；哪些风险需要监督，哪些空间应该保留自由。

没有界限的自由会带来混乱，没有空间的管理则会使人窒息。

智慧不是把一切收紧，而是知道哪里必须坚定，哪里可以放手。

三、信任不是没有监督

信任和监督并不冲突。

没有监督的信任可能变成疏忽，没有信任的监督则会变成猜疑。

健康的制度会明确责任、公开程序、定期复核，同时给承担责任的人足够空间完成工作。

四、真正的治理让人长大

一个好的家庭、教会或机构，不只是事情没有出错，也是在其中的人越来越成熟。

他们学会判断、合作、承担后果，也学会在错误中改进。

若一个系统永远只培养服从，却不培养责任，它可能很安静，却未必健康。

结语：少一点控制，多一点成全

管理的最高境界，不是所有人都听一个人的，而是每个人都知道自己为何而做，也愿意为自己的责任交账。

愿我们少一点因恐惧而产生的控制，多一点因信任而产生的成全；少一点事无巨细的干预，多一点清楚、公平、可问责的秩序。

English Version

Managing Less, Governing Better

The Wisdom and Limits of Governance

Some forms of management attempt to control everything.

From major direction to minor detail, from people's actions to their thoughts, everything is expected to remain within one person's reach.

Such a system may look orderly. In reality, it can make everyone increasingly passive.

1. Management Is Not a Proof of Importance

Management exists to help a community fulfill its purpose. It does not exist to demonstrate the manager's importance.

If every small matter must pass through one person, efficiency does not increase. The whole community slowly loses its ability to judge and act.

Good managers do not make others permanently dependent on them. They help others become mature enough to carry responsibility.

2. Boundaries Matter More Than Total Control

Healthy governance requires clear boundaries.

What must everyone honor? What may individuals decide? Which risks require oversight? Which spaces should remain free?

Freedom without boundaries may become disorder. Management without space can suffocate people.

Wisdom is not tightening everything. It is knowing where firmness is necessary and where release is healthy.

3. Trust and Oversight Belong Together

Trust does not conflict with oversight.

Trust without oversight may become neglect. Oversight without trust becomes suspicion.

Healthy systems clarify responsibility, make procedures visible, review work regularly, and still give responsible people enough room to do their work.

4. Good Governance Helps People Grow

A healthy family, church, or organization is not merely a place where nothing goes wrong. It is a place where people become more mature.

They learn judgment, cooperation, responsibility, and improvement after failure.

A system that produces obedience but never develops responsibility may remain quiet without becoming healthy.

Conclusion: Less Control, More Formation

The highest form of governance is not that everyone obeys one person. It is that people understand why they act and are willing to account for what has been entrusted to them.

May we practice less control driven by fear and more empowerment grounded in trust; less interference in every detail and more order that is clear, fair, and accountable.

知识不能救赎灵魂

Reason, Sin, and the Need for Grace

知识很重要。

它帮助我们看见事实，识别谬误，也使社会不断进步。

但人类历史同样提醒我们：受过良好教育的人，不一定更善良；能够分析复杂问题的人，也可能用聪明为自己辩护。

一、聪明不能自动带来正直

知识可以扩大人的能力，却不能决定能力被用在哪里。

同样的技术，可以医治，也可以伤害；同样的语言能力，可以澄清真相，也可以包装谎言。

问题不只在头脑知道多少，也在心愿意服事什么。

二、知识分子也在罪性之中

知识分子容易看见社会的盲点，却不容易看见自己的盲点。

我们可能批评权力，却渴望自己的影响力；批评别人的偏见，却把自己的立场当作绝对中立。

原罪不是说人毫无价值，而是说人的理性、意志和欲望都可能偏离。

没有任何职业、学历或思想传统，能让人自动免于自欺。

三、审判从诚实面对自己开始

我们喜欢审判一个时代，却很少审问自己的动机。

我写这句话，是为了寻找真理，还是为了证明自己优越？

我保持沉默，是出于智慧，还是出于害怕失去位置？

真正的反思，不只是分析别人，也让光照进自己。

四、恩典使知识重新成为服事

恩典不是反对理性。

恩典把理性从骄傲中释放出来，让知识重新成为服务人的工具。

一个被恩典触摸的人，可以承认不知道，可以修正观点，也可以在真理面前放下名声。

谦卑不是知识的敌人，而是知识不被偶像化的保护。

结语：让头脑与灵魂一同苏醒

世界需要有学问的人，更需要有良知、有勇气、肯悔改的人。

知识能够照亮道路，却不能代替人走路；理性能够指出问题，却不能单独医治人心。

愿我们的头脑保持清醒，灵魂也保持柔软，使所知道的真理，最终成为对人的爱与服事。

English Version

Knowledge Cannot Redeem the Soul

Reason, Sin, and the Need for Grace

Knowledge matters.

It helps us see facts, identify error, and contribute to human progress.

Yet history also reminds us that educated people are not automatically kind, and those who analyze complex problems may use intelligence to defend themselves.

1. Intelligence Does Not Automatically Produce Integrity

Knowledge increases human ability, but it does not determine how that ability will be used.

The same technology may heal or harm. The same gift of language may clarify truth or decorate a lie.

The question is not only how much the mind knows, but what the heart is willing to serve.

2. Intellectuals Also Share Human Brokenness

Intellectuals may see the blind spots of society while remaining unable to see their own.

We may criticize power while desiring influence for ourselves. We may expose the bias of others while imagining that our own position is perfectly neutral.

Original sin does not mean human beings have no value. It means that reason, desire, and will can all become distorted.

No profession, degree, or intellectual tradition makes a person automatically free from self-deception.

3. Judgment Begins with Honest Self-Examination

We find it easier to judge an age than to examine our motives.

Am I writing to seek truth, or to prove my superiority?

Am I silent because silence is wise, or because I fear losing my position?

Real reflection does not only analyze others. It allows light to enter the self.

4. Grace Returns Knowledge to Service

Grace is not an enemy of reason.

Grace frees reason from pride and returns knowledge to the work of serving people.

Those touched by grace can admit uncertainty, revise an opinion, and release reputation when truth requires it.

Humility is not the enemy of knowledge. It protects knowledge from becoming an idol.

Conclusion: Let Mind and Soul Awaken Together

The world needs learned people. It also needs people of conscience, courage, and repentance.

Knowledge can illuminate a road, but it cannot walk the road for us. Reason can identify a wound, but it cannot heal the human heart by itself.

May our minds remain clear and our souls remain tender, so that what we know as truth may finally become love and service.

当思想向权力低头

Guarding Conscience Under Pressure

思想的投降，很少从一句公开的谎言开始。

它常常从一次小小的沉默开始。

明明知道事情不完全真实，却因为害怕麻烦而不说；明明看见别人受到不公，却告诉自己：“这不关我的事。”

一、压力会改变人说话的方式

人在压力下，会本能地保护自己。

这并不总是可耻。谨慎有时是必要的。

但谨慎若逐渐变成自我欺骗，人就会开始修改记忆、降低标准，最后甚至相信自己曾经不愿相信的事。

二、思想自由首先是内在诚实

自由不只是能够公开说什么。

更深的自由，是一个人在无人知道时，仍然不欺骗自己的良知。

他可以暂时不说，却不把黑说成白；可以等待合宜时机，却不因利益重新定义真理。

这种内在诚实，是任何环境都无法轻易夺走的空间。

三、勇气也需要智慧

守住良知，不等于在每个场合用最激烈的方式表达。

有时候需要公开说话，有时候需要保存证据，有时候需要保护家人，也有时候需要用故事、提问和长期行动表达。

勇气若没有智慧，可能只留下伤害；智慧若没有勇气，则容易变成精致的逃避。

四、给思想保留安静的地方

一个人若每天只听同一种声音，很难保持分辨。

我们需要阅读，需要祷告，需要与诚实的人对话，也需要在安静中检查：我现在相信的，是经过思考的信念，还是为了生存而形成的习惯？

结语：不要把里面的光交出去

环境可能限制表达，却不必决定灵魂。

真正危险的，不只是不能说话，而是我们渐渐不再愿意思考；不只是外面有压力，而是里面开始以谎言换取安全。

愿我们谨慎，却不虚假；柔和，却不麻木；懂得等待，也始终守住心里那一点不可出卖的光。

English Version

When Thought Bows to Power

Guarding Conscience Under Pressure

The surrender of thought rarely begins with a public lie.

It often begins with a small silence.

We know something is not entirely true, but we remain quiet to avoid trouble. We see someone treated unjustly and tell ourselves, "This is not my concern."

1. Pressure Changes the Way We Speak

Under pressure, human beings naturally protect themselves.

That instinct is not always shameful. Caution can be necessary.

But when caution slowly becomes self-deception, people begin to revise memory, lower standards, and eventually believe what they once refused to believe.

2. Freedom of Thought Begins with Inner Honesty

Freedom is not only the ability to speak publicly.

A deeper freedom remains when people refuse to deceive their own conscience, even where no one can see.

They may remain silent for a time without calling darkness light. They may wait for an appropriate moment without redefining truth for personal advantage.

3. Courage Also Needs Wisdom

Guarding conscience does not require the loudest possible expression in every setting.

Sometimes courage speaks publicly. Sometimes it preserves evidence, protects family, asks careful questions, tells stories, or continues faithful action over time.

Courage without wisdom may leave unnecessary harm. Wisdom without courage may become refined avoidance.

4. Preserve a Quiet Place for Thought

Those who hear only one kind of voice each day will struggle to maintain discernment.

We need reading, prayer, honest conversation, and quiet self-examination.

Do I believe this because I have thought carefully, or because survival has trained me not to question it?

Conclusion: Do Not Surrender the Inner Light

Circumstances may limit expression, but they do not need to define the soul.

The greatest danger is not only that we cannot speak. It is that we no longer wish to think; not only that pressure surrounds us, but that we begin to exchange truth for security within.

May we be cautious without becoming false, gentle without becoming numb, patient without surrendering the light that conscience must never sell.

当知识不再服事真理

The Calling and Responsibility of Intellectual Life

知识分子的价值，不只是知道得多。

更重要的是，他愿意让所知道的，接受真理的检验。

如果知识只用来装饰身份、换取位置或服务某种既定结论，它就会失去照亮人的能力。

一、知识首先是一份托付

能够阅读、研究、写作和影响公众，是一种恩赐，也是一份责任。

一个人的文字可能塑造别人的判断，研究可能影响制度，课堂上的一句话也可能进入年轻人的生命。

因此，知识不能只问“这对我有没有好处”，也要问“这是否真实，是否公正，是否有益于人”。

二、真理不属于任何阵营

当人把真理完全绑在自己的群体上，就很容易只揭露对方的问题，隐藏自己人的错误。

但真理不会因为谁说而改变。

知识分子的责任，不是永远证明自己的阵营正确，而是在事实改变时愿意修正，在自己人犯错时仍然保持诚实。

三、语言可以照亮，也可以遮蔽

受过训练的人，往往更会使用语言。

这使他能够解释复杂问题，也使他更有能力把简单的错误包装得合理。

当术语成为烟雾，逻辑成为逃避，道德语言成为争取掌声的工具，知识就不再服事真理，而开始服事自我。

四、谦卑是思想的纪律

谦卑不是没有立场。

谦卑是承认自己的视野有限，愿意听取证据，愿意说“我可能错了”，也愿意让受影响的人进入讨论。

真正可靠的思想，不怕问题，也不靠羞辱提问者来保护自己。

结语：让知识成为光，而不是墙

世界已经有太多聪明的辩护，真正缺少的是诚实的见证。

愿写作者、教师、研究者和传道人都记得：知识不是用来把自己抬高，而是用来帮助人看见。

当知识向真理负责，它就成为光；当知识只向利益负责，它就会变成一堵遮挡光的墙。

English Version

When Knowledge No Longer Serves Truth

The Calling and Responsibility of Intellectual Life

The value of intellectual life is not simply knowing more.

Its deeper value lies in allowing what we know to be tested by truth.

When knowledge becomes decoration for identity, a path to position, or a servant of predetermined conclusions, it loses its ability to illuminate.

1. Knowledge Is a Trust

The ability to read, research, write, teach, and influence the public is both a gift and a responsibility.

Words can shape judgment. Research can influence institutions. A sentence in a classroom may enter a young person's life for years.

Knowledge must therefore ask more than, "Will this benefit me?" It must also ask, "Is this true? Is it just? Does it serve people well?"

2. Truth Does Not Belong to a Camp

When people bind truth completely to their own group, they expose the failures of opponents and hide the failures of friends.

Truth does not change according to the identity of the speaker.

The responsibility of intellectual life is not to prove that one's group is always right. It is to revise conclusions when facts change and remain honest when one's own side fails.

3. Language Can Illuminate or Conceal

Educated people often use language with greater skill.

That skill can explain complexity. It can also make simple wrongdoing sound reasonable.

When terminology becomes smoke, logic becomes avoidance, and moral language becomes a tool for applause, knowledge no longer serves truth. It begins to serve the self.

4. Humility Is an Intellectual Discipline

Humility does not mean having no convictions.

It means admitting that our vision is limited, listening to evidence, saying "I may be wrong," and allowing affected people to enter the conversation.

Reliable thought does not fear questions or protect itself by humiliating those who ask them.

Conclusion: Let Knowledge Become Light, Not a Wall

The world already has many intelligent defenses. What it lacks is honest witness.

May writers, teachers, researchers, and pastors remember that knowledge is not given to elevate the self. It is given to help people see.

When knowledge answers to truth, it becomes light. When it answers only to advantage, it becomes a wall that blocks the light.

第六辑：在盟约中相爱：婚姻的根基

夫妻之间的信任：婚姻的根基

在婚姻关系中，信任不是锦上添花的装饰，而是承重的根基。

一段婚姻可以没有太多浪漫，却不能没有信任。浪漫让人心动，信任却让人安心。浪漫常常出现在特殊时刻，信任却是在每天的言语、选择、态度和行动中，一点一点累积起来的。

信任不是一句“我爱你”就能建立，也不是一纸婚约自动带来的结果。它需要夫妻在日常生活中，用真诚、接纳、理解和守约，慢慢养成。

一、信任从真诚开始

信任首先来自坦诚。

坦诚不是把所有话都毫无分寸地说出来，而是在关系中不戴面具、不故意隐藏、不用沉默制造距离。

夫妻若能彼此分享真实的感受、软弱、恐惧和期待，就像慢慢把心门打开，让对方进入生命中更柔软的地方。

很多婚姻的距离，并不是从大事开始，而是从小小的隐藏开始。

有话不说，有伤不讲，有不安不表达，久而久之，心就会越来越远。

真诚，是信任的第一块石头。

二、信任需要安全感滋养

信任不是一次建立、永远不变的东西。

它像一株幼苗，需要安全感的土壤。

安全感来自什么？

来自尊重，来自聆听，来自稳定的陪伴，也来自一种让对方知道“我不会轻易离开你”的委身。

当丈夫或妻子能够用行动表达：

“我在这里。”

“我看见你。”

“我愿意听你说。”

“我不会用你的软弱伤害你。”

对方心里那根紧绷的弦，才会慢慢放松。

三、信任要在冲突中重建

没有一段婚姻完全没有冲突。

冲突会考验信任，也可能重建信任。

关键不在于夫妻会不会争执，而在于争执之后，是否仍愿意回到关系中。

当冲突来临时，选择冷静聆听，而不是急着定罪；选择真诚道歉，而不是自我防御；选择一起面对问题，而不是把所有责任推给对方。

这样的态度，能让信任在受伤之后重新生长。

有时候，信任不是从没有破裂过的完美中来，而是从愿意修复的诚实中来。

四、信任在信仰中更深

对基督徒夫妻而言，信任不仅是彼此之间的承诺，也是在神面前的交托。

圣经说：

“凡事包容，凡事相信，凡事盼望，凡事忍耐。”（林前 13:7，和合本）

这不是鼓励盲目相信，也不是纵容伤害，而是提醒我们：爱里面有一种愿意守护关系、愿意给人更新机会的力量。

夫妻若能一起祷告、一起等候、一起把婚姻交托给神，就会在信仰的根基上，找到比情绪更深的安全感。

结语：让信任成为家的桥梁

信任像婚姻中的桥。

桥让两颗心可以自由往来，可以分享喜乐，也可以承载忧伤。

亲爱的夫妻，信任从来不是理所当然的。它需要一生经营，也需要每天呵护。

愿我们用真诚建立信任，用接纳保护信任，用悔改修复信任，也在神的爱中彼此守望。

这样的婚姻，才会像一棵深深扎根的树，经历风雨，仍能结出甘美的果子。

English Version

Trust Between Husband and Wife

In marriage, trust is not a decoration added to love. It is the foundation that carries the relationship.

A marriage may survive with little romance, but it cannot remain healthy without trust. Romance moves the heart; trust gives the heart a place to rest. Romance often appears in special moments, but trust is built slowly through daily words, choices, attitudes, and actions.

Trust is not created by simply saying, “I love you.” Nor does it automatically appear because a couple is legally married. It is formed over time through honesty, acceptance, understanding, and covenant faithfulness.

1. Trust Begins with Honesty

Trust begins with honesty.

Honesty does not mean saying everything without wisdom or boundaries. It means refusing to wear a mask in the relationship, refusing to hide intentionally, and refusing to use silence to create distance.

When a husband and wife can share their true feelings, weaknesses, fears, and expectations, they slowly open the door of the heart and allow the other person into a tender place.

Many marriages do not grow distant because of one large event. They drift apart through small habits of hiding.

Words are left unsaid. Wounds are not expressed. Anxiety is kept inside. Over time, two hearts grow farther apart.

Honesty is the first stone in the foundation of trust.

2. Trust Needs the Soil of Safety

Trust is not built once and then left alone forever.

It is like a young plant. It needs the soil of emotional safety.

Where does safety come from?

It comes from respect, listening, steady companionship, and the covenant assurance that says, “I will not leave you easily.”

When a husband or wife communicates through action,

“I am here.”

“I see you.”

“I am willing to listen.”

“I will not use your weakness against you.”

the other person's tense heart slowly begins to relax.

3. Trust Must Be Rebuilt in Conflict

No marriage is completely free from conflict.

Conflict tests trust, but it can also rebuild trust.

The key is not whether a couple ever argues. The key is whether, after conflict, they are willing to return to the relationship.

When conflict comes, choose to listen calmly instead of accusing quickly. Choose sincere apology instead of self-defense. Choose to face the problem together instead of placing all the blame on the other person.

Such choices allow trust to grow again after hurt.

Sometimes trust does not come from a perfect relationship that has never been wounded. It comes from honest repair.

4. Trust Deepens in Faith

For Christian couples, trust is not only a commitment to one another. It is also an act of entrusting the marriage to God.

Scripture says:

"bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, and endures all things." (1 Corinthians 13:7, WEB)

This does not encourage blind trust or excuse harm. It reminds us that love carries a strength that protects relationship and gives room for renewal.

When a husband and wife pray together, wait together, and place their marriage in God's hands, they find a security deeper than emotion.

Conclusion: Let Trust Become a Bridge at Home

Trust is like a bridge in marriage.

It allows two hearts to move freely toward one another, sharing joy and carrying sorrow.

Dear couples, trust is never automatic. It must be cultivated over a lifetime and protected each day.

May we build trust through honesty, protect it through acceptance, repair it through repentance, and watch over one another in the love of God.

Such a marriage becomes like a deeply rooted tree, able to bear sweet fruit through changing seasons.

夫妻之间的谦让：爱的智慧

婚姻里的谦让，不是简单地“谁让着谁”，也不是一方永远退到角落里，把自己的感受、需要和尊严都压下去。

真正的谦让，是两个人在爱中学习放下“我一定要赢”的执念，转而追求“我们怎样一起更好”。

很多夫妻的冲突，并不是因为事情本身多么严重，而是因为两个人都想证明自己是正确的。话题可能只是晚饭吃什么、孩子怎么管、钱该怎么花、假期去哪里，但背后真正较劲的，往往是面子、控制感和被理解的需要。

圣经说：

“又当存敬畏基督的心，彼此顺服。”（弗 5:21，和合本）

这句话很宝贵。它不是要求一方单方面忍让，而是把夫妻双方都放在基督面前，让两个人都学习在敬畏主的心里彼此成全。

一、谦让不是软弱，而是爱的力量

有些人误解谦让，以为谦让就是没有立场、没有原则、没有主见。

其实不是。

在婚姻里，真正有力量的人，不一定是声音最大的人，而是能在情绪上来时仍然停一停、想一想、退一步的人。

能够谦让，说明一个人不被情绪牵着走；能够让步，说明一个人看重关系胜过一时的输赢。

软弱的人常常必须赢，因为他害怕失去控制；成熟的人可以让，因为他知道爱比面子更重要。

二、从“争输赢”到“护关系”

夫妻吵架时，最容易把对方看成对手。

一旦把配偶当成对手，接下来的话就会越来越硬，语气越来越冷，心也越来越远。

但婚姻不是辩论赛。

夫妻不是要分出谁赢谁输，而是要一起守住这个家。

有时候，丈夫先道歉，不代表他全错了；妻子先退一步，也不代表她没有道理。很多时候，先放软的人，是先看见关系价值的人。

谦让不是否定事实，而是在处理事实之前，先保护彼此的心。

三、谦让需要边界，不是纵容错误

需要说明的是，谦让不是纵容。

如果一方长期操控、羞辱、冷暴力、经济控制，甚至有身体伤害，另一方不能把“谦让”误解成无限忍耐。

圣经中的爱不是让罪继续扩散，也不是让受伤的人永远沉默。

健康的谦让，是在真理与爱中的让步；不健康的退让，是在惧怕中的压抑。

所以，夫妻之间的谦让必须有边界：

可以让步，但不能失去尊严。

可以包容，但不能纵容伤害。

可以先和好，但不能逃避问题。

可以为爱退一步，但不能让罪恶继续掌权。

四、谦让从小事开始

真正的谦让，常常不在大事上，而在小事里。

谁先关灯。

谁先说一句“算了”。

谁先把语气放低。

谁先承认“我刚才说重了”。

谁先把对方的需要放进自己的计划里。

这些看似微小的选择，会一点一点塑造婚姻的气候。

一个家若长期充满争夺，空气会变得紧张；一个家若常常有谦让，空气会慢慢变得柔和。

五、在基督里彼此成全

基督徒的婚姻，不只是两个人性格的磨合，更是两个人在基督里被塑造。

谦让不是靠脾气好撑出来的，也不是靠“算了吧”糊弄过去的。

真正的谦让来自一个更深的认识：我不是婚姻的中心，基督才是。

当丈夫和妻子都愿意在主面前放下骄傲，婚姻就不再只是两个人互相比较，而成为两个人一同被恩典更新。

结语：让爱胜过输赢

婚姻里最伤人的，不一定是大风大浪，而是日复一日的小争执、小不满、小较劲。

而谦让，就是在这些细小的地方，让爱重新占上风。

愿夫妻都学习在敬畏基督的心里彼此顺服，既不压抑自己，也不伤害对方；既守住真理，也保守温柔。

因为真正幸福的婚姻，不是永远没有不同意见，而是两个人即使意见不同，仍然愿意为了爱，彼此靠近。

English Version

Mutual Yielding in Marriage: The Wisdom of Love

Yielding in marriage is not simply about “who gives in.” Nor does it mean that one person must always retreat, silence personal needs, or lose dignity.

True yielding means that two people learn, in love, to lay down the desire to win and ask a better question: How can we become better together?

Many conflicts between husband and wife are not really about the issue itself. The topic may be dinner, children, money, schedules, or holidays. But beneath the surface, the real struggle is often about pride, control, and the longing to be understood.

Scripture says:

“submitting yourselves to one another in the fear of Christ.” (Ephesians 5:21, WEB)

This verse is precious. It does not ask one spouse to surrender endlessly. It places both husband and wife before Christ, calling both to honor, serve, and build up one another.

1. Yielding Is Not Weakness

Some people misunderstand yielding. They think it means having no position, no principle, and no voice.

But true yielding is not weakness.

In marriage, the stronger person is not always the one with the louder voice. Often, strength is seen in the one who can pause when emotions rise, soften the tone, and choose the relationship over the argument.

The insecure person must always win because losing feels threatening. The mature person can yield because love matters more than pride.

2. From Winning Arguments to Guarding the Relationship

When couples argue, they can easily begin to see each other as opponents.

Once a spouse becomes an opponent, words grow harder, tones become colder, and hearts move farther apart.

But marriage is not a debate tournament.

Husband and wife are not called to defeat each other. They are called to guard the home together.

Sometimes a husband apologizes first, not because he was entirely wrong. Sometimes a wife takes the first step back, not because she had no reason to be hurt. Often, the one who softens first is the one who first sees the value of the relationship.

Yielding does not deny the facts. It protects the heart before the facts are processed.

3. Yielding Needs Boundaries

This must be said clearly: yielding is not enabling.

If one spouse repeatedly controls, humiliates, manipulates, abuses financially, uses emotional violence, or causes physical harm, the other spouse should not confuse “yielding” with endless endurance.

Biblical love does not allow sin to grow unchecked. It does not require the wounded to remain silent forever.

Healthy yielding is shaped by truth and love. Unhealthy surrender is suppression under fear.

So yielding in marriage must have boundaries.

You may yield, but you must not lose dignity.

You may show patience, but you must not enable harm.

You may pursue reconciliation, but you must not avoid necessary truth.

You may step back for love, but you must not let sin rule the home.

4. Yielding Begins in Small Things

True yielding usually begins not in major decisions, but in small moments.

Who turns off the light.

Who lowers the voice first.

Who says, “I spoke too harshly.”

Who adjusts the plan to include the other person’s need.

These small choices gradually shape the atmosphere of a marriage.

A home filled with constant competition becomes tense. A home shaped by mutual yielding slowly becomes gentle.

5. Building One Another in Christ

Christian marriage is not merely the adjustment of two personalities. It is the shaping of two lives in Christ.

Yielding is not sustained by a naturally easy temper. It is not the same as avoiding conflict.

True yielding grows from a deeper conviction: I am not the center of this marriage. Christ is.

When husband and wife both lay down pride before the Lord, marriage becomes more than negotiation. It becomes a place where grace renews both people.

Conclusion: Let Love Win Over Winning

In marriage, the deepest wounds are not always caused by major storms. Often, they come from daily small arguments, small resentments, and small competitions.

Yielding is one way love takes the lead again in those ordinary moments.

May husbands and wives learn to submit to one another out of reverence for Christ, neither suppressing themselves nor harming each other, holding truth and gentleness together.

A blessed marriage is not one without disagreement. It is one where, even in disagreement, two people still choose to move toward one another in love.

夫妻的磨合之旅

婚姻不是童话，更像两条河流的汇合。

两个人带着各自的性格、习惯、价值观和成长背景，进入同一个家。起初有甜蜜，也有期待；但日子久了，就会发现：真正的婚姻不只是相爱，更是磨合。

圣经说：

“因此，人要离开父母，与妻子连合，二人成为一体。”（创 2:24，和合本）

“成为一体”不是一瞬间完成的浪漫，而是一生不断学习的功课。它不只是身体的联合，也是心灵、生活、责任和使命的联合。

一、三观的碰撞与对齐

夫妻之间的世界观、人生观和价值观，会深深影响婚姻。

有人重视事业，有人看重家庭；有人喜欢节俭，有人重视生活品质；有人凡事先计划，有人更随性；有人用信仰理解人生，有人更多停留在眼前感受。

如果三观长期无法对齐，夫妻就容易在关键问题上越走越远。

圣经提醒我们：

“又当存敬畏基督的心，彼此顺服。”（弗 5:21，和合本）

信仰不是夫妻逃避差异的理由，而是帮助他们在差异中寻找共同方向的根基。

当两个人愿意在神的话语中重新看待婚姻、家庭、金钱、时间和使命，三观的磨合就不再只是争执，而成为一起被神调整的过程。

二、性格的差异与互补

性格是神给人的独特礼物，也可能成为婚姻中的挑战。

一个外向，一个安静；一个喜欢计划，一个随遇而安；一个表达快，一个消化慢。这些差异，常常让夫妻在沟通和决策中产生张力。

圣经说：

“爱是恒久忍耐，又有恩慈；爱是不嫉妒；爱是不自夸，不张狂。”（林前 13:4，和合本）

性格差异本身不是问题，关键在于是否愿意用爱去理解和接纳。

一个安静的人，可能成为家庭中的稳定；一个积极的人，可能带来新的动力。差异若被骄傲使用，就会变成冲突；若被爱使用，就会成为互补。

三、生活习惯的调适

婚姻最真实的考验，常常藏在小事里。

作息时间、饮食偏好、家务分担、消费习惯、整洁标准，这些看似琐碎，却很容易成为日复一日的摩擦。

圣经说：

“凡事都要规规矩矩地按着次序行。”（林前 14:40，和合本）

夫妻可以一起学习建立适合家庭的秩序：怎样分担家务，怎样安排休息，怎样尊重彼此的节奏，怎样在小事上少一点固执、多一点体贴。

爱并不总是宏大的牺牲。很多时候，爱就是愿意为对方调整一点点。

四、原生家庭的影响与更新

每个人都带着原生家庭的痕迹进入婚姻。

有人在争吵中长大，所以害怕冲突；有人习惯被迁就，所以不容易看见别人的需要；有人从小缺乏安全感，所以在婚姻中过度敏感。

如果这些模式不被认识，就可能在婚姻中重演。

圣经说：

“若有人在基督里，他就是新造的人，旧事已过，都变成新的了。”（林后 5:17，和合本）

信仰给夫妻一个新的起点。我们不必永远被过去定义，也不必把上一代的伤带进下一代。

夫妻可以坦诚分享自己的成长背景，也可以一起祷告，求神医治旧伤，建立新的家庭文化。

结语：磨合是爱的雕刻

夫妻的磨合不是彼此消耗，而是彼此成全。

三观的对齐、性格的互补、习惯的调适、旧伤的更新，都是神在婚姻中给我们的属灵功课。

愿每一对夫妻都在这条磨合之路上，少一点控诉，多一点理解；少一点坚持己见，多一点共同成长。

让婚姻不只是两个人一起生活，而是两个人在神的恩典中，一起被塑造、一起成熟、一起成为爱的见证。

English Version

The Journey of Adjustment in Marriage

Marriage is not a fairy tale. It is more like two rivers joining together.

Two people bring their personalities, habits, values, and family backgrounds into one home. At first there is sweetness and expectation. But over time, they discover that marriage is not only about loving each other. It is also about learning to adjust to one another.

Scripture says:

“Therefore a man will leave his father and his mother, and will join with his wife, and they will be one flesh.” (Genesis 2:24, WEB)

Becoming one is not a romantic moment completed in an instant. It is a lifelong lesson. It is not only physical union, but also the union of heart, life, responsibility, and calling.

1. Aligning Values

A couple's worldview, view of life, and values deeply shape their marriage.

One may value career, while the other values family time. One may prefer simplicity, while the other cares about quality of life. One may plan everything, while the other is more spontaneous. One may interpret life through faith, while the other is more driven by immediate feelings.

If values remain misaligned for a long time, a couple can slowly drift apart on important matters.

Scripture reminds us:

“submitting yourselves to one another in the fear of Christ.” (Ephesians 5:21, WEB)

Faith is not an excuse to avoid differences. It is the foundation that helps a couple seek common direction in the midst of differences.

When two people are willing to let God's Word reshape how they view marriage, family, money, time, and mission, adjustment becomes not merely an argument, but a shared process of being formed by God.

2. Differences in Personality Can Become Gifts

Personality is a unique gift from God, but it can also become a challenge in marriage.

One person is outgoing, the other quiet. One loves planning, the other is flexible. One speaks quickly, the other needs time to process. Such differences often create tension in communication and decision-making.

Scripture says:

“Love is patient and is kind. Love doesn't envy. Love doesn't brag, is not proud,” (1 Corinthians 13:4, WEB)

Personality difference itself is not the problem. The key is whether we are willing to understand and receive one another in love.

A quiet person may bring stability to the home. An active person may bring new energy. When differences are handled with pride, they become conflict. When handled with love, they become complement.

3. Adjusting Daily Habits

The most honest tests of marriage are often hidden in small things.

Schedules, food preferences, household responsibilities, spending habits, and standards of cleanliness may seem minor, but they can become daily sources of friction.

Scripture says:

“Let all things be done decently and in order.” (1 Corinthians 14:40, WEB)

Couples can learn to build a healthy order for their home: how to share chores, how to arrange rest, how to respect each other’s rhythm, and how to show more consideration in small matters.

Love is not always a grand sacrifice. Often, love is the willingness to adjust a little for the other person.

4. Family Background and Renewal

Everyone enters marriage carrying marks from their family of origin.

Some grew up around conflict and therefore fear disagreement. Some were always accommodated and therefore struggle to see another person’s needs. Some lacked security growing up and therefore become overly sensitive in marriage.

If these patterns are not recognized, they may repeat themselves in the new family.

Scripture says:

“Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old things have passed away. Behold, all things have become new.” (2 Corinthians 5:17, WEB)

Faith gives a couple a new beginning. We do not have to be forever defined by the past. Nor do we have to pass the wounds of one generation to the next.

Husband and wife can honestly share their backgrounds and pray together, asking God to heal old wounds and build a new family culture.

Conclusion: Adjustment Is Love Being Shaped

Adjustment in marriage is not meant to consume one another. It is meant to help a couple become more complete together. Aligning values, receiving personality differences, adjusting daily habits, and healing old wounds are all spiritual lessons God gives within marriage.

May every couple walk this road with less accusation and more understanding, less stubbornness and more shared growth, so that marriage becomes not merely two people living together, but two lives being shaped, matured, and made into a witness of love by the grace of God.

离婚的原因与在基督里的医治

离婚很少从签字的那一天才开始。

在关系正式破裂以前，夫妻之间往往已经经历了漫长的疏远：话越来越少，误解越来越深，失望一次次累积，最后连争吵都变成了沉默。

面对离婚，我们既不能轻率定罪，也不能把所有责任模糊成一句“性格不合”。每段婚姻都有自己的故事，但若愿意诚实回望，破裂通常会显出一些可以辨认的轨迹。

一、沟通停止，心就逐渐远离

有些夫妻每天生活在一起，却只谈孩子、账单和家务，不再分享内心。

当真实感受长期得不到表达，猜测就会代替理解；当每次沟通都变成攻击或防御，人便会选择沉默。

沉默表面上减少了冲突，实际上也可能切断关系的血液。

医治的起点，不是一次把所有问题说清楚，而是重新学习安全地说、耐心地听。若夫妻已经无法独自进行这样的对话，成熟的牧养陪伴或合格婚姻专业人士可以帮助他们重新建立沟通的秩序。

二、未处理的伤，会进入新的冲突

婚姻中的问题，有时并不只属于婚姻。

原生家庭留下的恐惧、过去关系中的背叛、长期被忽视的羞耻，以及从未被安慰的失落，都可能在亲密关系中重新出现。

一个人可能因为害怕被抛弃而过度控制，也可能因为害怕冲突而不断退缩。若只处理眼前的争执，却不触碰深处的伤口，同样的问题就会换一种形式回来。

在基督里的医治，不是要求人忘记过去，而是让过去不再决定今天。承认伤口、接受帮助、学习新的回应方式，都是属灵成长的一部分。

三、背叛、暴力与控制，不能被属灵语言遮盖

有些婚姻的破裂涉及出轨、欺骗、成瘾、遗弃、家庭暴力、性暴力或严重控制。

面对这些处境，教会不能只劝受伤者“多忍耐”，也不能用“饶恕”催促其立即恢复共同生活。

饶恕不等于取消真相，恩典也不取消责任。真实的悔改必须包括停止伤害、承认事实、接受问责、尊重界限，并用持续行动证明改变。

若有人处于即时危险，应先寻求当地紧急服务、家庭暴力资源、法律援助和合格专业人士的帮助。保护生命不是背弃婚姻，而是拒绝让伤害继续。

四、修复需要两个人承担，但不能强求相同速度

婚姻若要重建，通常需要双方都愿意面对问题。

犯错的一方需要承担责任，受伤的一方则需要有悲伤、思考和辨明的空间。不能要求两个人在同一天恢复信任，也不能把“赶快翻篇”当作属灵成熟。

修复不是回到从前，而是建立一种从前没有的真实。

有些婚姻会经过悔改、辅导和长期重建而重新得力；有些关系则因持续危险或另一方拒绝改变，无法恢复共同生活。牧养者应陪伴当事人在经文、事实、安全、孩子需要和当地法律之间谨慎辨别，而不是替复杂个案作仓促裁决。

五、在基督里，破碎的人仍有未来

离婚会带来哀伤，也可能带来羞耻、孤单和对未来的恐惧。

但人的身份不应被一段失败的关系完全定义。

圣经说：

“耶和華靠近伤心的人，拯救灵性痛悔的人。”（诗 34:18，和合本）

基督的医治不一定把人生恢复成原来的样子，却能使破碎的人重新学习信任、建立界限、承担责任，也重新领受盼望。

教会应成为这样的地方：既尊重婚姻盟约，也保护受伤的人；既呼召犯罪者悔改，也不把破裂者永远钉在羞耻里。

结语：医治从真相与恩典相遇开始

婚姻破裂没有简单答案。

我们需要真相，使伤害不再被隐藏；需要责任，使悔改不只停留在言语；需要界限，使安全得到保护；也需要恩典，使人不被过去判处终身。

愿仍在婚姻危机中的夫妻，不轻易放弃，也不假装平安；愿已经走过离婚的人，不被羞耻吞没，而能在基督里重新站立。

因为破裂可以成为人生的一章，却不必成为生命的结局。

English Version

Why Marriages Break Down

Finding Healing in Christ

Divorce rarely begins on the day the papers are signed.

Long before a marriage formally ends, a couple may have lived through growing distance: fewer honest conversations, deeper misunderstandings, accumulated disappointment, and finally a silence in which even conflict disappears.

We should neither condemn people carelessly nor reduce every broken marriage to “incompatibility.” Each story is different, but honest reflection often reveals patterns that need attention.

1. When Communication Stops, Hearts Drift Apart

Some couples live together but speak only about children, bills, and household tasks. They no longer share their inner lives.

When feelings remain unspoken, assumptions replace understanding. When every conversation becomes attack and defense, silence begins to feel safer.

Silence may reduce visible conflict while slowly cutting off connection.

Healing can begin with learning to speak safely and listen patiently. When a couple can no longer do this alone, mature pastoral support or a qualified marriage professional may help restore a healthier pattern of communication.

2. Unhealed Wounds Enter New Conflicts

Some marital struggles began before the marriage itself.

Fear from one’s family of origin, betrayal in earlier relationships, buried shame, and grief that was never comforted may all reappear in intimacy.

One spouse may control because of fear of abandonment. Another may withdraw because conflict feels dangerous. If a couple addresses only the present argument and not the deeper wound, the same pain often returns in another form.

Healing in Christ does not require forgetting the past. It means the past no longer has to govern the present. Naming wounds, receiving help, and learning new responses are part of spiritual growth.

3. Betrayal, Violence, and Control Must Not Be Hidden by Spiritual Language

Some marriages involve infidelity, deception, addiction, abandonment, domestic violence, sexual violence, or coercive control.

In these situations, the church must not merely tell the injured person to “endure,” nor use forgiveness to pressure someone into immediate reunion.

Forgiveness does not cancel truth, and grace does not cancel responsibility. Genuine repentance includes stopping the harm, acknowledging the facts, accepting accountability, respecting boundaries, and demonstrating change over time.

Anyone in immediate danger should first seek local emergency services, domestic violence resources, legal assistance, and qualified professional care. Protecting life is not abandoning marriage; it is refusing to let harm continue.

4. Repair Requires Shared Responsibility but Not an Identical Timetable

Rebuilding usually requires both spouses to face the problem.

The person who caused harm must accept responsibility. The wounded spouse needs room to grieve, reflect, and discern. Trust cannot be restored on demand, and “moving on quickly” is not proof of spiritual maturity.

Repair is not a return to the old relationship. It is the building of a more truthful one.

Some marriages regain strength through repentance, counseling, and long-term rebuilding. Others cannot safely resume because harm continues or one person refuses responsibility. Pastoral care should help people discern carefully among Scripture, facts, safety, children’s needs, and local law rather than impose a rushed verdict.

5. In Christ, Broken People Still Have a Future

Divorce brings grief and may also bring shame, loneliness, and fear of the future.

Yet a person’s identity should not be defined entirely by a broken relationship.

Scripture says:

*“Yahweh is near to those who have a broken heart, and saves those who have a crushed spirit.”
(Psalm 34:18, WEB)*

Christ’s healing may not restore life to its former shape. It can, however, help wounded people learn trust again, establish wise boundaries, take responsibility, and receive hope.

The church should be a community that honors marriage and protects the wounded, calls wrongdoers to repentance, and refuses to imprison broken people in permanent shame.

Conclusion: Healing Begins Where Truth and Grace Meet

There is no simple answer to marital breakdown.

We need truth so that harm is no longer hidden, responsibility so that repentance becomes more than words, boundaries so that safety is protected, and grace so that the past does not become a life sentence.

May couples in crisis neither surrender carelessly nor pretend that everything is well. May those who have lived through divorce refuse the verdict of shame and learn to stand again in Christ.

Brokenness may become one chapter of a life, but it does not have to become the final chapter.

第七辑：婚姻中的日常操练

冲突中的和好：夫妻吵架的艺术

中国人常说：“夫妻床头吵架床尾和。”

这句话虽然朴素，却藏着一种婚姻智慧：争执再大，也不要让怨气长久停留；情绪再激烈，也要为和好留下空间。

圣经也给我们类似的提醒：

“生气却不要犯罪；不可含怒到日落。”（弗 4:26，和合本）

这句话不是说夫妻不能有情绪，也不是说基督徒家庭永远不会争吵。它提醒我们：情绪可以出现，但不能让情绪掌权；冲突可以发生，但不能让冲突吞噬爱。

一、吵架不是婚姻的终点

两个人带着不同性格、成长背景、生活习惯和表达方式进入婚姻，冲突几乎不可避免。

因此，夫妻吵架不一定说明婚姻失败。

有时候，冲突反而暴露了平时没有被认真听见的需要。

有人生气，是因为觉得不被尊重；有人沉默，是因为害怕再受伤；有人语气激烈，是因为里面有长期积压的委屈。

问题不在于夫妻有没有冲突，而在于冲突之后，是否学会更深地理解彼此。

二、生气，却不要犯罪

圣经没有说“不要生气”。

愤怒有时是人面对伤害、不公或误解时的自然反应。

但圣经提醒我们：生气时不要犯罪。

不要让怒气支配理智。

不要用伤人的话语发泄情绪。

不要把一时的愤怒变成长期的冷战、羞辱或报复。

当冲突来临时，夫妻可以先停下来问自己：

我现在是在表达需要，还是在攻击对方？

我是因为爱而着急，还是因为自我受伤而反击？

我能不能先冷静，再用更温柔的方式说出真实感受？

三、不可含怒到日落

“不可含怒到日落”是一条爱的界限。

它提醒夫妻：不要让怒气在心里过夜，不要让误解有机会生根，不要让冷战成为家的空气。

并不是所有问题都能在一天之内完全解决。

但即使问题还没有解决，关系也可以先回到爱里。

一句“我们明天再谈，但我不想带着怨恨睡觉”，有时比一场争论更有力量。

一个拥抱，一句道歉，一次祷告，都可能成为关系重新打开的门。

当然，如果冲突已经涉及威胁、暴力、严重控制或持续羞辱，就不应只用“当天和好”来处理。保护安全、寻求专业帮助和可信任的牧养陪伴，都是必要的。

四、把冲突变成成长

健康的夫妻不是没有争执，而是知道如何让冲突成为成长。

第一，尊重对方的感受。不要急着否定，先聆听。

第二，不翻旧账。专注眼前的问题，不把过去所有伤口都搬出来。

第三，以和好为目标。婚姻不是辩论赛，赢了道理却输了关系，并不是真赢。

第四，谦卑认错。哪怕对方也有责任，也先看自己可以调整的地方。

圣经说：

“回答柔和，使怒消退；言语暴戾，触动怒气。”（箴 15:1，和合本）

柔和不是软弱，而是一种有力量的节制。

结语：在日落之前回到爱里

夫妻吵架以后，最美的画面不是谁赢了，而是两个人愿意再次靠近。

也许是一句：“对不起，我刚才说话太重了。”

也许是一次安静的拥抱。

也许是两个人一起祷告，求神赐下智慧和医治。

愿每一对夫妻都学会在冲突中守住爱，在生气时不犯罪，在日落之前回到彼此身边。

让争执不成为婚姻的裂缝，而成为更深理解与更真和好的入口。

English Version

Reconciliation in Conflict

A Chinese saying says, “Husband and wife may quarrel at the head of the bed, but make peace at the foot of the bed.”

Simple as it sounds, it carries wisdom: no matter how intense the conflict, resentment should not be allowed to remain for long. No matter how strong the emotion, there must still be room for reconciliation.

Scripture gives a similar reminder:

“Be angry, and don’t sin. Don’t let the sun go down on your wrath.” (Ephesians 4:26, WEB)

This does not mean couples never feel anger. Nor does it mean Christian homes never experience conflict. It reminds us that emotions may arise, but they must not rule us. Conflict may happen, but it must not consume love.

1. Conflict Is Not the End of Marriage

Two people enter marriage with different personalities, backgrounds, habits, and ways of speaking. Conflict is almost inevitable.

Therefore, arguments do not necessarily mean a marriage has failed.

Sometimes conflict reveals needs that have not been heard.

One person may be angry because they feel disrespected. Another may become silent because they fear being hurt again. Someone may speak sharply because years of disappointment have been stored inside.

The issue is not whether a couple has conflict. The issue is whether, after conflict, they learn to understand one another more deeply.

2. Be Angry, but Do Not Sin

Scripture does not say, “Never be angry.”

Anger is sometimes a natural response to hurt, injustice, or misunderstanding.

But Scripture warns us not to sin in our anger.

Do not let anger control reason.

Do not use cruel words to release emotion.

Do not allow a moment of anger to become prolonged coldness, shame, or revenge.

When conflict comes, couples can pause and ask:

Am I expressing a need, or attacking my spouse?

Am I speaking from love, or reacting from wounded pride?

Can I calm down first and then express my true feelings more gently?

3. Do Not Let the Sun Go Down on Anger

“Do not let the sun go down while you are still angry” is a boundary of love.

It reminds couples not to let anger stay overnight, not to give misunderstanding a place to take root, and not to allow coldness to become the atmosphere of the home.

Not every problem can be completely solved in one day.

But even before a problem is fully solved, the relationship can return to love.

The words, “Let’s talk about this tomorrow, but I do not want to go to sleep with resentment,” may carry more power than another round of argument.

An embrace, an apology, or a prayer can reopen the door of relationship.

Of course, if conflict involves threats, violence, serious control, or ongoing humiliation, it should not be handled only by the principle of “making peace before the day ends.” Safety, professional help, and trusted pastoral care may all be necessary.

4. Turning Conflict into Growth

Healthy couples are not those who never disagree. They are those who learn how to let conflict become growth.

First, respect the other person’s feelings. Do not rush to dismiss them. Listen first.

Second, do not bring up every past wound. Stay with the issue at hand.

Third, aim for reconciliation. Marriage is not a debate tournament. Winning an argument while losing closeness is not true victory.

Fourth, apologize humbly. Even when the other person also has responsibility, begin by asking what you can adjust.

Scripture says:

“A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.” (Proverbs 15:1, WEB)

Gentleness is not weakness. It is disciplined strength.

Conclusion: Return to Love Before Sunset

After a conflict, the most beautiful scene is not one person winning, but two people choosing to draw near again.

It may be a simple sentence: “I’m sorry. I spoke too harshly.”

It may be a quiet embrace.

It may be a prayer together, asking God for wisdom and healing.

May every couple learn to guard love in conflict, to be angry without sinning, and to return to one another before sunset.

May conflict become not a crack in marriage, but a doorway to deeper understanding and truer reconciliation.

夫妻之间的情绪管理

婚姻，是两颗心一起面对生活的旅程。

在这段旅程中，情绪的稳定与管理，常常决定一个家的温度。

爱不是没有情绪，而是在情绪来临时，仍然愿意守护关系。若忽视情绪管理，许多小事就会被放大，许多无心的话就会变成伤口，许多原本可以沟通的问题，也会变成长期的距离。

一、情绪影响婚姻的温度

生活中有太多压力：工作、孩子、金钱、健康、服事、家务。

在这些压力之下，夫妻有情绪波动是正常的。

但若情绪不被管理，小事就容易升级为大冲突。

疲惫时的一句不耐烦，生气时的一句重话，委屈时的一次冷战，都可能慢慢刺伤对方。

情绪管理，不是为了让家庭变得没有声音，而是为了让家成为一个更安全的地方。

二、先认识自己的情绪

情绪管理的第一步，是认识并承认自己的情绪。

愤怒、委屈、焦虑、疲惫，这些都是人真实的感受。

问题不在于有情绪，而在于我们是否让情绪直接掌管言语和行动。

当一个人能说：“我现在有点累，需要安静一下。”

或者说：“我有些委屈，但我想等情绪平稳后再谈。”

这不是逃避，而是成熟。

承认情绪，往往比压抑情绪更健康。

三、管理情绪不是否定情绪

情绪管理并不是把所有负面情绪都抹去。

它不是假装不生气，也不是强迫自己永远微笑。

情绪管理，是在情绪来的时候，不被情绪拖着走。

当你想说一句伤人的话时，先停一停。

当你想立刻反击时，先深呼吸。

当你觉得自己快要失控时，可以暂时离开现场，等心安静之后再回来沟通。

很多婚姻的伤，不是因为有情绪，而是因为情绪没有经过爱和节制的过滤。

四、夫妻要彼此支持

情绪稳定不仅是个人操练，也需要夫妻彼此扶持。

当你发现对方情绪波动时，不要急着讲道理，也不要立刻否定。

很多时候，对方首先需要的不是分析，而是被看见。

一句“我看到你很累”，比一堆指责更有力量。

一句“你想跟我说说吗”，比急着纠正更能打开关系。

温柔的聆听，常常是稳定情绪最好的开始。

若情绪问题已经涉及严重抑郁、创伤反应、自伤风险、暴力或长期失控，就需要寻求专业辅导、医疗或危机支持。信仰陪伴很重要，但不应取代必要的专业帮助。

五、在信仰中学习节制

对基督徒夫妻来说，情绪管理也是属灵生命的操练。

圣经说：

“凡较力争胜的，诸事都有节制。”（林前 9:25，和合本）

圣灵所结的果子中，也包括节制。

当我们愿意把情绪带到神面前，承认自己的有限，求主赐下平安和温柔，我们就更有力量在婚姻中不被情绪支配。

节制不是压抑，而是让爱来管理力量。

结语：让家成为安全的地方

情绪管理不是一夜之间掌握的技巧，而是一生不断学习的功课。

夫妻若愿意一起操练，家就会越来越安全，沟通会越来越顺畅，孩子也会从父母身上学会如何面对情绪。

愿我们在爱中彼此扶持，在生活细节中学习节制，也用温柔的心拥抱彼此。

这样的婚姻，即使经历风雨，仍能稳固，成为恩典的见证。

English Version

Emotional Management in Marriage

Marriage is a journey in which two hearts face life together.

On this journey, emotional stability and emotional management often shape the atmosphere of the home.

Love does not mean the absence of emotion. It means choosing to protect the relationship when emotions arise. When emotions are ignored, small matters can become large conflicts. Careless words can become wounds. Problems that could have been discussed can become long-term distance.

1. Emotions Shape the Temperature of Marriage

Life brings many pressures: work, children, finances, health, ministry, and household responsibilities.

Under such pressure, emotional ups and downs are normal.

But when emotions are unmanaged, small matters can quickly become major conflicts.

An impatient word spoken in exhaustion, a harsh sentence spoken in anger, or a cold silence born of hurt can slowly wound the other person.

Emotional management is not about making the home silent. It is about making the home safer.

2. First Recognize Your Own Emotions

The first step in emotional management is recognizing and admitting what you feel.

Anger, hurt, anxiety, and fatigue are all real human experiences.

The problem is not that we have emotions. The problem is whether we allow emotions to control our words and actions.

When someone can say, “I am tired right now and need a little quiet,”

or, “I feel hurt, but I want to talk after I calm down,”

that is not avoidance. It is maturity.

Acknowledging emotion is often healthier than suppressing it.

3. Managing Emotions Is Not Denying Them

Emotional management does not mean erasing every negative feeling.

It is not pretending you are never angry, nor forcing yourself to smile all the time.

It means that when emotions come, you do not let them drag you wherever they want.

When you want to say something hurtful, pause first.

When you want to strike back immediately, take a breath.

When you sense that you may lose control, step away for a moment and return to the conversation when your heart is quieter.

Many wounds in marriage do not come from having emotions. They come from emotions that have not passed through love and self-control.

4. Husband and Wife Must Support One Another

Emotional stability is not only an individual practice. It also requires mutual support.

When you notice that your spouse is emotionally unsettled, do not rush to lecture or dismiss the feeling.

Often, the first thing the other person needs is not analysis, but to be seen.

The words, “I can see that you are tired,” may carry more strength than many corrections.

The question, “Would you like to talk to me about it?” may open the relationship more than immediate advice.

Gentle listening is often the best beginning of emotional stability.

If emotional struggles involve severe depression, trauma responses, risk of self-harm, violence, or long-term loss of control, professional counseling, medical care, or crisis support may be needed. Faithful spiritual companionship matters deeply, but it should not replace necessary professional help.

5. Learning Self-Control in Faith

For Christian couples, emotional management is also a spiritual discipline.

Scripture says:

“Every man who strives in the games exercises self-control in all things. Now they do it to receive a corruptible crown, but we an incorruptible.” (1 Corinthians 9:25, WEB)

The fruit of the Spirit also includes self-control.

When we bring our emotions before God, acknowledge our limits, and ask the Lord for peace and gentleness, we gain strength not to be ruled by emotion in marriage.

Self-control is not suppression. It is allowing love to govern strength.

Conclusion: Let Home Become a Safe Place

Emotional management is not a skill mastered overnight. It is a lifelong lesson.

When husband and wife practice it together, the home becomes safer, communication becomes smoother, and children learn from their parents how to face their own emotions.

May we support one another in love, learn self-control in daily details, and embrace one another with gentle hearts.

Such a marriage can remain steady through storms and become a witness of grace.

夫妻之间的经济管理

钱，在婚姻里从来不只是钱。

它常常牵动安全感、价值观、信任、责任、欲望、恐惧和未来规划。

有些夫妻平时很少吵架，一谈到钱就紧张；有些家庭收入并不低，却常常因为开销、债务、奉献、存款或给父母多少钱而争执。

这说明，经济管理不是婚姻里的边缘问题，而是很实际的属灵功课。

需要说明的是，本文只作信仰与家庭牧养反思，不构成投资、法律或税务建议。具体财务决策，仍需根据家庭处境并咨询合适的专业人士。

主耶稣说：

“因为你的财宝在哪里，你的心也在那里。”（太 6:21，和合本）

钱会暴露人的心。

一个家庭怎样使用金钱，往往也显明这个家庭真正看重什么。

一、金钱观不同，是许多冲突的根源

夫妻来自不同的家庭，往往带着不同的金钱观进入婚姻。

有人从小经历缺乏，所以特别重视存钱；有人习惯用消费表达爱，所以觉得花钱是生活品质；有人看重奉献与帮助别人；有人更在意安全与储备。

这些差异本身不一定是问题。

真正的问题，是两个人从来没有认真谈过这些差异。

如果夫妻不谈钱，钱就会在沉默中变成压力；如果夫妻只在吵架时谈钱，钱就会变成武器。

健康的经济管理，首先需要坦诚沟通。

二、透明，是信任的基础

婚姻里的财务透明，不是彼此监控，而是彼此负责。

夫妻之间如果长期隐藏收入、债务、信用卡消费、投资损失或给原生家庭的支出，信任就会被慢慢侵蚀。

有些伤害，不是因为花了多少钱，而是因为“你没有告诉我”。

所以，夫妻需要建立基本透明：

收入透明。

支出透明。

债务透明。

储蓄透明。

奉献与帮助他人的决定，也尽量彼此商量。

透明不是为了限制自由，而是为了让两个人站在同一边。

三、预算不是捆绑，而是保护

很多人一听到预算，就觉得生活失去自由。

其实，预算不是为了让人过得小气，而是为了让钱有方向。

没有预算的家庭，常常不是不能花钱，而是不知道钱去了哪里。

一个成熟的家庭，可以把收入大致分成几个方向：

基本生活。

储蓄与应急。

还债与长期规划。

奉献与帮助人。

适度休闲与家庭享受。

预算不是死板的表格，而是一种共同管理的节奏。它帮助夫妻减少临时冲动，也减少事后的埋怨。

四、债务与消费需要共同承担

在现代生活中，债务很容易变成家庭压力。

房贷、车贷、信用卡、学生贷款、医疗费用，都可能成为夫妻关系中的重担。

面对债务，夫妻最需要的不是互相责备，而是共同面对。

如果债务已经存在，就需要一起梳理、一起计划、一起承担。

若一方长期冲动消费，另一方也需要在爱中提出界限，而不是一直替对方收拾残局。

爱不是纵容失控的消费，爱也不是用羞辱逼迫对方改变。

爱是在诚实中一起建立新的秩序。

五、奉献与慷慨，需要在同心中实行

基督徒家庭谈钱，不能只谈储蓄和消费，也要谈奉献与慷慨。

金钱若只为自己服务，人的心会慢慢变小。

但奉献也不应成为夫妻之间的压力来源。若一方热心奉献，另一方缺乏安全感，就需要耐心沟通，而不是属灵化地压过对方。

真正健康的奉献，是在信心、智慧和同心中完成。

家庭的经济管理，不是让人抓紧每一分钱，而是学习成为忠心的管家。

结语：让钱服事爱，而不是破坏爱

钱本身不是婚姻的敌人。

真正的问题，是钱背后的不安、贪心、隐藏、比较和不信任。

当夫妻愿意坦诚沟通、共同计划、彼此负责、学习节制，也保留慷慨的心，金钱就不再是破坏关系的力量，而会成为建造家庭的工具。

愿每一个家庭都学习让钱回到合适的位置：不是主人，而是仆人；不是偶像，而是托付；不是争吵的理由，而是共同学习忠心的课堂。

English Version

Financial Stewardship in Marriage

Money in marriage is never merely money.

It often touches security, values, trust, responsibility, desire, fear, and plans for the future.

Some couples rarely argue until money enters the conversation. Some families earn enough, yet still struggle over spending, debt, giving, savings, or financial support for parents.

This shows that financial management is not a side issue in marriage. It is a very practical spiritual lesson.

This chapter is a reflection on faith and family stewardship. It is not investment, legal, or tax advice. Specific financial decisions should be made according to each family's situation and, when needed, with appropriate professional counsel.

Jesus said:

“for where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.” (Matthew 6:21, WEB)

Money reveals the heart.

The way a family uses money often shows what that family truly values.

1. Different Views of Money Often Create Conflict

Husband and wife usually enter marriage with different financial habits.

One person may have experienced lack and therefore values saving. Another may express love through spending and believes money should improve quality of life. One may care deeply about giving and helping others. Another may focus on safety and reserves.

These differences are not necessarily wrong.

The real problem is when couples never talk about them.

If couples do not talk about money, money becomes pressure in silence. If they only talk about money during arguments, money becomes a weapon.

Healthy financial stewardship begins with honest conversation.

2. Transparency Builds Trust

Financial transparency in marriage is not surveillance. It is shared responsibility.

When income, debt, credit card spending, investment loss, or support given to extended family is hidden for a long time, trust slowly erodes.

Sometimes the deepest hurt is not the amount of money spent, but the feeling: “You did not tell me.”

So couples need basic transparency:

Transparency about income.

Transparency about expenses.

Transparency about debt.

Transparency about savings.

Decisions about giving and helping others should also be discussed whenever possible.

Transparency does not remove freedom. It helps husband and wife stand on the same side.

3. A Budget Is Protection, Not Bondage

Many people hear the word “budget” and immediately feel restricted.

But a budget is not meant to make life small. It gives money direction.

Without a budget, many families do not necessarily lack money. They simply do not know where the money has gone.

A mature household can roughly plan income around several areas:

Basic living.

Savings and emergency needs.

Debt repayment and long-term planning.

Giving and helping others.

Healthy rest and family enjoyment.

A budget is not a rigid spreadsheet. It is a shared rhythm of stewardship. It helps couples reduce impulsive decisions and later resentment.

4. Debt and Spending Require Shared Responsibility

In modern life, debt can quickly become family pressure.

Mortgages, car loans, credit cards, student loans, and medical expenses can all become heavy burdens.

When facing debt, couples need less blame and more shared responsibility.

If debt already exists, husband and wife need to review it together, plan together, and carry it together.

If one spouse repeatedly spends impulsively, the other spouse may need to set loving boundaries instead of constantly absorbing the consequences.

Love does not enable uncontrolled spending. Love also does not shame someone into change.

Love helps build a new order through honesty.

5. Giving and Generosity Require Unity

Christian families should not speak only about saving and spending. They should also speak about giving and generosity.

When money serves only ourselves, the heart slowly becomes smaller.

But giving should not become a source of pressure between husband and wife. If one spouse is eager to give while the other feels insecure, patient conversation is needed. Spiritual language should not be used to overpower the other person.

Healthy giving happens through faith, wisdom, and unity.

Financial management in the family is not about clinging to every dollar. It is about learning to be faithful stewards.

Conclusion: Let Money Serve Love

Money itself is not the enemy of marriage.

The deeper problems are insecurity, greed, secrecy, comparison, and distrust beneath it.

When couples communicate honestly, plan together, take responsibility, practice self-control, and preserve generosity, money no longer destroys the relationship. It becomes a tool for building the home.

May every family learn to put money in its proper place: not as master, but as servant; not as idol, but as stewardship; not as a reason for conflict, but as a classroom for faithfulness.

夫妻长期分居的弊端

夫妻长期分居，是许多家庭不愿面对、却不得不面对的现实。

有的是因为工作。

有的是因为移民。

有的是因为学习。

有的是因为照顾父母或孩子。

也有的是因为婚姻已经出现严重张力，需要暂时拉开距离。

所以，谈长期分居的弊端，不能简单责备，也不能轻易给所有家庭下结论。

有些分离，是不得已的现实；有些分离，是保护自己的必要界限；有些分离，则是婚姻慢慢失去亲密的开始。

我们需要带着怜悯，也带着清醒来思想这个问题。

圣经提醒夫妻：

“夫妻不可彼此亏负，除非两相情愿，暂时分房，为要专心祷告方可；以后仍要同房……”（林前 7:5，和合本）

这段经文至少让我们看见一个原则：夫妻的分开若发生，也应当是彼此同意、暂时性的，并且有清楚的属灵目的与回归方向。

长期、无计划、无沟通、无盼望的分居，会给婚姻带来真实的伤害。

一、分居会削弱日常陪伴

婚姻最真实的部分，不是婚礼那一天，而是每天一起生活。

一起吃饭。

一起说话。

一起处理孩子的事。

一起面对账单、疲惫、家务和小小的麻烦。

这些日常看似普通，却是婚姻亲密的土壤。

长期分居之后，夫妻失去的往往不是某一个重大仪式，而是日复一日的陪伴。

没有共同生活，许多情绪无法及时被看见；没有日常互动，许多误会无法及时被化解；没有彼此在场，心里的距离就容易慢慢拉开。

二、沟通容易变成任务

分居中的夫妻常常仍然联系。

打电话。

发信息。

视频聊天。

但这些沟通很容易变成任务：报平安、说孩子、谈账单、安排事情。

真正的心灵交流反而越来越少。

屏幕可以传递声音，却很难完全承载拥抱；信息可以传达事实，却不一定传递温度。

如果夫妻长期只靠功能性沟通维持关系，婚姻就会越来越像合作事务，而不是亲密盟约。

三、情感孤单容易制造试探

人不是只需要责任，也需要陪伴。

长期分居中，最危险的不一定是一开始就有第三者，而是心里长期缺少被理解、被安慰、被需要的感觉。

孤单若长期无人回应，人就容易向别处寻找情感补偿。

有些关系的破裂，不是从明显的背叛开始，而是从一次次“只是聊聊天”开始。

因此，分居中的夫妻更需要警醒。不是彼此怀疑，而是一起承认：人都有软弱，孤单需要被认真对待。

四、孩子也会承受关系的距离

如果夫妻有孩子，长期分居不只是夫妻之间的事，也会影响孩子的安全感。

孩子需要的不只是父母都爱他，也需要看见父母如何相处、如何沟通、如何承担家庭。

长期缺席的一方，即使很爱孩子，也可能在孩子的成长节奏中慢慢变得陌生。

另一方则可能承担过重压力，既要照顾孩子，又要处理家庭责任，久而久之容易疲惫、委屈和孤立。

所以，分居若不可避免，父母更需要有意识地维持亲子连接，也要尽量让孩子知道：家庭虽然暂时分开，但爱没有停止，责任没有消失。

五、若不得不分居，就要有计划地守护婚姻

有些分居短期内无法改变。

这时最重要的，不是空喊“不要分居”，而是建立保护机制。

第一，要有清楚的时间表。

如果不能马上团聚，也要知道大致方向，而不是无限期拖延。

第二，要有固定而真实的沟通。

不只是谈事务，也要谈感受、压力、软弱、盼望和祷告。

第三，要有彼此同意的界限。

包括与异性的交往界限、金钱界限、家庭责任界限和社交界限。

第四，要有属灵同行。

可以请可信任的牧者、辅导者或成熟夫妻陪伴，不让婚姻在孤立中消耗。

第五，要定期团聚。

只要条件允许，就不要让“习惯分开”变成婚姻的新常态。

六、特别说明：安全优先

也必须说明，如果分居是因为暴力、严重控制、虐待或安全风险，那么不能为了“维持婚姻”而急着回到危险环境。

这种情况下，保护生命安全、寻求专业帮助、法律资源、牧养陪伴和心理支持，都是必要的。

圣经中的婚姻盟约不等于允许伤害继续发生。

真正的修复，必须建立在悔改、责任、界限和安全之上。

结语：不要让距离成为关系的结局

夫妻长期分居的最大弊端，不只是身体分开，而是心慢慢习惯了没有对方。

一旦习惯没有分享，习惯没有陪伴，习惯没有亲密，婚姻就可能在表面还存在的时候，里面已经变得疏离。

所以，如果夫妻正处在分居中，愿你们不要只管理距离，也要守护关系；不要只完成责任，也要维持亲密；不要只等待团聚，也要在等待中继续相爱。

距离可以是暂时的现实，但不要让它成为婚姻的方向。

愿每一对夫妻，都在限制中寻找靠近，在困难中保守盟约，在分开的日子里，仍然为相聚预备道路。

English Version

The Risks of Long-Term Separation in Marriage

Long-term separation is a reality many couples do not want to face, yet sometimes must face.

Some are separated because of work.

Some because of immigration.

Some because of study.

Some because of caring for parents or children.

Some because the marriage has entered serious tension and temporary distance has become necessary for a season.

Therefore, when we speak about the risks of long-term separation, we must not be simplistic or harsh.

Some separation is an unavoidable reality. Some separation is a necessary boundary for safety. Some separation, however, can become the beginning of slow emotional distance.

We need both compassion and clarity.

Scripture reminds married couples:

“Don’t deprive one another, unless it is by consent for a season, that you may give yourselves to fasting and prayer, and may be together again, that Satan doesn’t tempt you because of your lack of self-control.” (1 Corinthians 7:5, WEB)

At the very least, this teaches us a principle: when separation happens between husband and wife, it should be mutual, temporary, purposeful, and directed toward reunion.

Long-term separation without a plan, communication, hope, or a path toward reunion can bring real harm to a marriage.

1. Separation Weakens Daily Companionship

The most real part of marriage is not the wedding day. It is daily life together.

Eating together.

Talking together.

Handling children’s needs.

Facing bills, fatigue, housework, and small troubles together.

These ordinary details are the soil of marital intimacy.

When couples live apart for a long time, what they lose is often not one major ritual, but daily companionship.

Without shared life, emotions are not seen in time. Without daily interaction, misunderstandings are not resolved in time. Without presence, hearts can slowly drift apart.

2. Communication Can Become Functional

Couples who live apart often still communicate.

Phone calls.

Messages.

Video chats.

But communication can easily become functional: reporting safety, talking about children, discussing bills, and arranging tasks.

Deeper emotional exchange may become less frequent.

A screen can carry a voice, but it cannot fully replace an embrace. A message can communicate facts, but it may not carry warmth.

If a marriage is sustained only by functional communication, it slowly becomes cooperation rather than covenantal intimacy.

3. Emotional Loneliness Creates Temptation

Human beings need more than responsibility. They need companionship.

In long-term separation, the greatest danger may not begin with another person. It often begins with a prolonged lack of being understood, comforted, and needed.

When loneliness remains unanswered, people may begin to look elsewhere for emotional compensation.

Some broken relationships do not begin with obvious betrayal. They begin with repeated conversations that seem harmless.

Therefore, separated couples need vigilance. This is not about suspicion. It is about admitting together that all people are weak, and loneliness must be taken seriously.

4. Children Also Carry the Distance

If a couple has children, long-term separation affects more than husband and wife. It can affect a child's sense of security.

Children need more than knowing both parents love them. They also need to see how their parents relate, communicate, and share responsibility.

The absent parent may love the child deeply, yet slowly become unfamiliar in the rhythm of the child's growth.

The parent who remains at home may carry too much weight, caring for children and managing household responsibilities alone. Over time, this can lead to exhaustion, resentment, and isolation.

If separation is unavoidable, parents need to preserve connection intentionally and help children understand: the family may be temporarily apart, but love has not stopped and responsibility has not disappeared.

5. If Separation Is Unavoidable, Guard the Marriage Intentionally

Some separation cannot be changed immediately.

In that situation, the most important thing is not simply to say, “Do not separate,” but to build protection.

First, create a clear timeline.

If reunion cannot happen immediately, there should still be a direction, not indefinite delay.

Second, establish regular and honest communication.

Do not speak only about tasks. Speak about feelings, pressure, weakness, hope, and prayer.

Third, agree on boundaries.

This includes boundaries with the opposite sex, financial boundaries, family responsibility boundaries, and social boundaries.

Fourth, seek spiritual companionship.

Trusted pastors, counselors, or mature couples can provide support so that the marriage does not weaken in isolation.

Fifth, reunite regularly whenever possible.

Do not allow “getting used to separation” to become the new normal of the marriage.

6. A Necessary Word: Safety Comes First

If separation has happened because of violence, severe control, abuse, or safety concerns, a couple should not rush back into danger simply to “save the marriage.”

In such cases, physical safety, professional help, legal resources, pastoral care, and emotional support may all be necessary.

The biblical marriage covenant does not permit ongoing harm.

True restoration must be built on repentance, responsibility, boundaries, and safety.

Conclusion: Do Not Let Distance Become the Direction

The greatest risk of long-term separation is not only physical distance. It is that the heart slowly becomes accustomed to life without the other person.

Once a couple becomes used to not sharing, not accompanying, and not being intimate, the marriage may still exist outwardly while becoming distant inwardly.

If you are living apart, do not only manage the distance. Guard the relationship. Do not only fulfill responsibilities. Preserve intimacy. Do not only wait for reunion. Continue loving while you wait.

Distance may be a temporary reality, but it should not become the direction of the marriage.

May every couple seek closeness within limitation, guard the covenant through difficulty, and prepare a way toward reunion even during days apart.

第八辑：亲密、界限与圣洁

夫妻之间的性生活观念：以圣经为准绳

性，是婚姻中真实而重要的一部分。

它不应被污名化，也不应被神秘化；不应成为控制对方的工具，也不应成为逃避沟通的禁区。

从圣经的眼光看，夫妻的身体既属于自己，也在盟约中彼此托付。这份托付不是占有权，而是一份带着爱、尊重和责任的礼物。

一、亲密不是索取，而是彼此给予

健康的性生活，不以“我有权得到什么”为起点，而以“我怎样爱护你”为起点。

夫妻之间即使已经结婚，也需要彼此尊重、彼此同意。任何以威胁、羞辱、冷暴力、宗教语言或经济压力迫使对方发生性行为的做法，都违背了爱的本质。

真正的亲密让人感到被珍惜，而不是被使用。

二、身体有差异，节奏也有差异

夫妻对亲密的需要、表达方式与身体状态可能不同。年龄、疾病、药物、生产、压力、创伤和疲劳，都可能影响性欲与身体反应。

差异不是拒绝爱的证据，也不等于婚姻出了不可挽回的问题。成熟的夫妻会学习谈论需要，也学习听见对方的限制。

有些问题需要耐心，有些需要合格医生或婚姻治疗专业人士的帮助。牧养关怀可以同行，却不能代替医疗诊断或专业治疗。

三、亲密需要隐私与忠诚

夫妻的亲密不应成为朋友间的笑料，也不应在未经同意时被公开。色情内容、秘密关系和持续的暧昧，会侵蚀盟约中的专一。

忠诚不只是身体没有越界，也包括心愿意回到配偶面前，诚实面对孤独、失望与诱惑。

四、性生活不能承担婚姻的全部重量

性可以表达爱，却不能代替沟通、信任、陪伴与悔改。

若关系中充满轻视、恐惧或未处理的伤害，单靠增加性生活并不能修复婚姻。真正的亲密，是身体与心灵都能在安全中靠近。

结语：在尊重中成为一体

婚姻里的性，不是表演，不是交易，也不是义务清单。

它是两个人在盟约、忠诚和安全中，学习彼此接纳的语言。

愿夫妻在羞涩中仍能诚实，在差异中仍有耐心，在亲密中彼此尊重，使身体的靠近成为心灵相爱的延伸。

English Version

A Biblical View of Marital Sexuality

Sexual intimacy is a real and important part of marriage.

It should not be treated as shameful or mysterious. It should never become a tool of control or a forbidden subject that a couple is unable to discuss.

From a biblical perspective, husband and wife entrust themselves to one another within a covenant. This entrusting is not ownership. It is a gift shaped by love, respect, and responsibility.

1. Intimacy Is Mutual Giving, Not Taking

Healthy sexuality does not begin with, “What am I entitled to receive?” It begins with, “How can I care for you?”

Marriage does not remove the need for mutual consent and respect. Threats, humiliation, emotional punishment, religious pressure, or financial control must never be used to obtain sex.

True intimacy makes a person feel cherished, not used.

2. Bodies and Rhythms Differ

Spouses may differ in desire, expression, and physical capacity. Age, illness, medication, childbirth, stress, trauma, and exhaustion may all affect sexuality.

Difference is not proof that love has disappeared. Mature couples learn to express their needs and listen to each other’s limits.

Some concerns require patience; others may need help from a qualified physician or licensed therapist. Pastoral care can accompany a couple, but it cannot replace medical assessment or professional treatment.

3. Intimacy Requires Privacy and Faithfulness

A couple’s intimate life should not become public entertainment or be disclosed without consent. Pornography, secret relationships, and sustained emotional affairs weaken covenant faithfulness.

Faithfulness is more than avoiding physical betrayal. It means returning honestly to one’s spouse with loneliness, disappointment, and temptation.

4. Sex Cannot Carry the Whole Marriage

Sex may express love, but it cannot replace communication, trust, companionship, and repentance.

Where contempt, fear, or unresolved harm fills the relationship, more sexual activity will not repair the marriage. Real intimacy allows both body and heart to draw near in safety.

Conclusion: Becoming One Through Respect

Marital sexuality is not a performance, a transaction, or a list of obligations.

It is a language through which two people learn to receive one another in covenant, fidelity, and safety.

May couples speak honestly through discomfort, remain patient through difference, and honor one another in intimacy, so that physical closeness becomes an extension of faithful love.

夫妻中的出轨：悔改、医治与更新

出轨带来的伤害，往往不只是一个行为被发现。

它击碎的是信任，是共同记忆的解释，也是受伤一方对自己价值和现实判断的把握。

因此，面对出轨，不能只说一句“饶恕吧”，也不能把修复的责任交给受伤的人。

一、先让真相停止继续流血

修复的第一步，是越界关系真正结束，谎言真正停止。

若仍在隐瞒、删改事实、责怪配偶或保留秘密联系，就还不是悔改，只是在处理后果。

真实悔改愿意承担责任，也愿意接受关系、家庭和群体中的合理监督。

二、受伤者有权悲伤，也有权设立界限

被背叛的人可能愤怒、麻木、反复追问，也可能暂时无法决定婚姻下一步怎么走。这些反应并不等于缺乏信心。

饶恕不是假装事情没有发生，也不等于立即恢复共同生活、亲密关系或信任。

信任需要证据、时间和持续一致的行动，不能由犯错的一方规定进度。

三、不要把出轨合理化

婚姻中的孤独、冲突或性生活问题需要面对，但它们不能成为背叛的借口。

关系问题可以共同承担，出轨行为的责任则属于作出选择的人。

只有停止推责，修复才有真正的起点。

四、教会应当保护，而不是催促

教会不应只关心婚姻形式是否保存，更应关心人是否安全、真相是否被面对、悔改是否真实。

牧者可以帮助双方辨明下一步，却不应强迫受伤者迅速和好，也不应以羞耻阻止其寻求专业帮助或法律保护。

结语：恩典不取消真相

基督里的恩典为犯罪者留下悔改的路，也为受伤者留下医治的空间。

婚姻有可能更新，但更新不是回到假装无事发生的从前，而是在真相、责任、界限和时间中，重新学习可信。

English Version

Infidelity in Marriage

Repentance, Healing, and Renewal

Infidelity wounds more than a relationship through one act.

It shatters trust, changes the meaning of shared memories, and may cause the betrayed spouse to question both personal worth and the ability to recognize reality.

For this reason, it is not enough to say, “Just forgive.” The burden of repair must not be placed on the person who was betrayed.

1. Stop the Wound from Continuing

Repair begins when the outside relationship truly ends and deception stops.

Continued secrecy, altered stories, blame, or hidden contact is not repentance. It is damage control.

Real repentance accepts responsibility and appropriate accountability.

2. The Betrayed Spouse May Grieve and Set Boundaries

The injured spouse may feel anger, numbness, confusion, or uncertainty about the future. These responses are not evidence of weak faith.

Forgiveness does not mean pretending nothing happened. It does not require immediate reunion, sexual intimacy, or restored trust.

Trust needs evidence, time, and consistent action. The person who broke trust cannot control the timetable.

3. Do Not Rationalize Betrayal

Loneliness, conflict, or sexual difficulties in a marriage deserve attention, but they do not excuse infidelity.

Relational problems may involve both partners. Responsibility for betrayal belongs to the person who made that choice.

Repair begins only when blame-shifting ends.

4. The Church Must Protect, Not Pressure

The church should care about more than preserving the appearance of marriage. It should ask whether people are safe, whether truth is being faced, and whether repentance is genuine.

Pastors may help a couple discern next steps, but they should not force rapid reconciliation or use shame to prevent professional help or legal protection.

Conclusion: Grace Does Not Cancel Truth

Grace in Christ leaves a path of repentance for the one who sinned and room for healing for the one who was wounded.

A marriage may be renewed, but renewal does not mean returning to a false version of the past. It means learning trust again through truth, responsibility, boundaries, and time.

固定伴侣却不进入盟约的信仰反思

现代关系里，有一种状态越来越常见：两个人长期相伴，共享生活与亲密，却始终不愿进入婚姻盟约。

我们不应轻率定罪。有人害怕重复父母失败的婚姻，有人经历过背叛，有人面对经济、身份或法律上的复杂处境。

但理解处境，并不等于不再追问关系的方向。

一、亲密需要与责任同行

盟约的意义，不只是一场婚礼或一张证书，而是公开地说：“我愿意承担与你相爱相伴的责任。”

若关系只保留亲密，却不断延后责任，其中一方往往会长期生活在不确定中。

二、害怕承诺，需要被诚实面对

“现在这样也很好”有时是真实选择，有时则是用舒适掩盖恐惧。

成熟的关系需要谈清楚：我们为何不愿结婚？我们对忠诚、财务、家庭、孩子、疾病与未来有什么责任？

三、教会的角色是陪伴辨明

教会既不应羞辱同居者，也不应把所有关系形式都视为同样。

牧养的责任，是帮助人从隐藏走向诚实，从含糊走向清楚，从只求眼前安稳走向愿意承担盟约。

结语：爱需要一个可以交账的方向

真正的爱不只问“我们现在是否快乐”，也问“我是否愿意为你的明天负责”。

愿相爱的人有勇气面对恐惧、现实与责任，使亲密不再漂浮，而在清楚、忠诚和公开的委身中找到归属。

English Version

Intimacy Without Covenant

A Reflection on Commitment and Responsibility

One relationship pattern has become increasingly common: two people share life and intimacy for years but remain unwilling to enter marriage.

We should not condemn people carelessly. Some fear repeating their parents' broken marriage. Some carry betrayal or face complicated financial, legal, or immigration realities.

Understanding a situation, however, does not remove the need to ask where the relationship is going.

1. Intimacy and Responsibility Belong Together

Covenant is more than a ceremony or document. It is a public commitment to carry the responsibilities of shared love and life.

When intimacy is welcomed but responsibility is continually postponed, one partner may live for years in uncertainty.

2. Fear of Commitment Needs Honest Attention

"We are fine as we are" may be a considered decision, or it may hide fear beneath comfort.

Mature relationships discuss the difficult questions: Why are we unwilling to marry? What responsibilities do we accept regarding fidelity, finances, family, children, illness, and the future?

3. The Church Should Accompany Discernment

The church should neither shame unmarried couples nor pretend that every form of relationship carries the same covenant meaning.

Pastoral care helps people move from secrecy to honesty, from ambiguity to clarity, and from temporary comfort toward responsible commitment.

Conclusion: Love Needs a Responsible Direction

Love asks more than, "Are we happy now?" It also asks, "Am I willing to be responsible for your tomorrow?" May those who love one another find courage to face fear, reality, and responsibility, so that intimacy may find a home in clear, faithful, and public commitment.

第九辑：破裂之后的路

夫妻可以离婚吗？

这是一个无法只用“可以”或“不可以”回答的问题。

圣经高举婚姻盟约，也诚实面对人的刚硬、背叛与伤害。婚姻应当被守护，但守护婚姻不能变成要求受害者继续留在危险中。

一、不要轻看盟约

离婚会带来真实的失去，影响夫妻、孩子、家庭与群体。因此，在安全允许的情况下，夫妻应认真面对问题，寻求沟通、辅导、悔改与修复。

二、不要用盟约遮盖伤害

家庭暴力、性暴力、严重控制、持续威胁、遗弃或反复背叛，不应被一句“要忍耐”掩盖。

分居有时是保护生命和停止伤害所需的界限。若有人处于即时危险，应先联系当地紧急服务、家庭暴力资源、律师或合格专业人士，而不是独自承担。

三、复杂个案需要共同辨明

不同基督教传统对离婚的经文解释与适用范围并不完全一致。牧者不应以一篇文章替个人作最终裁决。

当事人需要在事实、经文、悔改可能、安全、孩子需要和当地法律之间，寻求成熟牧养与专业意见。

结语：真理与怜悯必须同行

婚姻不是可以随意丢弃的关系，离婚也不应成为处理所有冲突的第一选择。

但一个人的生命与尊严，同样不能被牺牲来维护表面完整。

本文是信仰与牧养反思，不构成法律意见或个案裁决。

English Version

Can a Couple Divorce?

This question cannot be answered responsibly with a simple yes or no.

Scripture honors the marriage covenant and also speaks honestly about hardness of heart, betrayal, and harm. Marriage should be protected, but protecting marriage must never mean requiring a victim to remain in danger.

1. Do Not Treat Covenant Lightly

Divorce brings real loss to spouses, children, families, and communities. When safety permits, couples should take problems seriously and seek communication, counseling, repentance, and repair.

2. Do Not Use Covenant to Conceal Harm

Domestic violence, sexual violence, coercive control, continuing threats, abandonment, or repeated betrayal must not be hidden beneath the command to “endure.”

Separation may be a necessary boundary to protect life and stop harm. Anyone in immediate danger should contact local emergency services, domestic violence resources, legal counsel, or qualified professionals.

3. Complex Cases Require Careful Discernment

Christian traditions differ in how they interpret and apply biblical passages concerning divorce. A pastor or article should not issue a final ruling for every individual case.

Discernment should consider facts, Scripture, repentance, safety, the needs of children, and local law, with mature pastoral and professional guidance.

Conclusion: Truth and Mercy Must Walk Together

Marriage should not be discarded casually, and divorce should not become the first answer to every conflict.

Yet a person’s life and dignity must not be sacrificed to preserve an outward appearance.

This chapter offers pastoral and faith reflection. It is not legal advice or an individual case ruling.

离婚后可以再婚吗？

离婚之后，很多人面对的不只是孤单，还有一个更复杂的问题：我是否可以重新进入婚姻？

基督徒对此有不同理解。有人强调婚姻盟约终身有效，有人根据离婚原因、悔改和经文中的例外作不同判断。承认这些差异，并不等于放弃真理，而是拒绝把复杂伤口变成轻率口号。

一、先不要急着用新关系止痛

离婚后的孤独很真实，但新的婚姻不能代替哀伤、反省与医治。

若旧关系中的恐惧、依赖、控制或沟通模式没有被面对，它们可能进入下一段关系。

二、诚实面对过去

再婚前需要问：上一段婚姻为何结束？我需要承担什么责任？我是否仍被愤怒、报复或证明自己的需要推动？

这不是让受害者承担不属于自己的罪，而是让每个人在自己可以负责的范围内成长。

三、考虑孩子与现实责任

再婚不只是两个人相爱，也会重组家庭边界、亲子关系、财务与照顾责任。

孩子需要时间、安全感和清楚的角色，不应被迫迅速接受新的家庭安排。

四、在群体中辨明

再婚决定应当经过祷告、经文反思、成熟牧养与必要的法律、财务和心理咨询。

不要因羞耻仓促放弃，也不要因孤单仓促开始。

结语：恩典不是催促，而是引导

离婚不是一个人生命的终点，再婚也不是证明生命已经恢复的奖章。

真正重要的是，一个人是否在恩典中变得诚实、自由、可靠，并预备好再次承担盟约。

English Version

Can One Remarry After Divorce?

After divorce, many people face more than loneliness. They also ask whether they may enter marriage again.

Christians do not interpret every relevant passage in the same way. Some emphasize the lifelong nature of covenant; others distinguish circumstances involving abandonment, betrayal, repentance, and biblical exceptions. Acknowledging these differences is not abandoning truth. It is refusing to reduce a complex wound to a slogan.

1. Do Not Use a New Relationship to Avoid Grief

Loneliness after divorce is real, but a new marriage cannot replace grief, reflection, and healing.

Unaddressed patterns of fear, dependency, control, or communication may enter the next relationship.

2. Face the Past Honestly

Before remarriage, ask why the previous marriage ended, what responsibility belongs to you, and whether anger, revenge, or the need to prove yourself still drives you.

This does not place another person's wrongdoing on a victim. It invites each person to grow within the area for which they are responsible.

3. Consider Children and Practical Responsibilities

Remarriage joins more than two adults. It reshapes family boundaries, parenting relationships, finances, and caregiving.

Children need time, safety, and clear roles. They should not be pressured to accept a new family structure immediately.

4. Discern Within Community

A decision about remarriage deserves prayer, biblical reflection, mature pastoral counsel, and appropriate legal, financial, or therapeutic guidance.

Do not abandon hope because of shame, and do not begin quickly because of loneliness.

Conclusion: Grace Guides Rather Than Rushes

Divorce is not the end of a person's life, and remarriage is not a trophy proving that healing is complete.

The deeper question is whether a person is becoming honest, free, and trustworthy in grace, and is ready to carry covenant responsibility again.

单身男女与寡妇鳏夫：性的需求与守独身的恩典

单身、丧偶或离婚的人，并不会因为没有配偶就失去身体的需要与亲密的渴望。

教会若只说“要忍耐”，却不谈孤独、身体、友谊与群体，就容易让人把正常需要误解为羞耻。

一、欲望本身不是身份

性的需要是身体经验的一部分，却不是一个人全部的身份，也不必成为支配人生的力量。

承认欲望，不等于必须立刻满足；守独身，也不等于否定身体。

二、守独身需要恩典，也需要结构

单靠意志很难长久。健康界限、规律生活、诚实友谊、服事、运动、祷告与可信任的同行者，都能帮助人不在孤独中失守。

对色情内容或强迫性性行为形成依赖的人，应寻求合格专业帮助，不必用羞耻隐藏。

三、教会应成为家

单身者不是等待进入“完整人生”的半成品，丧偶者也不是群体边缘的人。

教会需要提供真实的友谊、节期陪伴、实际帮助和服事空间，而不是只围绕核心家庭安排一切。

结语：独身也能活出丰盛

守独身不是没有爱，而是学习让爱不只沿着性与婚姻流动。

一个人可以有渴望，也可以有界限；可以经历孤单，也仍然拥有群体、使命与喜乐。

English Version

Singles, Widows, and Widowers

Sexual Desire and the Grace of Chastity

People who are single, widowed, or divorced do not lose bodily needs or the desire for intimacy simply because they do not have a spouse.

When the church says only, “You must endure,” without speaking about loneliness, embodiment, friendship, and community, normal human needs may become covered in shame.

1. Desire Is Not Identity

Sexual desire is part of embodied life, but it is not the whole of a person’s identity and does not need to rule the direction of life.

Acknowledging desire does not require immediate fulfillment. Chastity does not require rejecting the body.

2. Chastity Needs Grace and Structure

Willpower alone rarely lasts. Healthy boundaries, daily rhythm, honest friendship, service, exercise, prayer, and trusted companions help a person remain grounded.

Anyone struggling with pornography or compulsive sexual behavior should seek qualified professional help without hiding in shame.

3. The Church Should Become Family

Single adults are not incomplete people waiting for real life to begin. Widowed people do not belong at the edge of the community.

Churches should offer genuine friendship, companionship during holidays, practical support, and meaningful service, rather than organizing everything only around nuclear families.

Conclusion: A Full Life Is Possible in Singleness

Chastity is not the absence of love. It is learning that love can flow through more than sex and marriage. A person may carry desire and boundaries, experience loneliness and still possess community, calling, and joy.

离婚后独自养育孩子：在现实压力中寻找支持

离婚之后独自养育孩子，常常意味着一个人同时承担情绪、经济、照顾与法律事务。

外人看见的也许是“她已经离开那段婚姻”，当事人面对的却可能是住房、工作、孩子接送、医疗、监护安排和持续冲突。

一、不要把单亲处境道德化

每一段离婚都有不同背景。教会不应在不了解事实时，把所有责任归给独自带孩子的一方。

她首先需要的，往往不是审问，而是安全、聆听和实际支持。

二、法律权利需要当地专业意见

美国各州关于离婚、监护、抚养费、保护令和财产的规定并不相同，其他国家和地区也各有制度。

本文不提供法律结论。当事人应保存重要记录，并向当地合格律师、法律援助机构、家庭暴力服务或社会工作者咨询。

三、孩子需要稳定，不需要被迫选边

孩子不应成为传话工具、报复筹码或冲突证人。

在安全允许的情况下，成年人应减少让孩子承担婚姻矛盾，并为其提供稳定作息、诚实而合龄的解释，以及必要的心理支持。

四、群体可以提供具体帮助

一句“我为你祷告”很重要，但送一顿饭、接送一次、陪同咨询、帮助寻找住房和法律资源，常常更能托住一个家庭。

结语：接受帮助不是失败

独自养育孩子的人不需要证明自己什么都能扛。

寻求法律、经济、心理与牧养支持，是保护自己和孩子的责任，不是信心不足。

愿教会成为不定罪的家，也成为能够把关怀落实为行动的群体。

English Version

Parenting Alone After Divorce

Finding Support Under Real-World Pressure

Parenting alone after divorce often means carrying emotional, financial, caregiving, and legal responsibilities at the same time.

Others may see only that a person has left a marriage. The parent may be facing housing, employment, transportation, medical care, custody arrangements, and continuing conflict.

1. Do Not Moralize Single-Parent Life

Every divorce has a different history. A church should not assign all responsibility to the parent caring for the children without understanding the facts.

That parent may need safety, listening, and practical help before questions or advice.

2. Legal Rights Require Local Professional Guidance

Laws concerning divorce, custody, child support, protection orders, and property vary among U.S. states and across countries.

This chapter does not offer legal conclusions. Affected parents should preserve relevant records and consult a qualified local attorney, legal aid organization, domestic violence service, or social worker.

3. Children Need Stability, Not Pressure to Choose Sides

Children should not become messengers, bargaining tools, or witnesses in adult conflict.

Where safety permits, adults should reduce the burden placed on children and provide stable routines, honest age-appropriate explanations, and professional emotional support when needed.

4. Community Can Offer Concrete Help

Saying, “I am praying for you,” matters. A meal, transportation, accompaniment to an appointment, or help locating housing and legal resources may carry a family even more directly.

Conclusion: Receiving Help Is Not Failure

A parent raising children alone does not need to prove that everything can be carried without help.

Seeking legal, financial, therapeutic, and pastoral support is responsible care for both parent and child, not a lack of faith.

May the church become a home that does not condemn and a community that turns concern into action.